

IRCTC (IRCTC)

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1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda

Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,

Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

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Earnings Conference Call” held on May 30, 2023.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma’am,

In reference to our communication dated May 25, 2023, please find enclosed herewith the transcript of “Q4FY’23 Earnings Conference Call” held on May 30, 2023.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For Indian Railway Catering and

Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra) Company Secretary and Compliance Officer Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a

“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited

Q4 FY '23 Earnings Conference Call”

May 30 , 202 3

MANAGEMENT : MRS.RAJNI HASIJA – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING
DIRECTOR –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED

MR. AJIT KUMAR – DIRECTOR , FINANCE AND CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS
LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited Q4 FY '23 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star, then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you, and over to you.

Rahul Jain : Thank you, Renju. Good afternoon everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all

to the Q4 FY '23 Conference Call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC, represented by Smt. Rajni Hasija, who is CMD of the company; and Mr. Ajit Kumar ji, who is Director, Finance and CFO of the company.

And now, I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceedings forward. Over to you, please.

Rajni Hasija: Very good afternoon to everyone present here and a very warm welcome to you and all the presentees to this conference call of IRCTC Limited for the quarter and the year ended 31, March 2023. Wishing you and your dear ones a very good health also.

Yesterday, your company had announced audited financial results for the fourth quarter and year ended 31st March 2023 and the same has been disclosed on both the stock exchanges website also.

I shall first give you a brief overview about quarter -- the last quarter of fiscal '23 and the overall results of the financial year '23 also, post which our Director Finance and CFO, will provide the details of the performance of our business segments post which we shall have a question-and-answer session too.

The last quarter of financial year '23, the revenue was all-time high. That is INR 965 crores, a very strong growth of 5.1% quarter-over-quarter and year-over-year, the growth has been 39.7% has been seen. In the last quarter of financial year '23 the tourism segment has been the main driver of the quarter-over-quarter revenue growth, given that the quarter is seasonally the best quarter for the segment.

As you would be aware about the difference in the profitability of our business segments

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change in the business mix resulted in the EBITDA margins coming to 33.6% versus 35.5% quarter-over-quarter and 40.3% year-over-year. Importantly, the absolute EBITDA of INR 324.6 crores was in line with the INR 325.8 crores in the third quarter of financial year '23.

The net profit before exceptional items for the quarter, last quarter of financial year '23 came to 253 crores that is INR 253 crores, vis-a-vis INR 254 crores in the third quarter of the financial year and INR 218 crores in the last quarter of the previous year.

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For the year FY23 as a whole, the revenue which has been lifetime high for the IRCTC came to be INR 3,541.5 crores and grew by 88.5% year-over-year. That is the absolute EBITDA came at INR 1,276 crores with 46.3% year-over-year and EBITDA margin came at 36% versus 46.4% year-over-year given the changes in revenue mix. Lifetime high net profit before exceptional items also came. That is at INR 978.7 crores versus INR 663.6 crores from the last year.

The Board of Directors have recommended a final dividend of INR 2 per share, subject to shareholders' approval, which takes the total dividend of INR 5.5 per share for the financial year '23, highest ever dividend declared by IRCTC so far.

I would like to conclude my opening remarks by saying that IRCTC has demonstrated once again a resilient business model during and most importantly, post the COVID-19 pandemic. It is its resilience that would keep the company to continue on its growth path in the future as well.

Now I shall be handing over the call to my colleague and our Director and CFO, Shri. Ajit Kumar, to brief you on the financial and segment-wise performance of the company. Thank you very much, gentlemen.

Ajit Kumar: Good afternoon, everybody, and I hope you and your dear ones are good health. I shall first give a brief overview about Q4 FY '23 results, post which we'll have the question-and-answer session.

Q4 FY '23 revenue saw another quarter with strong growth both on quarter-over-quarter and year-over-year basis. Revenue of INR 965 crores grew by 5.1% quarter-over-quarter and by just under 40% year-over-year.

Given that tourism segment with relatively lower margin was the key driver for quarter-over-quarter revenue growth, the overall EBITDA margin, 33.6% versus 35.5% quarter-over-quarter and 40.4% year-over-year. However, we have been able to maintain the absolute EBITDA almost at Q3 FY '23 levels. Net profit before exceptional items for Q4 FY '23 came at INR 253 crores versus INR 254 crores in Q3 FY '23 and INR 218 crores in Q4 FY '22.

Let us move to the business segment. Now the first one, Internet Ticketing segment that continues to demonstrate its resilience and with conversion of reserved tourist ticket back to unreserved tickets during the past pre-pandemic period, revenue for the quarter was at INR 295 crores which declined by just 2% quarter-over-quarter and grew by 0.8% year-over-year. However, EBIT margin came at 88.1% versus 84.2% quarter-over-quarter and 91.5% year-over-year.

Next segment, the Catering segment. That reported revenue of INR 395.8 crores, implying growth of 0.4% quarter-over-quarter and 48.7% year-over-year. However, the EBIT margin improved to 12.1% versus 10.7% quarter-over-quarter and 9.4% year-over-year. The third important segment, the Tourism. The Tourism segment saw a strong growth of 38% quarter-over-quarter and 1.5x year-over-year to INR 204 crores, which is all-time high and well

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above the pre-pandemic level. EBIT margin for the segment improved further to 13.5% versus 10.8% quarter-over-quarter and a loss on year-on-year basis. In Q4 FY '23, the revenue share of the Tourism segment increased to 21.1% versus 16.1% quarter-over-quarter and 11.6% year-over-year. As you would know, given that the EBIT margin for the segment is lower than the company average, it has resulted in the moderation of overall margin profile of the quarter. Now next important segment, Railneer. Railneer saw Q4 FY '23 revenue of INR 70.10 crores, implying a decline of 6.7% quarter-over-quarter and a growth of 35.2% year-over-year. Reported EBIT margin improved to 18.6% versus 11.8% quarter-over-quarter and a loss on a year-on-year basis. For Q4 FY '23, the capex was 21.64 crores and total capex for the FY '23 was INR 135.4 crores. The cash and bank balance and net worth of the company as of the end of FY '23 is INR 1,934 crores and INR 2,480 crores, respectively.

That will be the end of my -- the opening remarks. Now we can straight move to the question-and-answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question comes from the line of Jinesh Joshi from Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: Thanks for the opportunity. Initially, if you can help with the convenience revenue for the quarter and also the number of the tickets books?

Rajni Hasija: Can you please come again? Your voice initially was not audible.

Jinesh Joshi: Yes, Madam, I wanted to know, what was the convenience revenue and the total number of tickets booked for the quarter?

Rajni Hasija: Okay. The first -- I will answer your second question first. The total numbers of 10.44 crores tickets have been booked during the last quarter of Q4 FY 23 and 14.54 crores passengers have been booked on these tickets.

And then you said the revenue from this, total INR 802 crores was the total revenue of the ticketing in the entire financial year. And in the last quarter, the convenience fee that we have received is nearly INR 197 crores in the last quarter.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure, madam. My second question is with respect to our Catering business. So if I remember correctly, our Catering reach was approximately 1,203 including TSV and pantry car until the last quarter.

So the question is, have we been able to extend the count over here? And also, what is the total opportunity size in terms of number of trains that we can service. So basically, I thought of asking this question as not all suburban trains would require catering support, especially the ones that ply on the short distance, so yes, your thoughts on this.

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Rajni Hasija: See, before COVID, we were having nearly 417 trains if you recall correctly. Now these 417 trains will be pantry car. So now the 417 trains figure has increased, and we have now the contracts available for 492 trains, which has been awarded by IRCTC till the last month.

In addition to these 492 trains, we also have a Train Side Vending contracts available for nearly, 675 touch screens. And many of -- I think more than 300 train contracts is in -- still in the pipeline because we are, as of now, we are going for our short-term tenders. And this is a continuous process and every -- after six months, the cycle repeats.

So as of now, you can see more than 1,100 trains are available with the IRCTC on contract.

Out of which more -- nearly 50% trains are with the pantry car and rest of the trains are under Train Side Vending.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure, madam. Just one follow-up on this train side vending. You mentioned that more than 1,100 trains are available, but I wanted to know the opportunity size, so...

Rajni Hasija: All Vande Bharat, which are coming are being added as a fleet. The contracts are being awarded by the IRCTC there is one addition. Any new trains being operated by Indian Railways, the contracts are being awarded by IRCTC only.

So we have a right -- you can say that so far, I think Honourable Prime Minister has announced that 75 new Vande Bharat are going to be operated. Out of which, I think 17 have started. All such operations are being looked at by IRCTC. The more trains are going to be there in the pipeline, the more services are

going to be available for IRCTC.

Jinesh Joshi : Sure, madam. One last question from my side. That is on the balance sheet, especially pertaining to the receivable days. So if I remember correctly, in the past, we have worked out in the Indian Railways whereby majority of the payment pertaining to catering also happened on the day of the service itself, which essentially should have led to an improvement in our receivable cycle so to say. But apparently, if I look at our receivable days for FY '23, it is at about 118-odd which is not materially different than the past. So has the change really come into effect?

Rajni Hasija: There was a software to be made. Ministry of Railway decided, even yesterday also there was a testing. If everything goes well with the testing, it is likely to be started in the coming month.

So we -- as our services are booked for a train, accordingly the customer will be paying online. So we would be receiving nearly 68.5% of that revenue directly the next day. So that testing is being done. Our team is also involved. Once the testing is in place, you will find some changes in the preceding months -- in the forthcoming months.

Jinesh Joshi : Got it. So basically, our receivables cycle should improve going ahead, that is the understanding.

Rajni Hasija: It will rather .Because we are going to get -- earlier you used to get the amount after 120 days. And after 120 days, sometimes it is taken by the railways to reimburse the amount. So we had a lead time of more than six months in getting, that is why you are saying six months. So

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maybe now as soon as the ticket is booked, journey may be after 120 days but at least 68% of the revenue will be available with you.

That program has been developed by our technical body in place. It is being tested by Railway Finance . It is being tested by IRCTC Finance and our operational teams too on both the sides.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure, madam. Thank you so much and all the best .

Rajni Hasija: Thank you, Jignesh.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Rohit Bahirwani from Vijit Global Securities Private Limited. Please go ahead.

Rohit Bahirwani : Yes, thank you for giving me the opportunity. I had a couple of questions. First is, what are your growth plans in Railneer segment? The capacity is around 14.8 lakh litres per day and utilization is around 70%. At what levels can we expect it to grow further?

Rajni Hasija: You said our capacity is nearly 14 lakh litres but per day production of the Railneer is now 15.5 lakh litres a day. We have 16 plants in operation. And our Bhubaneswar and Vijayawada is going to be operational soon. And the plants which are being operated by us. We are also thinking of increasing their capacity also. So like we have certain sales available before the plant. So we are trying to increase the capacity of that, but as well, in addition to making the new plants, which are going to be commissioned soon in Bhubaneswar, Vijayawada, Kota and Simhadri.

Rohit Bahirwani : And what can be the utilization level can we expect in future?

Rajni Hasija: As of now, in the last financial year, the fiscal we are talking about, our capacity utilization has been nearly 73.32%. So as that really is picking up, we are increasing our capacity utilization in many of the cases. Yesterday, we also had our cost audit, and it was also observed that the utilization of -- the plant capacity utilization has improved a lot as compared to the pre-COVID levels, COVID levels also.

And we are in process since we are going to increase their capacity also and the utilization of the not only the existing assets but the asset going to be added because since we have to meet the demand, so we'll have to increase the production from these plants as well. So you will find some good improvement on a better side as well as the capacity utilization is concerned.

May and June are the peak periods, July in fact. Now the Railneer demand is throughout the year, except for the month when we have winters. So you will find more or less good capacity utilization throughout the year, except for the maintenance days.

Rohit Bahirwani : Okay. Okay. And my second question was what's the update on the payment aggregator license, which is pending since last 2 quarters? And just wanted to understand, will it help in bringing additional revenues or it will help in cutting down the cost?

Rajni Hasija: It will help. The payment gateway business, yes, we had applied for the license. We were stuck up in between, many changes had to be made. We are -- iPay licensing, we had applied to RBI.

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RBI has given us certain guidelines. We are complying with that guidelines. We are in the process of following. As a follow-up, we are about to submit 2 papers to them very soon. As far as the revenue from the iPay is concerned, let me explain you that our revenue from the

payment gateway has been very good this year. This has been nearly INR 67.37 crores from the payment gateway. And out of this, the net profit has been around -- without GST hedging INR38.09 crores. So the revenue projection is larger. That is why we are going ahead till that time, it is not there we are going with only with Easy.

We have not stopped the Easy work. But an aggregator model, yes, we are going to increase the revenue once we are through. The process is not that simple sir, it requires lots of efforts, that team is -- and the entire process has to be rebuilt, so we are doing that. The technical changes are also in the pipeline and as well as our approvals are also in the pipeline. You will hear the good news in the days to come.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Jyoti Singh from Arihant Capital Markets Limited. Please go ahead.

Jyoti Singh : Yes, sir, thank you for the opportunity. My question is on the Vande Bharat side. If you can give us a little bit of brief which are the -- how is the pipeline and which are the companies that we are having contracts if we can disclose? And apart from that, why are other expenses -- sorry, why our other income has increased from previous quarter?

Rajni Hasija: First is that the other income is from the other resources, the interest has gone up.

Ajit Kumar : due to increase in FD rates..

Rajni Hasija: And increasing. FD rates also. FD rates have improved, so the interest has improved so other income has improved. Answer to your second question, ma'am. The answer to your first question is some light on the Vande Bharat. As far as the operation of train is concerned, it is controlled by the Ministry of Railways. We know that much as you have read in the newspaper that the trains are going to be inaugurated.

The Vande Bharat so far we are operating doing the entire hospitality business, services are being provided by IRCTC on Vande Bharat. As of now, we are providing services and nearly 17 Vande Bharat. So these services are there. Many -- if railway decides to operate more and more trains, we would be providing services in all. And who would be getting the contract, who's running the contract may not be that important. Important is the license fee that IRCTC is getting. And rest of the operation part, IRCTC is handling well.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Akshay Bhor from Citadel. Please go ahead.

Akshay Bhor : My question is on the Internet Ticketing business and group as we think about the next year in this business because ultimately this contributes to about 80% of your EBIT contribution. I just want to understand what are the levers from here for you to deliver growth in this business in terms of either Internet penetration increase or number of passengers increase? And how do we think about each of these elements?

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Rajni Hasija: To explain you, I would like to show you a few figures with you actually. That is the daily average ticket, if you recall, in the first quarter was around 12.73 lakh tickets in a day. When we were having 2S ticket in reserved segment that is a good number of tickets available with us that was nearly 38%. Subsequently, when the decision was taken, our booking went down to 11.63 lakhs per day.

And now in the third quarter, the booking went down further. It was 11.31 lakhs per day But the average now -- but in quarter 4, the bookings came back to 11.61 lakhs per day So the average booking that we are doing is nearly 82% of the total ticket inventory available through online mode.

And as far as the services' convenience fee, which is contributing nearly 75% to our profit, so the -- more or less the question of the convenience fee remains the same barring INR1 crores or INR2 crores -- INR1 crores, INR2 crores or INR3 crores here and there. You can see our revenue from the convenience fee is nearly INR 200 crores per quarter. .

And the total revenue that we have collected from the Internet Ticketing towards convenience fee is around INR 802 crores in the entire year. So as of now, the booking remains the same, but we are focusing more on the non-convenience fee resources, which have now increased -- which are contributing to 33% of the total revenue of the Internet Ticketing, Internet Ticketing business.

Out of it, you can say the total revenue that we have earned through this and business and related business was nearly INR 1,200 crores. Out of which INR 802 crores, that is 67% was contributed by convenience fee, that is your Ticketing business. And the non- convenience fee business is around 33%, sir. So that was earlier, INR337 crores in the last financial year. This year, it is now almost touching the INR 400 crores where you find some growth.

And this growth has been mainly due to many factors. That is our loyalty program has also contributed. Our PG integration has also contributed. Our agent portion has also contributed. Our IT earning has also contributed. So when we see the revenues on the IT business it has to be seen in totality, not alone with the convenience fee, which is 82%. It may increase to 83%, 84% in the years to come. But at the same time, we need to focus upon the non -convenience fee resources, which are the added business -- ancillary business to the Internet Ticketing.

Our intention is to increase our revenue. They are more and more because -- and so not only to retain the Internet Ticketing, but to show us good growth by providing good services to the customer. Akshay Bhore : Got it, ma'am. And just a clarification, is it then fair to say that looking into the next couple of years, the growth in the Internet Ticketing segment would be largely through non-convenience fee and convenience fee could remain in the same sort of 200 lakhs per quarter kind of range? Is that...

Rajni Hasija: Volume growth will be there in the ticketing also. As the Internet improves in the country, some marginal improvement happens every year. It was a little fortunate or unfortunate in the COVID days, that growth, which was to happen in the years to come happened in 1 year. So

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that is why some variation, you can see -- some variation in the revenue mix was also seen just after the COVID. And it was a main bread earner during that period.

As the train increases, the capacity utilization increases. So like Vande Bharats are being guided and more and more days will be added to our revenue will also take us, will go on the higher side gradually. But the margins are going to be little at slower pace as compared to the COVID period. Yes, our focus is going to be more on the non-convenience fee where we are trying to hard, aggregator business is one.

And our other loyalty programs you might have noticed that we are doing a lot of loyalty programs and we have already opened with the three banks as compared to one previous bank. Then ticketing also we have recently launched the Char Dham ticketing with the other parties, other parties ticketing also, we are focusing. That Char Dham booking is very popular and our payment business is also there, and we are also focusing more on the B2C partner and of other businesses.

Akshay Bhore : Got it, ma'am. And then just one last question from my side. This is again on the convenience fee itself. And then you could have a decent visibility in terms of what is the likely passenger booked growth in the next couple of years? And as you understand, already the capacity of Indian Railways is so high that you -- by adding a few previous trains, it doesn't move the needle in terms of overall passengers' travel. Do you have a visibility in terms of what is the growth rate that you could see in terms of passengers booked or travelled in our case?

Rajni Hasija: As of overall picture of passenger travelled on Indian Railways. I can only tell you about the reserved segments. And if we see the...

Akshay Bhore : Yes, on the result segments as well. Do you have a visibility of what could be the passenger growth?

Rajni Hasija: I can tell you. First thing, if you see the January figure, the passengers travelled was 4.85 crores. But in February because of the winter, it has a seasonal variation also, the number of passenger reduced to 4.59 crores in the reserved segment. But in the month of March, it increased to 5.09 crores. And the number of our trains also decreased correspondingly in the month of February, but increased in the month of March.

So we have to see the seasonal variation also, but, yes, there is a scope as the new trains are being started, more and more customers are getting diverted from the other mode Festival rush is also there. The holiday rush is now happening. All trains are full. You will not get reservation in any of the trains these days because the trains are running with full bookings,

which is good news for all of us. The more booking, the more revenue to us. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Rohit Jain from Tara Capital Partners. Please go ahead.

Rohit Jain: So taking off from the last question, you said that on the ticketing side, most of the growth is going to be driven by non-convenience fee and convenience fee is going to be more or less stable, I mean, it could grow slightly, but the main growth is going to come from non-

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convenience fee. Can you tell us what is the difference in the margin profile between convenience fee and the non-convenience fee?

Rajni Hasija: In the convenience fee, when we talk of the -- you want me to tell you the productivity margins in that?

Rohit Jain: No, no. I mean, like I'm assuming that convenience fee would be your highest margin business. I mean pretty much as the platform business, everything is sort of flows to the bottom line. So just compare to with that like, EBIT margin had been anything?

Rajni Hasija : I got it. I got it. In fact the non-convenience fee, we will have better margins, better than convenience fee. I'll tell you how. Because while -- when we calculate the convenience fee, we need to pay to the trains also for maintaining the infrastructure. The entire infrastructure of that ticketing is costly, so their average expenditure though not as much, but it is certainly more than what we are going to spend

in the non-convenience fee resources.

Here, what we are doing, the infrastructure that has been already been placed, on top of that, these are the ancillary services, which is a total bonus business for IRCTC. So here, the expenditure is less.. Most of our businesses, like payment gateway, agent business, advertisement etc., their -- our expenditure is almost negligible because the infrastructure is already in place. I need not get any additional bandwidth. The only manpower, monitoring resources and the reconciliation expenditure is added to it. That is very meagre as compared to the other infrastructure expenditures that we normally do in the Internet Ticketing.

Rohit Jain: Understood. And just another related question to last question is that, I guess, about the previous participant might have been trying to ask is, as you said, most of the ticket -- trains are already running at full occupancy. It's difficult to get reservations. So which means pretty much Indian Railways working at peak capacity. And if you look at the budgetary announcement every year, the number of trains being added is the hardly anything as a percentage of the overall days.

So given that Internet penetration is pretty much at peak levels, I mean, in the near term 80% to 84% and all the trains are working at full capacity, so what will drive the growth in the ticketing volume? I mean, if you look at on a Y-o-Y basis, should we expect ticketing revenues to be sort of low single digit to flattish assuming no change in convenience fee.

Rajni Hasija: It may not be exactly flattish. It will have some seasonal variations and the festival variations, of course.

Rohit Jain: No, no. I'm talking on a Y-o-Y basis, like if we consider the full year, that will rule out the seasonality, right? I mean if we take the whole year versus the next year, the seasonality will adjust itself.

Rajni Hasija: Yes. There is some growth sector associated with the Internet Ticketing. And as the more and more awareness is happening, the growth [sino-cycle 0:35:02] curve may not be that sharper. It will go at -- still grow, but grow at a slow pace.

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Rohit Jain: Yes. So that's what I said. Is it fair to say that it would be low single-digit types?

Rajni Hasija: Sir, we have already come back 82%. There is going to be a growth, but growth will be at a little -- the sector will be a little less. And that is why we would be focusing more on the non-convenience fee resources. You can't presume that we have to -- we still have an off-line model available for persons who are not that literate. We should have because it is a services time Indian Railways has offered services from all the more Internet Ticketing is one.

There will be a transition of the customer from off-line mode to online mode like all businesses, which is also going to happen. So that transition, we will be a beneficiary. But at the same time, just to keep the momentum up, we would be focusing more and more on the other businesses. So that our total revenue from this segment, that is Internet segment remains on the top notch.

Rohit Jain: Understood. And can you just help us understand the, let's say, a stable or steady-state margin in the Catering business? That margin has fluctuated pretty sharply over the last few quarters. So going forward, what can we expect in terms of a stable margin for that business?

Rajni Hasija: Catering is now contributing nearly 41% of our revenue this financial year it has contributed. So our margins have been more or less same as we had earlier, that is 10% to 12%, depending upon segments. So giving margin not going -- it is going to be in that side also, except for the e-catering where we have a 15% margin.

Rohit Jain: Right. So more or less, going forward, also 10% to 12% should be the steady-state range for the Catering business.

Rajni Hasija: Yes. You can say, sir.

Rohit Jain: And just last question, what drove the sharp increase in the Tourism revenue quarter-on-quarter?

Rajni Hasija: You should be happy with that, sir?

Rohit Jain: No. Just trying to understand. We're happy, but we're just trying to understand.

Rajni Hasija: The domestic tourism is on its boom, right? And I think I would like to apply this out that IRCTC earlier was running into -- only into budget tourism and we were in the luxury tourism as well. We have come up with the new model of the business after Ministry of Railway has announced that the scheme called Bharat Gaurav scheme under Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat Scheme announced by Ministry -- Honorable Prime Minister has taken this initiative, and in this Ministry of Railways has announced the scheme Bharat Gaurav where we have taken 10 rakes. These 10 rakes have been customized and put it into the operations.

So this new segment has been added. Earlier we were operating only 80 trains in a year, 80 to 90 trains in a year in the budget segment. Now we would be running nearly 300 trains in a year. And each train is contributing to nearly INR 50 lakhs of our revenue. And out of which,

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yes, of course, some expenditure of the railway and IRCTC and the service provider is also there. But a good margin of 10% is left with us.

So you can say that we have operated many such trains. We did a lot of domestic tourism, and we competed with the open market, we could drive lot many customers to IRCTC and State Teertha also contributed into that, so we could goodwill and the results are in front of you.

And in the years to come, this Bharat Gaurav is going to add a revenue not less than INR 250 crores alone from this segment. But used to be nearly INR60 crores to INR 70 crores only in the previous year. So you can anticipate good growth in the tourism.

Rohit Jain : Understood. And just last question. Given that future growth is going to be driven more by, let's say, non-convenience fee, things like Bharat Gaurav and Catering, which are, let's say, 10% to 12% margin business, at what level should we expect the overall margins to settle? I'm assuming it's going to be lower than 33%, 34%, 36% that we are used to? So can you help us understand what would be the margins going forward?

Rajni Hasija: You can expect the same results, sir.

Rohit Jain: I mean even if the mix of non-convenience fee increases in the overall revenue mix, the margin is not going to come down?

Rajni Hasija: Yes. Yes, I agree, sir. It can be even better in the non-convenience fee, resources are doing pretty well and the Bharat Gaurav segment, the way it has picked up the market and the brand equity of the IRCTC has improved in this segment. And we are getting full cooperation everywhere and good number of bookings are happening, and the revenue in this segment put together is going to be high and the margins are also going to improve.

Rohit Jain: No, no, ma'am, what I'm trying to understand is the, let say, the Catering business and the Bharat Gaurav business, to set up a 10%, 12% margin business. So as their proportion in the overall revenue goes up, even though the absolute numbers might go up, but margins will settle lower, right?

Rajni Hasija: Yes. Likely things will be there. But at the same time, absolute number will go up. So the ultimate...

Rohit Jain: Yes, yes, I understand. I'm not asking that. I'm just trying to -- from a modelling perspective, I'm just trying to understand, is there a margin number that we are working with? Is there a visibility there? Is there some visibility there?

Rajni Hasija: If we are able to do even better in the non-convenience fee resources so that is going to compensate.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Rahul Jain. Please go ahead.

Rahul Jain : Congratulations on very good numbers. Ma'am, just a couple of things I need to check. Firstly, on the catering side, can we see all normalization related to that lean period peak period related reconciliation on catering license fee is done?

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Rajni Hasija: We have completed for the peak period, and for RSD trains, we have done. For the lean period, it is still on for the Mail/Express . We have not been able to complete that exercise because we started a little late. And we are still in process maybe in the lean period we will -- the team is going to complete that soon.

Rahul Jain : Okay. And regarding this...

Rajni Hasija: Rahul, you might have seen in the remarks that the invoices that we have seen some impact on the results also which are going to be on the -- which was on a good side. Accordingly, the demand notices was given to our license fees, many of them have disputed also we are resolving those disputes first before the money gets realized. So we are very much in the process and actively in the process.

Rahul Jain : And in the Ticketing business, since the 2S normalization is largely done with, what should be the growth potential here in the convenience fee side?

Rajni Hasija: Convenience fee will have -- the convenience fee as compared to the previous year, it has grown up because the number of passengers have gone up. The overall passengers travelled on Indian Railways is going to increase because many new trains have been added. And when you see new trains are being run during the season, festivals, extra trains are being operated.

So we have already seen the growth as compared to the previous year in spite of the fact we got second at mandatory provision associated in the quarter, first quarter itself, but more or less -- I think more or less uniform results were there. But as far as the growth is there, growth is going to be happen -- going to happen. It is going to happen more in the non-convenience fee, which has even better margins, so the overall earnings from this segment is going to be on a better side. That is what my -- our perception is.

Rahul Jain : Right. And if you could share some basic data on the convenience fee side, basically, average selling price for the quarter, mix of AC, mix of UPI, those kind of metrics?

Rajni Hasija: Yes, I'll certainly share. See, our total contribution in the last quarter, the quarter we have --

quarter 4 that we are discussing, the Sleeper Class has been 42.87%. The Second S is more or less at the pre-COVID level that is 12.52%. And the Third AC is around 28.29% and Second AC is about 6.93%, just very small amount. So this is the breakage as far as the class wise is concerned.

And the UPI transaction is contributing nearly 33% now. As you know, that the average UPI transaction in this year has been 33% as compared to the previous year when it was 31%. And before that is 24%. So the overall increase in the UPI transaction is also impacting this. So there -- that is what your -- I think I've answered your question.

Rahul Jain : Yes. Yes. And ma'am, on the non-convenience part within the ticketing, any 2, 3 key segments which are sizable, if you could quantify them and the drivers for them going forward?

Rajni Hasija: Yes. You will find the increase in the revenue in the loyalty program. And of course, I say the payment gateway business, you will see some improvement -- further improvement, then you

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will also see our results. Aggregator license comes through, then you will see further improvement in that business. And advertisement revenue has shown a good improvement where we have nearly INR 67.41 crores from brand advertising business. That growth may continue and we may do even better because this year is going to be very important. That is in the Internet segment.

But in the other segment, in the Tourism, yes, Bharat Gaurav is going to have. IRCTC has a very interesting mix of the revenue. It keeps on changing, but the overall absolute thing, as you know, Rahul, you are a better judge that we end up landing always in a good numbers. Maybe the revenue mix may change. So this year, the Tourism may also show a good improvement because earlier the revenue from the Bharat Gaurav type trains used to be nearly INR 60 crores.

Now, it is going to nearly INR 250 crores and the margins are going to increase. Absolute numbers also will increase.

The loyalty fee in the Internet Ticketing, we are going to show a jump and in E-catering we'll also show some improvement. Overall, there's going to be a good very good picture and very good future for our investors in IRCTC.

Rahul Jain : And one more question on the Tourism side. Can you share the metrics for Tejas in terms of revenue frequency?

Rajni Hasija: Tejas has done well this year. The overall revenue that we received from Tejas has been INR 155 crores. And operating expenses has been INR 130 crores. So put together, both Tejas has given a revenue -- net profit of INR 24.3 crores. And occupancy level of Ahmedabad Tejas has been nearly 81% and Lucknow Tejas has been nearly 69%.

Rahul Jain : 81% and 69% what you said, is it?

Rajni Hasija: Yes. That is occupancy level.

Rahul Jain : Right. And what's the situation on some of the businesses which are on the Tourism segment led by overseas traveller like Maharaja and Buddhists circuit?

Rajni Hasija: Maharaja has also done very well this year. Last year, it was with COVID. So we could get only INR2.84 crores when we run few charters. But this year, we have been able to get nearly INR55.38 crores from Maharaja, which is a good number and number of our pax that we have traveled is the highest in the country in the luxury segment. In the air ticketing also as compared to the earlier revenue of INR 8.54 crores in the previous year, we are having INR23.04 crores in this year.

So other business in the air ticketing also has done well. And this year the state tiertha segment has also picked up as compared to the INR 30 crores of the previous year. This year, we have done INR 153 crores. So entire -- put together, the Tourism business has given us revenue of INR 555.98 crores as compared to INR187.89 of the previous year. And we can expect more growth in this business because of the Bharat Gaurav being added in the fleet.

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Rahul Jain : Right. Just last bit on the state is, comment that you made, ma'am. I think we generally see some more traction in the election period. So do we expect this since general as well as some state elections has come.

Rajni Hasija: Like any other tourism product, it is also subject to seasonal variation, so I can only answer this at this time. Sir, it all depends on states, whether they want to spend their fund in this direction or not. But generally, people work in this direction. So we hope for the good.

Rahul Jain : And it's great being associated with you for so long. Thank you so much for your guidance through this period.

Rajni Hasija: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question comes from the line of Madhuchanda Dey from Money Control.

Please go ahead.

Madhuchanda Dey : Hello, ma'am. Yes. I have a couple of questions. One is a housekeeping question. What was the absolute number of tickets booked in FY '23?

Rajni Hasija: Just wait for a while, I have to look for the numbers. The total ticket you said booked when?

Madhuchanda Dey : FY '23.

Rajni Hasija: I'll get you to the numbers.

Ajit Kumar : 43 crores.

Rajni Hasija: 43 crores.

Madhuchanda Dey : 43 crores. Okay. And ma'am, this year's Bharat Gaurav revenue is INR 60 crores. Is that right?

Rajni Hasija: This year, the Bharat Gaurav train just started their operations. Earlier we were running the same segment in the name of Bharat Darshan and Pilgrim Special. That together was contributing not more than INR 60 crores, which is going to be now INR 250 crores to INR 300 crores with the 10 rakes that we have taken from Indian Railways on lease.

Madhuchanda Dey : Okay. That is your projection for FY '24?

Rajni Hasija: Yes, ma'am.

Madhuchanda Dey : Okay, ma'am. So you have answered all these questions very nicely on Internet Ticketing and also on the Tourism side. Am I audible?

Rajni Hasija: Yes, you are.

Madhuchanda Dey : Yes. So my question is what is your take on the growth in Catering and Railneer for the next 2 years? What will be the driver? And what kind of growth rate can we expect?

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Rajni Hasija: We would be on the positive side in the Railneer revenue as we would be starting our 2 plants very soon. We'll make sure and Bhubaneswar and Simhadri, we are going to start this .

Further, we are upgrading the capacity of the existing plant also, so we are going to increase our production. Secondly, we are going to improve our capacity utilization by doing some operational measures. So our performance in the Railneer is going to be better sized. As now we are producing nearly 15.52 lakh litres a day, which we would be increasing taking up to nearly 17 lakh litres per day by the end of this financial year.

Madhuchanda Dey : And by '25? And by '25, what kind of capacity will be there for Railneer?

Rajni Hasija: By '25, we would be -- we have ended all our plants, so would be meeting the entire requirement. Nearly 80% of the railway's requirement of the water will be met by all these measures that we are taking, then we will be serving nearly 18.5 lakh litre water in a day. So that will add a good amount of revenue to our stream.

Madhuchanda Dey : Got it, man. And what about Catering, what are the future drivers? What can we look forward to?

Rajni Hasija : There is a future driver in the name of a new train fleet that is coming up, that is Vande Bharat, which is a prepaid train. We know that there has been an announcement that many more new rakes are going to be inducted. So that is going to add a fleet to our revenue, one.

Secondly, the existing tenders which have not -- could not be done yet because of -- because we are small duration tender that we are trying to wind it up. And now we are focusing not only on the revenue side, on the operational side also so that we can provide better services to our customers and bring a good brand value to our businesses in addition to the revenue.

Madhuchanda Dey : So ma'am, my question is from these initiatives. One is Vande Bharat and another tender, what kind of incremental revenue are you looking at for FY '24 to start with? And again, for FY '25, what kind of growth can we expect?

Rajni Hasija: As and when the tenders are awarded, the revenue gets settled, ma'am.

Madhuchanda Dey : Yes, I understand. But if you could give us some colour on kind of growth that we are looking at?

Ajit Kumar : Numbers...

Madhuchanda Dey : Not numbers, but some idea about the kind of growth that...

Rajni Hasija: It is an open bidding process, ma'am, at times vendors bid very high, then you get a good numbers. At times, when the train doesn't -- is not having a good route, then it gets a less bid, too difficult to project. At times, the competition in 1 sector is very high you get a very, very high bid. So -- and then the other processes also there. So may be very difficult to predict. However, the growth will be there and a good amount of growth more than, I think, 10% is going to be -- we can anticipate. But once the segment which we should be -- we are focusing with e-catering, where we have already reached to the extent of 40,000 meals in a day, and we

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are already providing. And in quarter 4, the figure has been nearly 43,000 meals, and it is growing steadily.

We have also started booking to our agents. These are B2C agents which are there on our

website. And the number of our vendors with our food aggregator has also gone up. Number of food aggregators has also improved. The direct vendor number is also improving. So you can anticipate some growth in this segment as well.

Moderator : Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, due to time constraints, we have reached the end of question-and- answer session. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Rajni Hasija: A very good afternoon once again. It has always been pleasure talking to all the investors and all the participants here. Sharing our experiences with the IRCTC has been one part, but at the same time, what market things about us, and what are the queries of the market, we are more than happy to answer. Not only to the earnings call, we are always open to share our experiences and our thoughts in the investors call also.

So IRCTC is a very transparent and open organization and believes in the transparency as well.

So I welcome you all and all the investors to be part of this journey as you have been in the past and show your patronage to this company as usual.

Thank you very much and wishing you all the good health to you and your dear ones. Thank you, sir. Thank you once again.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of IRCTC, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us.

You may now disconnect your lines.

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Call: Sep 2023

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 August 17 , 202 3

BSE Limited

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Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “ Q1FY’24 Earnings
Conference Call ” held on August 10 , 2023 .
Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma’am,

In reference to our communication dated August 07 , 202 3, please find enclosed
herewith the transcript of “Q1 FY’2 4 Earnings Conference Call” held on August 10 ,
2023.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
For Indian Railway Catering and
Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a

“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited
Q1FY’24EarningsConferenceCall”
Aug 10, 2023

MANAGEMENT : Smt. Seema Kumar –CHAIRMANAND MANAGING
DIRECTOR –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. AJIT KUMAR – DIRECTOR , FINANCE AND CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN– DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS
LIMITED
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Rahul Jain: Thank you, guests. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q1 FY 2024 conference call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Ms. Seema Kumar, who is CMD of the company; and Mr. Ajit Kumar ji, who is Director (Finance) and CFO of the company. And, also, we have today with us Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar, who is Director (Catering Services); and Mr. K. K. Mishra ji, who is Director Tourism and Marketing .

I would like to hand over the conference call to IRCTC management to take the proceedings forward. Over to you.

Seema Kumar:

Good afternoon, everyone .I extend a very warm welcome to all of you for this con-call of IRCTC Limited for the Q1 of FY2024. As we are aware, IRCTC has already announced the unaudited financial results for the first quarter yesterday and the same have also been disclosed on both the stock exchanges.

I would now be giving a brief overview of Q1 FY 2024, which will be followed by the details of performance of our business segments by Director (Finance) and CFO Mr. Ajit Kumar. After that, we will be having question-and-answer sessions.

Q1 FY2024 has been a landmark year for the IRCTC with the revenues crossing the INR 1,000 crores quarterly mark for the first time since the inception of this company. And absolute revenue, EBITD and net profit before exceptional items also touching new high. Q1 FY2024 revenue was at INR 1,002 crores, implying a growth of 3.8% QoQ and 17.5% on YoY. The largest segment, Catering has been the main driver for this QoQ revenue growth. Importantly, this is also backed by the improvement of EBIT margin for the segment to 14.6% in Q1 as compared to 12% in YoY and 12.1% on QoQ.

The consolidated level, despite the loss in Tourism segment, due to a one-time adjustment of exceptional item of INR 51.9 crores towards provisioning of revised haulage charges, as mandated by the Ministry of Railways, for the Tejas train for the previous years. The EBITDA margin came at 34.2% as compared to 33.6% for QoQ and 37.6% YoY.

If we exclude this exceptional item of INR 51.90 crores for the provision of Tejas haulage charges, Tourism segment has also registered a profit.

Absolute EBITDA has also hit a new high at INR 343 crores before exceptional item. Net profit before exceptional item for Q1 FY24 came at INR 284 crores as compared to INR 253 crores in Q4 FY23 and INR 246 crores in Q1 FY23.

I would like to conclude my opening remarks by saying that IRCTC continues to demonstrate its resilient business model during the important post the COVID -19 pandemic. It is this resilience, combined with the commitment that will help the company to continue on its growth path in future as well.

Now, I will hand over the call to my colleague and our Director (Finance) and CFO, Shri Ajit Kumar, to brief you on the financial and segmental performance of the company. Thank you.

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Ajit Kumar: Good afternoon, everybody, and I hope you and your dear ones are in good health. .I shall first give a brief overview about Q1 FY '24 results, post which we'll have the question-and-answer session.

Q1 FY2024 revenue saw another quarter of good growth, both on quarter-over-quarter and year-over-year basis. Revenue of INR 1,002 crore when we marked the full-figure INR 1,000 crore, grew by 3.8% quarter-over-quarter and 17.5% year-over-year. Consolidated EBITDA margin improved quarter-over-quarter to 34.2% versus 33.6% and versus 37.6% given the change in revenue mix. The net profit before exceptional item for the quarter came at INR 284 crore versus INR 253 crores in Q4 FY 2023 and INR 245 crores in Q1 FY 2023.

Let us move to the now -- the different business segments of the company. The first one, the Catering. The Catering segment reported another quarter of strong revenue growth of 20.5%

quarter-over-quarter and 35.5% year-over-year to INR 477 crores and EBIT margin also saw a good improvement to 14.6% versus 12.1% quarter-over-quarter and 12% year-over-year.

The Internet Ticketing segment continued to demonstrate resilience amid conversion of reserved tourist tickets back to unreserved tickets during the pre-pandemic period. The revenue for the quarter was at INR 290 crores, which declined by just 1.7% quarter-over-quarter and 3.8% year-over-year. The EBIT margin for the quarter came at 82.7% versus 88.1% quarter-over-quarter and the 84.5% year-over-year.

The Tourism segment, it has seen the impact of seasonality, especially in the state of the business with revenue for the quarter at INR 142.5 crores, implying a decline of 30.2% quarter-over-quarter. Overall segment registered a growth of 23.8% on year-on-year basis. Given the decline in quarter-on-quarter revenue, the segment reported a loss at the EBIT level versus profit on quarter-on-quarter and year-on-year basis due to a one-time adjustment of one exceptional item of INR 51.9 crores towards provisioning of revised haulage charges of the previous year's for the Tejas train as mandated by the Ministry of Railways.

Rail Neer saw Q1FY2024 revenue of INR 92.2 crores, implying a growth of 31.4% quarter-on-quarter and 10.2% year-on-year. Reported EBIT margin of 13.2% versus 18.6% quarter-on-quarter and 11% year-on-year, due to increase in the production cost, especially the petroleum products. Further, the decrease in EBITDA in current quarter, that is Q1 also due to allocation of income, because the reversal of excess provision of PRP done in the last quarter.

Now, for Q1FY2024, the Capex was INR 101 crore. The net worth and cash and bank balances of company at the end of the quarter is INR 2,709 crores and INR 1,912 crores, respectively.

That brings to the end of the opening remarks. Now, we can straight way move to the question-and-answer session. Thank you.

Rahul Jain: Thank you, everyone, for that opening remark. First question is from Jinesh Joshi. You may please go ahead with your question, Jinesh.

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Jinesh Joshi: Thank you so much. There are two questions from my side. First is that, to what extent there has been a revision in the custody charges for the Tejas Express? And on what grounds are we seeking a waiver from Railways for earlier years?

Seema Kumar:

This is a charge, which has revised from the post-dated, that is from 13th August 2021 to 31st March 2023. This haulage indexation is notified by the Ministry every year. But for these two years, they have issued a surplus and revision in haulage charges from the August 2021 with – this letter was given to us only in the year 2023. So, we are not seeking any waiver. We have requested Ministry to reconsider, so that these revised charges should be made applicable only from the future date, not from the retrospective effect. We have made a representation and we are pursuing it with the Ministry of Railways.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. But would you like to call out a number in terms of how much the revision has been?

Seema Kumar: The amount has already informed, it is INR 51.9 crores for the period 13th August 2021 to 31st March 2023. This is the total amount, which has come to us as a liability. Thank you, Joshi.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. And, secondly, if I look at this announcement with respect to this INR 78 crores of investment for procurement of hardware and software, is this a part of our IT modernization plan that we had communicated earlier, or is this Capex over and above that?

Seema Kumar: I would

like to advise you, this is a part of the Capex plan, which we have advised. This is the upgradation of this system and we had projected this expenditure in this year as Capex.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. Just one last question. I think after reversal in 2S seating, the monthly average non-suburban traffic used to be in the band of about 6 crores odd per month. But if I look at the July month figure, which is available on the website of Indian Railways, the number has increased to about 7 crores odd. So, is there anything specific with respect to this jump, which you would want to highlight?

Seema Kumar: See, for this quarter, which is we are talking, April to June, 2023 this 2S –I will just give you a little background, this 2S reservation was reversed by Ministry in the month of February 2022, right and its implementation took some time because of date of booking and it was implemented in middle of the June, July 2022, right. So in this quarter, April to June, which is under consideration, The total reserved 11.56 crores tickets were booked in the first quarter of FY 23 and this quarter is 10.41 crores that is Internet Ticket has gone down substantially for my system. But thank fully after the looking at the total reserved and unreserved ticket, my perform mance share of e-tickets has gone up. In Q1FY24, shar e of total e-tickets has increased. Last year, it was 79.64% a nd this year it is 80.86%. So whatever pies available to me for reservation, this is increasing.

JineshJoshi:

Thank you.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Our next questions come from the line of Moksha Shah . Moksha, you can probably unmute yourself and ask your question. Thank you.

Moksha Shah: Hi. Thank you for the opportunity. So, my question was on Catering business. Catering and Rail neer business, especially Catering, the share for the overall revenue has increased. It was 41% and now it has increased to 47%.So, you think –how has this driven? Is there any specific reason? And how do you expect this to grow going forward? Do you expect it to remain high as a percentage of total revenue?

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Seema Kumar: Yeah. Ms. Shah, I would give you the reason why it is seeing the upward trend, see in pre - COVID we had catering in 891 trains. I'm talking about 2019 pre -COVID scenario. Now, at present, post-COVID, I'm talking as on end of July, 2023 we have provided catering services in 1,209 trains. So, we are providing more and more trains and around more than 200 contracts are in pipeline. This is the reason and for further growth, we are working on the re-assessmen t of sale, which is mandated by the Ministry that would also give us the further fillip in catering earnings for IRCTC.

Moksha Shah: Also, if you could provide me the number of daily average ticket f or this quarter, quarter one FY2024? How was this in comparison to the last year same quarter?

Seema Kumar:

You seeing for the details of reserved ticket segment .Total tickets booked in the month of April, is 3.37crores ,, 3.56crores in the month of, May and 3.49 crores in the month of june, 2023. In the Q1FY24 and in the Q1FY23 were 11.56 crores. This is the total ticket booked by the IRCTC in this quarter and the same quarter to the last year by the IRCTC.

Rahul Jain: Okay. Thank you. Next, I'll take a question from the chat window. The participant is keen to understand there is a loss in the Tourism segment, if you could explain more about why it happened and what is the gross contribution or gross margin?

Seema Kumar:

Yeah. As I mentioned in my opening remarks, this Tourism segme nt has taken a hit because of around INR52crores, on account of e xceptional item towards revised haulage charges of previous years for Tejas trains as per the revised charges advised by the Ministry

of Railways.

If I take out this exceptional item, then my Tourism sector has also made profit.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. I will take another question from the chat, which comes from Madhu chanda Dey .

Madhuchanda: What is the breakup of Internet ticketing between convenience fees? What is the total number of tickets sold?

Seema Kumar: Tickets sold, I already informed in the previous question. I can tell you about the convenience fee. In the Q1 of FY 2024, the total convenience fee earned is INR198 crores.

Madhuchanda: What is the breakup of other segment within the Ticketing, Internet Ticketing segment other than the convenience fee?

Seema Kumar: Convenience fee is INR198.48crores,then service charges stand at INR0.13crores, service charges other than the I-Ticket is INR19.48crores.Then agent commission received is INR 17.74crores .License fee earned from the call center is INR0.06crores.Our Integrated 139And Rail Madad is I NR2.05crores. Agent login authentication INR1.97crores.Inquiry charges are

INR0.8crores and Chatbot charges areINR0.32crores.If we total everything in the Internet Ticketing, this comes toINR290 crores.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. The next question is from Rohit.

Rohit:

Why the margin in the Ticketing segment has gone down sharply?

Seema Kumar:

Yeah. I would rephrase it. As we know that 2S ticketing was given to IRCTC during COVID, which was reversed by Ministry of Railways in the month of February 2022, and it was implemented up to July. So, whatever you are seeing, as I read it earlier, there is a sharp decline in number of tickets in passenger of 2S segment, if we compare it to the Q1 of last year. But this effect was only till the middle of July 2022. Now onwards, we will be at par with Q2 of 2022.

Rohit: How many trains the catering services are provided by IRCTC? Is there any other impact because of the food inflation to our Catering revenues?

Seema Kumar:

As I stated earlier, as on July 31st, 2023 we are providing catering services in 1,209 trains as compared to pre-COVID of 891 trains. And since this tariff is fixed by Ministry of Railways, right now, we are providing Catering at the same charges which were notified by the Ministry of Railways in 2019.

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Rahul Jain:

Thank you. Another question from the chats, can you explain about what is the revenue breakup from own plant versus PPP model in the Rail Neer segment?

Seema Kumar:

Sure. The total we have 16 plants, out of which 4 are departmentally owned and 12 are PPP model. And, in the pipeline, we have 4 more, which would be commissioning very soon, 3 in this year and 1 PPP plant next year. It will go into FY 2024-2025. Now, as far as revenues are concerned, I can give the production value. In terms of revenue, we would share it, because this is a detailed item. See, I can give you a lump sum figure of Rail Neer. Details of PPP and department owned, we'll be sharing it later, because we don't prepare separate profitability statement for owned plants and PPP plants. But in the Rail Neer in this quarter, we have earned INR90.54 crores from the sale of the Rail Neer and INR 1.61 crores as license fee, so total my revenues from this Rail Neer segment for the quarter under consideration is INR 92.15 crores.

Rahul Jain: Right. The follow-up question on this is what is the total number of plants? What is the capacity at this point? And what is the utilization? And any upcoming plant later in this year?

Seema Kumar: As I said, total 16 plants are operational today with a capacity of 15,52,000 liters per day and there are 04 more plants in pipeline, out of which three are expected to commence in this year and another one will go in the next

financial year. The total capacity with these four plants will become 18,40,000 liters per day.

Rahul Jain: Thank you and there is another question from participant, who wishes to understand when -- What other plan on the Golden Chariot? Do we plan to start that?

Seema Kumar: See, Golden Chariot is a luxury Train, which is owned by the Government of Karnataka Tourism and we are in the partnership with them for operation of this train. This year, they are already advertising some of the itineraries and we are in touch with them, and we hope to grow the business on this model.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Next, we'll take question from the participants who are online. The next questions Come from the line of Deepesh Lakhani .

Deepesh Lakhani: Yeah. Thank you. So, I just wanted an update on the payment aggregator license and also iPay revenues in this quarter?

Seema Kumar: On the iPay platform, number of payment transactions handled during this quarter is 1.54 crores. It has increased by 12.94% over the previous quarter and by 36% increase over the previous year. Payment aggregator license is in the process of getting this license from RBI, and as recommended by RBI, we are in the process of forming a subsidiary for this iPay license.

Deepesh Lakhani: Okay. Okay. Also, revenues for the Tejas trains and its occupancy level?

Seema Kumar:

For Tejas - there are two Tejas LJM-New Delhi Tejas and ADI –MMCT. For this quarter, the occupancy of LJM -New Delhi Tejas train has been 72.8% and for ADI-MMCT Tejas, the occupancy has been 89.2%. And if we see revenue combined together for these two trains is INR 45.89 crores.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Next, we take a question from Devang from IDBI Capital.

Devang:

Hi. Thank you for taking my questions. And there are two questions. One is that, what led to the increase in Catering margins this quarter? What were the key drivers? And second one is, what could be the trajectory of Tourism margins, considering that now revised haulage charges will be applicable for Tejas ?

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Seema Kumar:

See, Catering, as I told you, we have increased the number of trains on which we are providing the catering services. We are way ahead even the pre-COVID scenario. That has increased my Catering margins. As I answered in the previous question, pre -COVID in 2019 we only were serving 891 trains, today I stand on 1,209 trains and 200 additional trains are in pipeline. This has resulted into my margins increasing in Catering segment.

As far as Tourism is concerned, Tejas is only two trains . IRCTC is having 10 trains from Indian Railways for Bharat Gaurav Scheme Tourism Train that is my biggest market now. In addition to this, I also run State Tirth Special . So Tourism segment, we are having many products. Tejas is just one part of it. And I'm very confident that we will do better in Tourism segment in the coming season. As we all know, tourism sector as an industry in India is a seasonal thing. It comes it picks up from September mid and goes up to February, which is a peak of this. So, I'm confident that we will do much better in Tourism segment in the coming quarters.

Devang: So, would we be seeing similar margins which we saw for FY2023 overall in Tourism considering the ups and downs?

Seema Kumar: Yes. We can and we are hopeful that we'll be able to meet this.

Rahul Jain: Okay. Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rohit Jain.

Rohit Jain: My question was on the Catering side. So, you mentioned the number of trains that you are currently providing catering services to. I just wanted to understand what is the total number of trains potentially that we can increase it to? Like, I mean, in the next six months

show how much can that increase by?

Seema Kumar: See, total Mail/Express trains as on date on Indian Railways are around 2,000 odd pairs. When I say pairs, it is one coming and going. We have around 2,000 pairs of trains on Indian Railways. Out of which, the trains having pantry car or having run of more than eight hours , we are looking for providing catering services. That number comes around 1,500 odd pairs. So, we have already reached 1,209 trains. Now, we would be working on the remaining trains. Also, we would be revising the license fee as mandated by Ministry with effect from November, 2019. So, we are looking for a good trajectory in the Catering business.

Rohit Jain: Right. So, as you said, we are already at 1,200 and potential, currently, as it stands is about 1,500 trains. So, we can increase it by another 200, 300 and then we would be pretty much at our, let's say, full capacity as far as providing catering services is concerned?

Seema Kumar: No, no. We are also in the -- like, Indian Railways always announcing new trains. You know how Vande Bharat trajectory is going on. And then we did always a program of India Ministry of Railways to announce new trains, announce new services, increase the frequency of trains, extension, election specials, we have lot of scope to do the Catering business.

Rohit Jain: Fair enough. And my second question, which again somebody asked but was not clear, was, given the recent increase in vegetable prices, especially tomato and other things, which have really increased a lot and given the fact that our tariffs are fixed at 2019 levels, what sort of an impact would that have on the Catering margins going forward?

Seema Kumar: Right now, I can say that licensee is committed as per contract to provide the catering services on the tariff issued by the Ministry of Railway in 2019. That is the contract condition, and Licensee bound to give me this. So as far as my revenues are concerned, they are absolutely protected.

Rohit Jain:

So, basically, you are saying that, this has to be taken by the licensee and basically, as IRCTC, you don't have to suffer any of that?

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Seema Kumar:

No, no. I'm not saying that. I'm not saying that. I'm saying whenever we—when the contract was signed between IRCTC and licensee, he was aware what services at what cost have to be given. So, we are continuing with the services with the same tariff as notified by the Ministry of Railways.

Rohit Jain:

Understood. And my second question is on the growth potential. Given that we are already at pretty decently penetrated levels as far as the e-ticketing is concerned in India and the fact that the number of passenger growth in Railways in India is low to bids in single digit at best. So -- and the number of trains added in the country also is pretty low, as you know, as -- in comparison to the stock of the train that is already there. So, in the core segment of ticketing, should we expect the growth rate apart from any tariff revision to be in the mid to low -single digit? Is that the right understanding?

Seema Kumar: No, no. We are working -- we are expecting, rather shifting more number of people on e-ticketing. Because right now we stand at, say, 80.86% have booked through e-ticketing. So, without efficient services up-gradation of our systems more -- we are hoping that we -- more Number of people will shift towards e-ticketing.

Rohit Jain:

Ma'am, I understand that. But given the nature of the country and a lot of the population is still rural and uneducated, is there a level at which you think that e-ticketing sort of maxes Out in the near term? It cannot be 100%

Seema Kumar:

Because if you see with the IRCTC app, we are hav

ing -- seeing with IRCTC app being so

popular, I'm 100% sure that people are -- and with this government's by 5G penetration and strengthening of Internet facility right up to the village level, I'm -- we are hopeful that more number of people will shift to the e-ticketing. And, also, with new trains being announced with the extension of services, with the increase in frequency of train, number of people will Increase on Indian Railways .

Rohit Jain: Fair enough. And just last question from my side .Is there any discussion on any revision as far as the Rail Neer prices are concerned or ticketing convenience fee and the sharing with the Government ? Is there any discussion on renegotiations on that front?

Seema Kumar: We can only request or make a reference to Ministry of Railways. So, Rail Neer, we have written, and we would be pursuing it with the Ministry of Railways.

Rohit Jain: But no communication from their side as yet?

Seema Kumar:

Soon. This is in the pipeline. We have only made a reference and now we will be pursuing it. I cannot give any kind of a commitment on behalf of Ministry here.

Rohit Jain:

Okay. Fair enough. Thanks a lot for answering my question. I really appreciate it. Thank you.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. At this point, I'll take couple of questions from the chat window. There is a question, in terms of why the revenue, of the non-ticketing part of the revenue have declined on a Y-o-Y basis?

Seema Kumar:

I would request this question to be further clarified, so that I can give the relevant answer.

Rahul Jain:

So, basically, the question, if I understood it right, is about, if you look at the non-convenience fees part of the Internet Ticketing, that revenues have declined from INR100 odd crore to INR91 crores, what is the reason for decline in the non-convenience fee part of the Ticketing segment?

Seema Kumar: See, the UPI transaction share, it has increased. It was 3.84 crores in the Q1 of last year, now it has become 3.93 crore transactions. So, what happens with this hike of transactions, my UPI transaction has reduced convenience fee from INR 15 and INR 30, it goes down to INR10 and INR15 for Sleeper and AC, correspondingly. So, number of transactions are increasing on UPI platform and my corresponding convenience fee is little going down. And even there is a slight hit in the agent business, because if we see FY2023, it was INR37 crores and in this quarter is INR 32.9 crores.

Moderator: Thank you. This next question is from Naman Jain.

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Naman Jain: What is the mix of tickets sold in terms of 2S, SL class and different classes? Thank you.

Seema Kumar: See, for 2S ticket, April to June last year total 2S tickets 3.14 crores were booked through our online system out of total tickets 11.56 crores booked online. . And for this quarter April to June, 2023 total 2S tickets 1.33 crores booked out of total tickets 10.41 crores booked online. So, a number of tickets totality for 2S has gone down. This is for 2S tickets.

Rahul Jain: There is a follow-up, which is like what is the breakup between AC & non-AC tickets during that quarter?

Seema Kumar: For this quarter, if we see, this is a 484 lakh tickets booked in AC segment and for non-AC segment it is 558 lakhs. . Q1 of last year, for AC, it was 404 lakhs and for non-AC it was 754 lakhs.

Rahul Jain:

Okay. Thank you. This question is—large part of the question is, what is the UPI share in terms of ticketing?

Seema Kumar: So, UPI, as just mentioned in the previous question, it has increased the overall share. See, UPI transaction were last year 3.84 crores, it has increased to 3.93 crores. So, its share is 35.3% last year and this year it is 37.0%.

Rahul Jain:

Thank you. At

this point, we'll take questions from the participant live on the platform. Next question comes from the line of Rahul

Rahul: Yeah. Thank you so much for the opportunity. I would like – I have two questions. First is, any thought process by IRCTC for selling up its consumer data as it can generate additional revenue to IRCTC in digital world? And second is, any future prospectus of -- including even freight ticket booking business to IRCTC from Indian Railways, because the freight business also -- to rapidly expanding in the country?

Seema Kumar: So, IRCTC is not right now planning monetization of this data, because this data is of the passengers of Indian Railways. And as far as air ticketing is concerned, we have another segment where we deal with the air ticketing segment in tourism sector. Numbers of air tickets booked in this quarter are 4.77 lakh and the last year Q1 was 4.5 lakhs. So, you see this growth of 5% if we see Q1 as compared to the Q1 of last year. And if I see Q4 of 2022-2023, it is a growth of 3.66%. These are the air tickets being booked by the -- on IRCTC platform.

Rahul: Yeah. A part from the air tickets, I would also want to know what about the rail freight, which is Currently done only by Indian Railways. Any future prospectus where —we can also book

freight bookings, rail bookings from IRCTC?

Seema Kumar: That is another application, which is hosted in FOIS. Ministry is doing directly through the freight operation system. IRCTC as of now has no mandate apart from catering, tourism and e-ticketing.

Rahul: Okay. Just wanted to know if we can add this business in the future, which can be remunerative for IRCTC?

Seema Kumar: Only if when Ministry decides. Thank you.

Rahul Jain:

Thank you. Next, I will take a question from the chat window. Ma'am – the question is, ma'am, comparatively from Q2, Q1 of FY2022, revenue in this quarter have been weak despite so much demand in the tourism, what is leading to -- for this kind of a revenue?

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Seema Kumar: See, in the Tourism segment, as we have discussed before, there is a profit. Only thing is this exceptional item, which is INR 52 crores, which have come from the Ministry. If I take out this exceptional item, which has been in the Tourism segment, our revenues are up by -- there is a profit in Tourism segment as well.

Rahul Jain:

Thank you. The next question is regarding what are the prospects of Vande Bharat train, once all of this program goes through, what is the increase in the Internet Ticketing potential of the business?

Seema Kumar: Vande Bharat is also one kind of train, which is available in the reserve segment for ticketing. So, this inventory gets added to already available inventory for the ticketing. So Vande Bharat is already continuously being added and there is a very ambitious plan of the Government of India for having more number of Vande Bharat in the coming future. So, this will add to my prospects of e-ticketing doing better. And this would also give us the additional opportunity for catering services when the new trains are added, as well as Rail Neer. So, my e-ticketing, catering, Rail Neer entire segment will see a boost as and when these Vande Bharat's are being added by the Ministry of Railways.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. The next question is related to Data Protection Bill which has been passed, it will become law sooner. Now, IRCTC plan for data monetization, what will be the impact for that, if you could give any brief on that?

Seema Kumar: See, as I told you, this data is -- belongs to the passenger of Indian Railways and IRCTC is fully committed to follow whatever the Act is passed by the Government of India.

Rahul Jain:

Okay. Next question

on is, are we looking to bid—this is from Utkarsh Maheshwari. Are we looking to bid for Vande Bharat like that of Tejas Tourism business?

Seema Kumar:

No. Tejas was one of the only segments, which was, given to IRCTC by Ministry of Railways. Vande Bharat is like other Mail/Express, Super fast trains and Premium segment. So, this will - we would be doing the Ticketing, Catering and Rail Neer services only in these Vande Bharat as things stand today.

Rahul Jain:

Thank you. The next question is on the lean period related, is the reconciliation on the Catering business regarding the lean period and normal period has been done with? Or is there any more scope left in terms of any license fee revision in any contract?

Seema Kumar: So, this is going on and we would be finishing. We are doing it on priority and may be it will take a month more, and then we'll raise the demand and realize it. This process is on.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. The next question from M.S. Vinodh.

Ms. Vinodh: What about the RSD train, any revenue and profit breakup you can share about it?

Seema Kumar:

Say, for one particular segment, I would be taking out the details and my CRO will be sharing it with the person asking the question on mail. See, I can tell you the turnover, right. Turnover in this quarter is INR246 crores for RSD trains and as compared to Q1 of last year this was INR 201 crores. This is a turnover of RSD trains.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Deepesh. Deepesh you may unmute your line and ask your question.

Deepesh Lakhani: Yeah. So, as you mentioned earlier in this call that four new plants are in the pipeline, so does it include Vijayawada and Bhubaneswar branch, which you mentioned in the previous call?

Seema Kumar: Yes. These four upcoming plants are Bhubaneswar, Kota, NTPC Simhadri and Vijayawada.

Deepesh Lakhani: Okay. Okay. So, like, when is it going to be operational?

Seema Kumar: See, we are looking for these plants at Bhubaneswar, Kota and NTPC Simhadri, to be commissioned by end of this calendar year and Vijayawada will go into the Q1 of the next year, next financial year.

Deepesh Lakhani: Okay. Okay. So, all of these are the PPP model?

Seema Kumar: Yes. All these are PPP models.

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Rahul Jain: Thank you. The next question from the chat window is related to what are the prospects we see in The Tourism segment? And, overall, what are the potentials from various segments—since all this pricing related normalization has happened, what are the next few growth triggers? Thank you.

Seema Kumar: See, as I informed in the previous question, IRCTC has taken 10 rakes from Indian Railways for running Tourist circuit trains under the policy of Bharat Gaurav Tourist Trains. So, we are in the planning with these 10 rakes under the right to use charges, which has been taken from the Ministry of Railways, we are looking for a healthy growth in the tourism sector.

Rahul Jain: And what could be the growth trigger in other segments, other than Tourism segment?

Seema Kumar:

See, we have already -- this thing -- as per the announcement of Ministry of Railways, around 475 Bharat -- Vande Bharat trains are going to be added in next three years. So, if these 475 Vande Bharat trains are added in the fleet of Indian Railways, IRCTC is a natural thing to provide catering services, e-ticketing, RailNeer, so these are the impacts we are looking for our Business of IRCTC.

Rahul Jain: Thank you Madam. What is the cycle for wage revision for our business? And when it will be effective?

Seema Kumar: For IRCTC, wage revision is done every 10 years. The last revision was done in 2017, so next revision is being only in 20

27.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Next question is from the chat—from the platform. The question is from the line of Ratan. Ratan, please you may unmute your line and ask your question.

Ratan: Sure. Thanks for the opportunity, ma'am. I have a question that our e-ticketing revenues have been flat over the last 15 months, so my question is, there's been high inflation over the last couple of years, when we are likely to raise convenience fee?

Seema Kumar: As of now IRCTC is not looking for revision of the convenience fee but as far as e-ticketing business is concerned, we are seeing a plateau, because a lot of infra work is going around Indian Railways. As you are aware, Indian Railways are adding new tracks, so much of Infra—INR 24,000 crores has been given for new infra work on Indian Railways. Since these have been done on priority, you have a lot of NIs going on. So, this temporary and DFCCIL works under completion so track linkage is going on. I must say, this diversion or little bit of discontinuity in what you're seeing in plateau, with DFCCIL coming up and number of freight trains going on the DFCCIL, we will have a line capacity to win the passenger trains, and which will ultimately result in more passengers traveling on Indian Railways and leading to increased share of e-ticketing.

Ratan:

Yeah, ma'am, but the convenience fee is pretty low, INR10, INR15. I think it doesn't because if you look at our other revenues, which are—which have lower margins, it is important to balance it out by raising prices?

Seema Kumar: See, currently, we are having good profit around 80% profit in e-ticketing, so there is no basis for increasing further this convenience fee and putting burden on the Indian Railways' passenger.

Ratan: All right. And can you map out the -- what is the e-ticketing revenue that can happen for per Vande Bharat train?

Seema Kumar: We need to work out the projection for Vande Bharat outcome still, because train wise e-ticketing profiling needs to be done and we would be sharing it soon with you.

Rathan: All right. Thank you. Thank you. That's all from my side.

Rahul Jain: Thank you .This was the last question f or the session today. I would now request IRCTC management to give their final remark.

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Ajit Kumar: Thanks for this opportunity to us also, because we keep on want to learn. As investors and on the behalf of investors, whatever you say, so we will try that within the policy guidelines, we want to follow it on taking the community to greater heights. And if there is any other question and if more details, any more specific details or data, so everything we have, we are all totally transparent, so please send one mail ,then we will ensure that everything is to sent to you.

Thank you very much.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Thank you, all.

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Call: Nov 2023

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 November 14, 2023

BSE Limited

1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
"Exchange Plaza", C -1, Block -G,
Bandra- Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of "Q2FY'24 Earnings
Conference Call" held on November 8, 2023.
Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated November 3, 2023, please find enclosed
herewith the transcript of "Q2FY'24 Earnings Conference Call" held on November 8,
2023.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
For and on behalf of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a

IRCTC Limited
IRCTC Limited
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call

Event Date / Time : 8/11 /2023, 1
Event Duration : 44 mins 26 secs

CORPORATE PARTICIPANTS:

Ms. Seema Kumar
Chairman and Managing Director

Mr. Ajit Kumar
Director – Finance and Chief Financial Officer

Mr. Lokiah Ravikumar
Director – Catering

Mr. K. K. Mishra
Director – Tourism and Marketing

Q&A PARTICIPANTS:

1. Jinesh Joshi : Prabhudas
2. Siddharth Agrawal : Systematics
3. Rohan Nagpal : Helios Capital Asset Management

4. Rohith Jain : Tara Capital
5. Ankit Agarwal : Individual Investor
6. Madhuchanda Dey : MC Pro
7. Deepesh Lakhani : Dolat Capital

1 Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call
/2023, 16:00 Hrs.
secs

CORPORATE PARTICIPANTS:

Managing Director
Chief Financial Officer
Tourism and Marketing
Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Ltd
Systematics
Helios Capital Asset Management
Tara Capital
Individual Investor
MC Pro
Dolat Capital
08.11.2023
IRCTC Limited 2 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call
Moderator

Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the IRCTC Limited Q2 FY 24 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen – only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation conclude. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing * and then 0 on your touch tone phone. Please note that this call is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital .Thank you and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain

Thank you. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q2 FY24 conference call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Ms. Seema Kumar, who is CMD of the company; and Mr. Ajit Kumar ji, who is Director Finance, and CFO of the company. And we also have Dr. Lokiah Ravi kumar , who is Director of Catering ; and Mr. K.K.Mishra ji , who is Director for Tourism and Marketing segment. And now I would like to hand conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you please.

Seema Kumar

Good afternoon, everyone. I'm Seema Kumar, CMD here. At the beginning, I would like to extend a very warm welcome to all the participants for the con call of IRCTC Limited for the quarter ending 30th September 2023. Yesterday, the company had announced the unaudited financial results for the Q2 FY24 and then same has been advised to both the stock exchanges as well.Now, I will give a brief overview of Q2 FY24 followed by the Director of Finance and CFO, who will give the details of performance of various business segments, following which, we shall have the question-and-answer session.

In Q2 FY24, the company h

as reported revenue just under INR 1,000 crores mark as INR 995.3 crores, which is a growth of 23.5% YoY and almost at par on QoQ basis. The largest segment Catering as well as Tourism have been the main driver of the YoY revenue along in this year.I'm very happy to report that almost all the segments have reported an improvement in EBIT margin both on YoY as well as QoQ basis.Absolute EBITDA has also hit a new high at INR 366.6 [ph] crores, [Inaudible 00:02:53].The company reported a net profit of INR294.67 [ph] crores in September quarter of FY24, making an increase of 30.36% from INR226.3 crores in Q2 FY23.

Net profit is the highest ever profit registered by the company in the history of IRCTC in this quarter. The Board of Directors of the company has declared an interim dividend of INR 2.5 equity share for a face value of INR 2 per share for FY24 which is 125% of paid-up share capital which stands at INR 160 crore. At that consolidated level, EBITDA margin stands at 36.8% vis-à-vis 37.8% YoY and 34.2% QoQ basis. Here, I would like to conclude my opening remarks by wishing you and your dear ones are very

IRCTC Limited 3 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call happy and prosperous Diwali. Now, I will hand over this call to my colleague and our Director,

Finance, and CFO, Shri Ajit Kumar to brief you on the financial and segmental performance of the company. Thank you.

Ajit Kumar

Hi everyone your dear ones are in a good health. I shall, first, give a brief overview about Q2 FY 24 results, post which we shall have the question-and-answer session. Q2 FY24 revenues saw another quarter of good growth. Revenue of INR995.3 crores grew by 24% year-over-year and on quarter-over-quarter basis and it's almost at par. Consolidated EBITDA margin improved QoQ to 36.8% versus 34.2% quarter-over-quarter and 37.8% year-over-year given the change in revenue mix. Net profit after tax for the quarter came at INR294.7 crore versus INR 226 crore in Q2 FY23 and INR 232.2 crores Q1 FY 24.

Now let us move to the business segments of the company, the Catering segment. It reported a 29% YoY growth in revenue to INR 431.5 crores through on QoQ basis and it declined by 10% due to lean season in the Q2 which is a usual scene we have seen in the earlier years. However, I would like to highlight that, Q2 FY24 revenue run rate is higher than the best quarter of FY23, which was Q4 FY23 by 9%. Importantly, the EBITDA margin continued to report good improvements to 17.2% versus 14.6% quarter-over-quarter and 10.6% YoY basis.

The Internet Ticketing segment, this continued demonstrate the resilient amid conversion of reserved tourist tickets back to unreserved tickets during the pre-pandemic period and the revenue for the quarter was at INR 327.5 crore growing by 9% YoY and 13% QoQ, and EBITDA margin for the quarter came at 83.7% versus 82.7% QoQ and 84.2% YoY.

The next segment is Tourism and State Teertha, that segment saw strong growth in revenue for the quarter at INR 161.4 crores, implying a growth of 63% YoY and 13% QoQ. Given the revenue growth this segment reported positive EBITDA margin of 3.6% versus a loss both on QoQ and YoY basis.

And the last segment, Rail Neer saw Q2 FY24 revenue of INR 78 crores, implying a growth of 4% YoY and decline of 19% QoQ, reported EBITDA margin of 12.9% versus 7.5% YoY and 13.2% QoQ. For Q2 FY24, the cash and bank balances and net worth of the company at the end of the quarter is INR 2,026 crores and INR 2,846 crores respectively. I wish that happy and prosperous Diwali to all of you. Now, we can straight way move to the question – and –answer session. Thankyou.

Q&A

Moderator

Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. Anyone who wishes to ask a question, may press * and 1 on your touch tone telephone. If you wish to remove yourself from the question queue, you may press * and 1 again. Participants are requested to use handse

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IRCTC Limited 4 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call while asking a question. Ladies and gentlemen, we will wait for a moment while the question queue

assembles. The first question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi from Prabhudas Liladher Private Limited.

Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi

I have a question on the Catering segment. So, I think in the month of September, we made an announcement that IRCTC will manage Catering facilities in all coaches and trains that are booked on the full tariff rate. So, first, if you can just speak about the opportunity size that we target over here. And also, what kind of incremental revenue do we foresee from this arrangement per se?

Seema Kumar

Actually, this full tariff rate, FTR trains, these are train on demand booked by the party. So, there is not a fixed kind of a target we can fix, but I can give you the kind of YoY demand we have. This is not a very huge market, but it's a big responsibility, because it has been given entirely to the IRCTC to do the business. Last year, there were roughly 100-odd trains which are booked on full tariff rates. So, looking at the same kind of a traffic or maybe marginally depending on the market demand. So, these trains are booked by the parties for the movement on special occasions et cetera.

Jinesh Joshi

So, in nutshell, the opportunity size is not big enough, right?

Seema Kumar

Right now, it can't be ascertained, but I can tell you what is the trend for the previous years. We will know by the end of the year or maybe during the course of discussion, we will let you know by mail the details of number of trains run and the size of the pie we are looking at through the FTR trains.

Jinesh Joshi

Sure. My second question is also with respect to the Catering segment. So, can you share how has been our response with respect to the tie-up with Zomato that we announced sometime back?

What is the fee per order that we get over here? And I believe the current arrangement is limited to five stations, so do we plan to go Pan India over here?

Seema Kumar

Yes, definitely. This is just a pilot we have tied-up, because here we are dealing not per meal, we are dealing with the volumes. So, we have come up with a pilot MoU, pilot agreement with the Zomato to start with. And if it is successful, we will definitely like to go on the Pan India level.

IRCTC Limited 5 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Jinesh Joshi

What is the fee per order, if you can share?

Seema Kumar

We have just started in October, but it will be lump sum INR 40 per order.

Jinesh Joshi

One last question from my side, if you can just share the number of ticket booked and the convenience fee for the quarter.

Seema Kumar

Yes, sure. Just give me a moment, please, I will give you. Convenience fee for this Q2 of 2023-24 is INR 220.98 crores. And as compared to Q2 2022-23 was INR 200.23 crores, which is a growth of 11% QoQ and 10% YoY.

Jinesh Joshi

Number of tickets book, if you can just share that number.

Seema Kumar

Yeah, tickets booked also I can share. We have number of ticket books for the Q2 2023-24 are 1,164 lakh as compared to 1,069 lakh in Q2 of 2022-23.

Moderator

Thank you. Next question is from the line of Sidharth Agrawal from Systematic. Please go ahead.

Sidharth Agrawal

I've been follower of IRCTC since a long time. Ma'am just two questions, actually maybe just one

question. Some other online ticketing platforms like MakeMyTrip and EaseMyTrip, they are offering products like free cancellation and trip guarantee offers with train ticket booking. So, what I wanted to know is, IRCTC also planning to launch a similar feature to retain ticketing user? And if yes, then when, and any estimate of the annual revenue potentials on the same or when can we start seeing revenues on such product?

IRCTC Limited 6 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Ca

Il Seema Kumar

See, as of now, we have no such product for the offering, but definitely taking the market trend in the view we can plan, and we should rather look at the offerings available in the market.

Sidharth Agrawal

Okay. But nothing has been fructified or thought of right now?

Seema Kumar

Not yet.

Sidharth Agrawal

I'm not trying to pre-empt anything, but don't you feel that they may be using a large number of customers for that?

Seema Kumar

As I have told you, the customers are of Indian Railway customers. We are front-end for the e-ticketing of India Railways. But yes, as you've pointed out, if something is available in the market being offered by other players, we would definitely like to have a look at it.

Moderator

Thank you. Next question is from the line of Rohan Nagpal from Helios Capital Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Rohan Nagpal

So, you told us that INR 221 crores is convenience fee revenue for the quarter. Could you provide a break-up of the remaining INR 100-odd crores that is booked under Internet Ticketing or what fraction of that is say advertising or iPay revenue, et cetera?

Seema Kumar

Yes, definitely. As I said, the convenience fee stands at INR 221 crores, then agent business is INR 44 crores, then payment gateway business is INR 17 crores, then loyalty program is INR 12.39 crores, marketing and advertising et cetera is INR 7.29 crores, iPay is INR 19.58 crores, and then digital marketing et cetera is INR 1.16 crores. All stuffed together makes it INR 323.46 crores.

IRCTC Limited 7 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Rohan Nagpal

Got it. So, you said payment gateway INR 17 crores and iPay is about INR 11 crores.

Seema Kumar

iPay, I said INR 19.58 crores.

Rohan Nagpal

INR 19.58 crores. Okay. And what is the exact difference in the economics of transactions that are carried out through the regular gateway and through iPay?

Seema Kumar

Yes. I'll give it to you. Just give me a moment, please. iPay transactions, I can give you the trend growth in the iPay transactions. For the quarter, revenues from the iPay transactions have increased 13.63% as compared to the previous quarter because we have registered revenues of INR 1.75 crores and also increase of 59% over the previous quarter, that is Q2 of FY22-23. During the call, I will try to get you the data of what you're looking for, how much is the percentage of total transaction by the iPay.

Rohan Nagpal

All right. Thank you so much. And one more question on Catering. So, what is the total number of trains on which Catering can potentially be offered and what is the sort of progress that we have made in terms of implementation of the new Catering policy tariffs on these trains?

Seema Kumar

See, during the quarter Q2, we have added 11 pair of Vande Bharat train. This is mobile Catering. As far as starting catering is concerned, we have added 18 new units, eight fast food unit, two Plaza, one that adding room, refreshment room are strict spaces, and then total 18 static catering units have been added, 11 Vande Bharat trains have been added. As a result, if you see, in mobile catering, our revenues have gone up by 26.7% if you see YoY. Last year in Q2, it was at INR 292.82 crores and this year in Q2 at INR 371.16 crores which is an increase of 26.7%. Similarly, we started Catering, if you have a look at it, in Q2 2022-23, it was at INR 33.70 crores. While in this year Q2, we are at INR 55.90 crores, which is a 65% increase. So, we are definitely, progressively, making huge strides in both segments of Catering, mobile Catering as well as static Catering.

Rohan Nagpal

Understood. That's very encouraging. I was just trying to get at least from the perspective of how much headroom is there for this to grow. So, how many trains are there where the new Catering policy is still not implemented or is yet to be implemented?

ted?

IRCTC Limited 8 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

See, it's like, I would say, roughly 200-odd contracts are in pipeline for train side vending. All the pantry car trains have been covered, all the prepaid mail express train have been covered which are having pantry car. So, few trains we have to do for the train side vending, these Catering contracts are in the pipeline.

Moderator

Thank you. Next questions from the line of Rohit Jain from Tara Capital. Please go ahead.

Rohit Jain

Good evening. So, just a question again on catering. The license renegotiation that was due, has it been completed, let's say, for all the trains in which there's pre-book meals, like Shatabdi, Rajdhani, et cetera?

Seema Kumar

Yes, the exercise is complete. I suppose you are hinting towards the revision of the license fee which was to be done as per the year 2019. That has been done. We have raised the bills. There are few court cases also have been registered, we are in the process of realizing it.

Rohit Jain

So, I mean, what I'm trying to understand is, that since it was supposed to be done on a retrospective basis, are we going to, let's say, get any one-time benefits going ahead or all these benefits have already been accounted for?

Seema Kumar

No. This is from the post dated, from 2019.

Rohit Jain

My understanding is that, this tariff revision was from 2019-20, as you mentioned, but because of COVID et cetera, it could not be implemented. So, what I'm trying to understand is, do our numbers reflect the benefit of retrospective change in license fee or are we going to register a one-time gain whenever we get that income?

Seema Kumar

You're right. Whenever the realization happens, we will register again. Right now, we have and [Inaudible00:20:34] and raised the bill.

IRCTC Limited 9 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Rohit Jain

And on a prospective basis, is it fair to say that there is no increase in the license fee, current quarter revenues reflect the steady state run rate?

Seema Kumar

Yes. This is as per the existing license fee.

Rohit Jain

Okay. And last question is, there was a dip in the Catering revenues sequentially from last quarter to this quarter. Is it just because of seasonality or is it because of some other factor as well?

Seema Kumar

Absolutely, it's important. This is because of seasonality. As you know, April, May, June is a peak summer period for people to travel because of summer rush. That is the reason, it happens every year. And there have been few cancellations because lot of infrastructure work is going on Indian Railways which we are all aware. So, there are some increase in number of cancellation as well as because of seasonality, there has been very slight decrease as compared to Q1 to Q2.

Rohit Jain

Understood. And one question on the ticketing side. Can you share the percentage of tickets booked using UPI, and also the AC, non-AC split?

Seema Kumar

Yes. Give me a moment please. I can give you the breakup of class-wise. If we see the class-wise breakup. AC class and other ticket you see. For the Q2 is 540 lakhs in Q2 of 2023-24 as compared to 484 lakhs AC ticket in Q1 of 2023-24. And if I compare it with the Q2 of the last year, last year was 438.11. So, there's an increase in number of tickets booked.

RohitJain

Understood. And UPI versus non-UPI?

Seema Kumar

UPI, I can give you the revenues how they have gone up. So that will give an direct indication of increase in the traffic. So, as far as the UPI, if you see Q2 of 2023-24, 453 lakhs tickets have been booked in the Q2 on UPI transactions.

IRCTC Limited 10 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Rohit Jain

Okay. Thanks. And, ma'am, just one last suggestion from my side. All these granular data that we provide on the call, if you can just put them on a slide deck and sort of rel

ease that with the earnings that would be very helpful for us to keep track of it.

Seema Kumar

Yes. But I'll just mention, since you're asking for the UPI, I just want to share a very interesting data.

If you see UPI transition share, I think one more caller had asked earlier. It is increased continuously. If you see transaction share has grown to 38-39%, UPI transaction.

Rohit Jain

So, currently about 38% of the tickets are booked using UPI, is it?

Seema Kumar

Yes.

Rohit Jain

And what was this number last quarter?

Seema Kumar

Last quarter, number of tickets were 393 lakhs.

Rohit Jain

As a percentage? Like you said, this quarter it was 38%. What was it last quarter?

Seema Kumar

Last quarter have 2% growth. If you see on the quarter, YoY 7%. As you suggested all the data so that everybody can see and I don't have to pitch up. Everybody doesn't need [Inaudible00:25:04] .

Rohit Jain

Exactly. Yes. That would be very helpful if you can put all of this in a slide deck.

IRCTC Limited 11.08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

We'll do that. I think it's a good suggestion. Thank you.

Moderator

Thank you. Next question is from the line of Ankit Agarwal, an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Ankit Agarwal

I wanted to know that if you could provide any guidance for like FY24 revenue and in terms of margins and for FY25 as well?

Seema Kumar

We can expect to continue with the same theme and do better.

Ankit Agarwal

Okay. And, ma'am, what would be the reason for decline in the Rail Neer revenues in the first half of FY24?

Seema Kumar

See, Rail Neer, again, be it Catering or be it Rail Neer, this is directly linked to the number of people travelling in the train. And as we have discussed in the earlier call, April, May, June is a peak season for rail travel because of summer rush. And then June, July, August, Q2 is always if you compare, as compared to Q1, it would look little lesser. But if you see the same period, identical period for the Rail Neer, in last year 2023-24 for Q2 I'm talking about, there's an increase of 3.81% in the Rail Neer segment as well, because we have registered a revenue of INR 78 crores as against INR 75 crores last quarter. So, there is an increase in Rail Neer segment also this year.

Ankit Agarwal

There's a margin decline as well in the Rail Neer and Rail Neer section in Q2. What's the reason behind that and what is the steps taken to revive it?

Seema Kumar

Rail Neer's requirement is largely, it is directly linked to number of people travelling in the train. So, if I have more cancellations and if I have lesser people travelling because of seasonality of April, May, June. Again, you will see in the next quarter because of festive season there will be a jump. This is a IRCTC Limited 12 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call trend every year. So, there is no systemic degradation of the services. Our capacity is very much

there to produce the Rail Neer. Depending on demand, the results are seen.

Ankit Agarwal

And last thing, any indication of the second half of FY24 will be better in terms of, like, better than the first half of FY24?

Seema Kumar

Yes, definitely. We are looking forward to do much, much better, because of coming festive seasons and also tremendous efforts you are making in all the segments be it Tourism, be it takes special trains and everything.

Moderator

Thank you. Next question is from the line of Madhuchanda Dey from MC Pro. Please go ahead.

Madhuchanda Dey

I have a couple of questions. I mean, maybe I have missed this answer. But I didn't get what was the reason for this kind of a 13% jump in the internet ticketing revenue sequentially?

Seema Kumar

See, what happened in the internet ticketing, the tickets are booked 120 days in advance, because that is our advanced reservation

period. So, all these tickets were booked in advance, right?

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. For the festive season?

Seema Kumar

Yes. Okay. While the Catering and Rail Neer would be actually based on number of people travelling, while e-ticketing is in advance and Catering and Rail Neer is directly related to the number of people travelling during that time. That is the reason.

Madhuchanda Dey

Yes, got it. And just one clarification. This tourist category doesn't contribute anything, right, to the internet ticketing now?

IRCTC Limited 13 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

It is now reduced to very little because now Board has withdrawn that mandate which was given to us during the COVID.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay.

Seema Kumar

This is a very, very small segment.

Madhuchanda Dey

And so, this entire jump has come because of the advanced ticketing for this festive season.

Seema Kumar

Yes.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. Thanks. My second question is on the Catering margin which has improved, although the revenue has declined as you rightly pointed out, because of lower number of passengers travelling et cetera. So, what was the reason for the improvement in margin and what is a sustainable margin for the Catering business?

Seema Kumar

In this, what happens, if we add number of trains, it will improve my revenues or this thing. Because, during this quarter, 11 pair of Vande Bharat new trains were added, okay. And then, as I told in the earlier call, even in the static Catering unit we have added more number of units. In e-Catering also, our business on quarter-to-quarter is increasing. So, while you would see my expenditure is also linked directly to the number of trains I serve. So, if there are more cancellations, so I am serving lesser trains which also takes away my expenditure portions. So, my margins are directly linked to revenues and the expenditure which is directly linked to the number of trains which are travelling.

Madhuchanda Dey

No, I mean, I still didn't understand, the jump in margin is quite substantial. If one look at segmental margin, at this point 14.6 to 17.2.

IRCTC Limited 14.08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

Yes, I will give you some data to substantiate and try to rephrase my answer to you. If you see in case, then you also see at the expenditure part of it. I'll tell you.

Madhuchanda Dey

So, are you trying to say that the addition of Vande Bharat et cetera are better margin businesses even within catering?

Seema Kumar

Yes, prepaid trains are my premium trains which give me better margin, because there is assured catering business in prepaid. This is part of the ticketing. Right?

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. So, one part of this jump could be explained because you have added Vande Bharat kind of premium trains into the catering, right?

Seema Kumar

Right.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. So, I have another question with some other participant also asked you, which is, in Catering, for instance, what is the total number of trains that you're servicing, either pantry or through mobile?

Seema Kumar

See, if I could just give the perspective I have on my hand. Before COVID, we were serving total 891 pair of trains, in which the trains without pantry were 474 pairs and rest was pairs with pantry cars. Now, after the COVID, we are serving around, say, 363-plus 381. So, without pantry has been covered almost 80%. While we were serving only 474 trains and now we are serving 749 pair of trains without pantry cars. So, there is a tremendous jump in the trains without pantry cars. The coverage has increased tremendously.

Madhuchanda Dey

And with pantry cars, how many are you serving now?

IRCTC Limited 15 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

With pantry cars, I'm serving 437 mail express trains
, 37 Gatimaan, Tejas, Vande Bharat and 66 pairs
of Rajdhani, Shatabdi, Duronto.

Madhuchanda Dey

So, that has reduced?

Seema Kumar

No, it's not reduced. See, Gatimaan, Tejas, Vande Bharat are only five. All the Vande Bharat have been introduced now in this year, from 12 to we have reached to 34 pairs.

Madhuchanda Dey

No. I didn't get the numbers, ma'am. You said, pre-COVID you were serving 891 train pairs with pantry cars. So, what is that number post-COVID?

Seema Kumar

No. 891 were the total train pre-COVID and out of which 474 was a non-pantry. So, if I take that out, so this will be 417.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay.

Seema Kumar

Right, 417 will be this. Right now, we are at 1,284 pairs from 891.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay, altogether?

Seema Kumar

Altogether.

Madhuchanda Dey

And, ma'am, what is the potential, where can it go to by the end of, say, FY25?

IRCTC Limited 16 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

This all depends on number of new services being introduced by the railway, which are in the offering. Vande Bharat, as you're aware, large number of orders have been placed, all the Vande Bharat would be coming. There is a roughly assessment of 450 Vande Bharat in the coming years. And also, besides Vande Bharat, there are few 100, 200-odd trains, in which I have to do the train side vending contract. So, we are looking at it. Vande Bharat is totally dependent of number of services

introduced by the Indian Railways and 200-odd trains which are still to be covered in the train side vending. That chunk is already running, I have to provide services.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay, ma'am. So, if you can share a similar statistics for Internet Ticketing, how many trains are covered by you under Internet Ticketing and how many more trains are in the pipeline in the next two years?

Seema Kumar

See, Internet Ticketing is almost 80%. Okay. It's not train specifics. Inventory is, 20% people are still going to the counters, right, railway counters; 80% are doing on the e-ticketing. So, it is not train specific. The whole inventory is divided, people who can do e-ticketing and the people who still opt to go to the railway counters.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. And how many more in terms of new train addition. I mean, the growth can only come from, the penetration is kind of 80% of recent penetration. So, the growth can only come from addition of inventory, which can happen only if Indian Railways decides to introduce new trains.

Seema Kumar

Yes.

Madhuchanda Dey

So, what is that pipeline?

Seema Kumar

I'm not privy to this, because this is a decision of Ministry of Railways.

Madhuchanda Dey

Right. But still, as you pointed out about Vande Bharat et cetera.

IRCTC Limited 17 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

Actually, those were the announced. Obviously, when Vande Bharat trains have introduced, their ticketing inventory will also be added. For the new trains also the ticketing inventory would be added for those 20 trains. And then 80% of those trains or 90% of that inventory we are expected to be added to the in e-ticketing. As and when new train is added, e-ticketing also grows along with the Catering and the Rail Neers.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. So, we just wanted to get a sense of the organic growth in the sense, if, say, between last year and this year, what is the quantum increase in the inventory of tickets?

Seema Kumar

Okay. Total inventory of Indian Railways?

Madhuchanda Dey

Yes, of Internet Ticketing.

Seema Kumar

We'll share with you. It will need more detailed discussion on this, because even in train, a single bus can be booked multiple times. So that results into [Inaudible 00:38:19] . So, we'll definitely get back to you. It is detailed discussion matters, right?

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. And, ma'am, just one last house keeping question. What was the share of the Tejas revenue in Tourism?

Seema Kumar

For the Q2 of 2023-24 revenues from Tejas are INR 33.98 crores as compared to Q1 of 2023- 24, INR 45.88 crores. This is because of the Tejas.

Madhuchanda Dey

Okay. And their profitability?

IRCTC Limited 18 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

We are working towards it, because now whatever concessions are given by the Ministry of Railways, they have withdrawn all those concessions. Now, we are re aligning our expenditure contracts to make it a profitable venture.

Madhuchanda Dey

It is not broken even in this quarter.

Seema Kumar

Right now, we are in the process of re aligning our expenditure contracts.

Moderator

Thank you. Next question is from the line of Deepesh Lakhani from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Deepesh Lakhani

So, my question was on your collaboration with Zomato in this quarter. So, what is the response from this collaboration and are you making any margins out of this?

Seema Kumar

See, as I stated in one of the call, it is just begin, it's a three-week old collaboration with Zomato. And now what we have said is, for Zomato we have worked out a model where IRCTC is taking INR 40 per order, right? And railway share comes to INR 16.

Deepesh Lakhani

Okay.

Seema Kumar

Actually, in the next quarter, picture will be clearer, how much volume Zomato is bringing to us and how much are the earning patterns. That is why pilot has been limited to five stations for a six month period to understand how this model will work which is dependent on the volumes rather than percentage value of each order.

Deepesh Lakhani

How many bottles are produced in a day, average, in this quarter?

IRCTC Limited 19 08.11.2023
Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Seema Kumar

RailNeer?

Deepesh Lakhani

Yes.

Seema Kumar

Okay. See, we are producing around 12 lakh liters per day. We have the capacity of 16 lakh liter per day, but as for the demand we are producing 12 lakh liter per day. And also we have added one Rail Neer plant in this quarter at Kota. Kota Rail Neer plant commissioned on 19th October of this quarter.

Deepesh Lakhani

Okay And the Bhubaneswar, ma'am?

Seema Kumar

Bhubaneswar and NTPC-Simhadri is likely to come in the next quarter, Q3 of this year.

Deepesh Lakhani

Okay. So, what will be our capacity then after adding this?

Seema Kumar

See, right now, I'm at 16,24,000 and after adding Bhubaneswar and NTPC-Simhadri, this is 72,000 each, litre.

Deepesh Lakhani

Okay. And so, my last question, what is the update on the Tejas train online charges which you accounted in last quarter? You had mentioned that you are in words with the Ministry of Railways.

Seema Kumar

Yes, we are still touching with the Ministry to have a re look at the decision, because they have withdrawn it from the prospective date.

IRCTC Limited 20 08.11.2023

Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call Moderator

Thank you. That will be the last question for the day. I would now like to hand the conference over to Ms. Seema Kumar for closing comments.

Seema Kumar

I would like to thank each one of you who have taken time out to have a conversation with the management and to understand and give us also the direction in which company needs to look at to go for the further growth. Wishing all of you and your family is a very Happy Deepawali. Thank you and very good evening.

Moderator

Thank you, ma'am. On behalf of Dolat Capital, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Note: 1. This document has been edited to improve readability
2. Blanks in this transcript represent inaudible or incomprehensible words.

Call: Feb 2024

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 February 19, 2024

BSE Limited
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
“Exchange Plaza”, C -1, Block -G,
Bandra- Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “ Q3FY’24 Earnings
Conference Call ” held on Wednesday, February 14, 2024.
Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma’am,

In reference to our communication dated January 30, 2024, please find enclosed
herewith the transcript of “Q3FY’24 Earnings Conference Call” held on Wednesday,
February 14, 2024.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
For and on behalf of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a

Page 1 of 13

“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Q3
FY24 Earnings Conference”

February 14, 2024

M
MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN & MANAGING
DIRECTOR , IRCTC
MR. AJIT KUMAR – DIRECTOR (FINANCE) & CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER , IRCTC
DR. LOKIAH RAVIKUMAR – DIRECTOR (CATERING
SERVICES), IRCTC
MR. K.K. MISHRA – DIRECTOR (TOURISM &
MARKETING), IRCTC

MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
February 14 , 2024

Page 2 of 13

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to IRCTC Q3 FY'24 Results Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' then '0' on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q3 FY'24 conference Call of IRCTC Limited.

I know there is a delay in the call and we apologize for that because of some technical reason we could not avoid that, but now without wasting any time I just take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain who is CMD of the Company; Mr. Ajit Kumar, who is Director (Finance) and CFO of the Company, and also we have today with us Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar, who is Director of the Catering Services; and Mr. K.K. Mishra ji who is Director for Tourism and Marketing Segment.

Now, I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC Management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, Mr. S.K. Jain.

S.K. Jain: Thank you, all. A very good afternoon to everyone and a warm welcome to you all to this Conference Call of IRCTC Quarter -ending December 2023. I extend my warmest wishes to you and your family.

Just to add that, I have joined as a regular CMD of IRCTC with you all for what an opportune moment today.

The Company has announced Unaudited Financial Results for the Third Quarter of Financial Year 2023 -24, which were disclosed yesterday on both the stock exchanges.

I shall first give a conscience overview of Q3, post which our Director (Finance) and CFO, will provide the Details of the Performance of our Business Segment, thereafter, we shall have the Question -Answer Session as per your convenience.

During Q3 this year, I am really happy to announce that the Company achieved a remarkable milestone with operating revenue reaching to 1,118 crores, marking its highest ever quarterly revenue, implying a growth of more than 20% year -on-year basis, 21.8% and 12.4%. Catering and tourism have been the main drivers for this revenue growth. The EBITDA for Q3 is Rs.394 Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
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crores in absolute term, growing by 20.9% from Rs.326 crores for Q3 last year, mainly due to the decent growth in catering and tourism business. EBITDA came to around 35%, more or less similar to the last year and 36.83 % compared to the Q2. Due to the change in the product mix and a low margin in catering and other verticals as compared to the internet ticketing.

The Company reported a net profit of Rs.300 crores in the December quarter of this year, making an increase of 17.4%. So, as I told that the Company reported a net profit of Rs.300 crores as against Rs.255 crores last year, the net profit also is the highest ever profit registered in the history of IRCTC in this quarter, despite making a provision of Rs.14.5 crores in Q3 on account of differential profit sharing for PPP plants in Rail Neer segment with railways.

I would like to conclude my opening remarks by conveying warm wishes to all our investors and wishing you all a very profitable venture ahead. Thank you for your continued support and trust in us.

I shall now hand over the call to my colleague and our Director (Finance) and CFO, Ajit Kumar to brief you on the " Financial and Segmental Performance" of the Company. Thank you very much.

Ajit Kumar: Good afternoon. Ajit Kumar, Director, Finance and CFO.

Now, I will first give a " Brief

Overview " about Q3 FY'24 Results, post with which we shall have that question -answer session.

In Q3 FY'24, IRCTC experienced yet another quarter of robust revenue growth, marking another significant milestone in its journey. Revenue of Rs.1,118 crores grew by 21.8% year -over -year and 12.4% quarter -on-quarter basis. Consolidated EBITDA margin is more or less the same, that is quarter -on-quarter to 35.23% versus 36.83% and 35.49% year -on-year due to change in the revenue mix.

Now, net profit after exceptional items for the quarter came at Rs.299.9 crores versus Rs.255.2 crores in Q3 FY'23 and Rs.297.67 crores in Q2 FY'24.

Now, let us move to the different business segments of the Company:

The catering segment reported a 29.1% year -on-year growth in revenue, reaching Rs.507.76 crores and a 17.6% increase on a quarter -on-quarter basis.

Additionally, it may also be noted that the Q3 and nine months revenue in FY'24 is the highest ever recorded in the catering segment. The EBITDA margin continued to show substantial improvement reaching 15.44% compared to 10.73% year -on-year. However, there was a slight decrease compared to the 17.21% quarter -on-quarter margin, mainly due to changes in the

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product mix within the catering vertical as the prepaid trains revenue having low EBITDA, has increased Q3 to Rs.59.76 crores from Q2 Rs.207 crores.

The next vertical, the "Internet Ticketing." This segment continues to demonstrate the resilient amid conversion of reserve to tickets back to the early reserve tickets during the pre -pandemic period. And the revenue for the quarter was Rs.335.31 crores growing by 11.4% year -on-year and 2.39% quarter -on-quarter. The EBITDA margin for the quarter came at 83.02% versus 83.7% quarter -on-quarter and 84.15% year -on-year.

The next segment is tourism and state distance. That segment saw strong growth in revenue for the quarter at Rs.195.47 crores, implying a growth of 32.28% year -on-year and 21.11% quarter -on-quarter. Given the revenue growth, the segment reported positive EBITDA margin of 12.10% versus 3.6% on quarter -on-quarter and 10.79% year -on-year basis.

The other segment, Rail Neer in Q3 FY'24, reported a value of Rs.83.76 crores marking a sequential growth quarter -on-quarter of 7.39% and year -on-year increase of 6.05%. The reported EBITDA margin stood at 13.43% representing an improvement compared to both year -on-year figure of 11.20% and quarter -on-quarter figure of 12.43%. However, the segment's quarterly profit showed a negative return of minus 3.3 crores contrasting with the previous quarter profit of 8.8 crores. This decline was primarily attributed to an adjustment of an exceptional item amounting to Rs.14.51 crores in this quarter. This exceptional item involved a sharing of an additional 25% revenue from the PTC railway plant for previous year, which was accounted for in the third quarter.

For Q3 FY'24, the cash and bank balances and the net worth of the Company at the end of the quarter is Rs.2,258 crores and Rs.2,946 crores respectively.

That brings to the end of the opening remarks. And we wish you all the best. So, now we can straightaway move to the question -answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: We will now begin the question-and -answer session. The first question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi from Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: My question is on the catering business, which reported a very strong growth in this quarter. So, was it due to higher coaches booked on FTR basis or did we get more TS V contract in this quarter, if you can highlight that? and also a related question is, we had plans to expand into the non-railway catering business. So, if you can share some progress on that line as well?

S.K. Jain: So, I'm seeing two, three reasons for the increase in such

a robust catering revenue enhancement.

First is introduction of Vande Bharat Train. As against the announcement of 75 Vande Bharat trains this year, already 41 trains have been announced and running. The old contract which expired this year is around 1,200, has now increased to 1,518 contracts to be precise. FTR has

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also increased and FTR is also giving us revenue because of that policy that now all the catering to be done by IRCTC. Yes, you are right that because of that also it is adding to our revenue and it will further add to our revenue. Then, you talked about NRC. NRC also like this year only we have already started eight NRC projects, seven are in pipeline and these are mostly government offices, high court, etc., In addition, we are tied up with Zomato also as a food aggregator. We are on to more than around 400 stations. We are providing e -catering services, whereas we have direct contact with around 480, 490 vendors. We are eyeing aggregators like Zomato and recently they have onboarded onto our system. Till now, we have 17 such aggregators with us. So, all these results led to the growth in catering. One more thing which I want to add is that recently Ministry of Railways has announced a new catering policy, basically, it is a corrigendum to the old one wherein a new concept of this cluster -based catering being announced. We have already floated some of the tenders and we are going very aggressively towards that. The main highlight of the tender is that this is a long -term tender; it will be given for five plus two years. That's all.

Jinesh Joshi: A related follow up is that you mentioned that the current contracts are roughly at about 1,500-

odd. So, if my memory serves me right, I mean in the last quarter, I think we were at about 1,300 - odd contracts and the opportunity size was 1,500. And given we have already reached that number; do you foresee a catering revenue plateau out a bit from here on?

S.K. Jain: No, no, no, no. It's a very good question. And I can understand your worry, but it's a matter of joy. We are in the sector, largely our catering is all our business rather is in railways and you know that railways is going, going, going. With DFC CIL coming, the line capacity of Indian Railways will further get relief and there is a huge demand from passenger side. So, once the passengers are there, they need food to eat that IRCTC provide and they need tickets which we will issue. So, we should try to serve as much as we can.

Jinesh Joshi: My second question pertains to the additional provisioning that we have wherein profits in our Rail Neer business. So, our press release states that the incremental provision is taken until FY'23. So, do we expect some additional provisioning crop up in future from here on due to higher share which we need to give to Indian railways?

S.K. Jain: I'm not able to hear you. Kindly repeat the question. There was a disturbance.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, the provisioning in this quarter that we have took approximately 14-odd crores with respect to share in Rail Neer profit, our press release states that we have taken provision till FY'23 and for FY'24 do we expect incremental provision come through from here on?

S.K. Jain: No, no, no, it's already provided. You see there are two things in this which I would like to explain to you. See, the departmental Rail Neer plan that we have to share the revenue with railways at the rate of 15%. But all the plans which are on PPP model, the revenue sharing is 40% of our profits. So, earlier, what happened, we calculated 15% and 14.5 crores is the grand total of the difference of 40% of the net profit.

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Jinesh Joshi: Actually, the worry was that this difference in profit which you have provided for, you have stated

in your press release that this has been provided for up till FY'23 which is 31st of March 2023. Will we have to provide more? That was my question.

S.K. Jain: Up to December 2023, PPP sharing has already been made at the rate of 40% in this quarter apart from the provision of 14.5 crores up to March '23.

Jinesh Joshi: Maybe sir, I'll take this offline. If you can share what is the convenience fee and number of tickets booked for this quarter?

S.K. Jain: This AC class is 550 lakhs; non-AC class is 456 lakhs and second sitting is 140 lakhs for this quarter.

Jinesh Joshi: And convenience revenue?

S.K. Jain: 219 crores is the Q3 convenience fee.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rohan Nagpal from Helios Capital. Please go ahead.

Rohan Nagpal: I have one question. On your catering revenue expenses, there is one line item in the income statement -

S.K. Jain: Can you please be louder?

Rohan Nagpal: So, on your income statement, there's a line item that says expenses of catering services. Now that expenses of catering services, if I look at it, it's 349 crores, but that is not the same as the difference between your catering segment revenue and your catering segment result, the catering segment result is about Rs.78 crores, catering segment revenue is Rs.508 crores. So, what all is covered in that line item, expenses of catering services and what are the other expenses within catering services that you are incurring?

S.K. Jain: No, this is operating profit. This is absolutely directly linked to the catering whatever we earn the revenue from the catering, and it's the net of the direct cost which is there.

Rohan Nagpal: So, what all is rolled up in that 350 -odd crores in your expenses of catering services?

S.K. Jain: That is the reimbursement cost of catering charges paid to vendors and the railway share on the license fees

Rohan Nagpal: I was just wondering on catering revenue in terms of the trains, how many more trains are there that are still under the old catering policy and how much runway for or catering revenue increase is there on the train side?

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S.K. Jain: Do you mean to ask that old catering policy; how many mobile units are there and as per the new policy?

Rohan Nagpal: Yes, exactly. So, how many trains are yet to move to the new catering policy or yet to be transitioned?

S.K. Jain: 100% has to be moved to the new policy because the policy has recently come. We have already started floating the tender. So, at the moment all are on earlier short-term tenders. So, that's why

I said will be for seven years. As of now, most of the tenders are up to six months.

Rohan Nagpal: So, are all trains that are currently operational under the new catering policy or there're still trains that are yet to sort of move on to the new catering policy?

S.K. Jain: Actually, this new catering policy has recently come. Again, I'm repeating that we have just started the tendering process. We have floated a few tenders, not yet finalized.

Rohan Nagpal: So, then how long will it take for the tenders under the new catering policy to be applicable across the trains? Is there some sort of penetration number that you have in terms of, there are X number of trains and of these, why are currently on the new catering policy or on the tenders that are under the new catering policy?

S.K. Jain: All the trains which we are running at present and all the trains which will be coming. we are having around 1,200 trains at the moment putting altogether. So, all these will be put on the tender, and this will be on long term tender because the size is quite large. We are aggressively following to finalize as soon as we can. We have already decided the phases about this.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ashish Srikumar. Please go ahead.

Ashish Srikumar: I ju

st wanted to ask a question about the Zomato digitally eating that you were talking about. Could you specify that how much has it grown because the catering service you said grew because of the number of trains, Vande Bharat inclusion, So, in the coming days, how much is it going to grow?

S.K. Jain: Number doesn't matter. Actually, if you want, I can give you the numbers. We are already there on POC concept, and we are at 18 stations now and we are coming up on 22 additional stations, but number doesn't matter. What I see is to create a network so th at first you put the system in place and then you with your strength of the network, you create the stability in the market and confidence in the customer. That's what we have to be looking for.

Ashish Srikumar: So, I believe that first we are plumbing the entire structure and then basis that we will increase the numbers. I got your point. And one final question, sir. You might have seen that ONDC's inclusion has been included a lot and ONDC has also gotten into the e atery services through

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different aggregators. So, ONDC also coming into the ticket booking section for IRCTC planning, something of that sort?

S.K. Jain: We were discussing ONDC. So, our discussion is already going with them for each recasting and bus booking.

Ashish Srikumar: So, any projected timelines by when you are foreseeing there could be an inclusion of ONDC into IRCTC?

S.K. Jain: It will be too early to say but what we are trying.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Madhu Chandan Day from MC Pro. Please go ahead.

Madhu C Day: I have two questions. One is the same question on the catering. I was not very clear. You mentioned about a figure of 1,518 contracts. So, that is the potential number of contracts that you have. And how many contracts have you already won, or you're already present, if you can clarify that number?

S.K. Jain: Yes, this number is already under short term tenders. These are the short -term contracts going on. What I was telling is that a new catering policy has come for long -term tenders. At present we are having a contract of maximum six months. The new catering policy is prescribed for five years plus two years contract. And for that, we have decided to go in five phases and complete the tender.

Madhu C Day: So, my question is, what will be the number of trains where given the existing inventory from railways where there is a potential for catering where you are not present. Are there any number of trains where there is a potential for catering and you're still no t present?

S.K. Jain: Largely, we are present in one or other form. You see, one who is on the train, if he is hungry, he needs to be provided with the meal. That we manage in three ways. One is a long -term contract; another is short term contract where there is a gap which fills it up through short -term contracts. Third is (TSV), Train Side Vending we get it done. And there are certain trains which are not having any pantry car. So, it will be interesting to know the e -catering is also there. Then we have food plazas all across the country besides where a refreshment food. There is no place where we are not going. The question is, if we put them from five to seven years in place of six months, certainly will give us confidence in the market firstly and there will be stability and revenue growth on our part.

Madhu C Day: But if you give it to them on a five to seven-year contract, in terms of pricing, will you have to give some concession compared to the short term?

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S.K. Jain: What I feel is it will be the other way round. The pricing is controlled by ministry, but the transitional fees what they are expected to quote, if they have the surety of a longer-term contract,

so I believe their fixed cost, they will be able to manage and that's how they can share more profit with us.

Madhu C Day: Sir, on an organic basis, what kind of growth should we expect in the catering revenue in the next two to three years?

S.K. Jain: Number is if I say infinite. You see we have two crores people travelling on our system on Indian Railways every day. What we are providing here is around 18, 20 lakhs of meals per day. So, the number is huge as much as I can take it.

Madhu C Day: I have another question which is a little kind of, if you can guide us with some number. So, as of now you sell about 46 crores roughly ballpark in that range internet tickets in a year. So, given that –

S.K. Jain: What's your question?

Madhu C Day: As of now, you sell about 46 crores internet tickets roughly, may not be the numbers. So, given the Vande Bharat or other additional plans for introduction of nutrients, etc., what kind of organic addition to this number can we expect?

S.K. Jain: You see, just now I told that Indian railways infrastructure is growing very fast. DFC has already come. It is creating , line capacity enhancement in the railways in a big way for the passenger trains. They are investing a huge amount in CAPEX in building the infrastructure and bringing rolling stock and all. So, the question is not what is the growth. The question is how much we can capture. The economy is also growing. And we all believe that is the next 25 years of India we are planning according to that.

Madhu C Day: I'm just asking for my curiosity. One simple number. One additional Vande Bharat train leads to what kind of annual capacity in terms of tickets?

S.K. Jain: So, there are two kinds of Vande Bharat. One, which has the capacity of 543 people with eight coaches, and another one is around 1,000. 1,100 and 540 depends upon the train is running with how many coaches per day per trip, one side because Vande Bharat goes in the morning, comes back in the evening. So, if you multiply by two, so in a day two round trip is taken, one round trip is taken means 11 into two, 2,200 passengers travel every day.

Madhu C Day: But then all Vande Bharat don't travel every day of the week also. So, ballpark –

S.K. Jain: No, it runs for six days. Not for seven days.

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Madhu C Day: So, ballpark, you mentioned right that was 75 Vande Bharat announcements and 25 running. So, with this 45 running, what is the additional ticketing capacity that you have?

S.K. Jain: Madam, that we can calculate any day. We have like 543 or 1,100 into two into 300 days we can say. What I'm trying to say is that you do not only see catering parts, you see the ticketing, you see the Rail Neer, you see even tourism. Any addition of Vande Bharat has a multiplier effect on IRCTC and its services.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Rahul Jain: So, I just have a couple of questions. Firstly, on the Rail Neer business, we saw this exceptional charge. So, it would be great if you could give some feedback that why there is this ambiguity of earlier having this 15% versus 40% now? And it's just a provision, when we expect this to be conclusive for the future as well?

S.K. Jain: As I explained you earlier, initially, Indian Railways and IRCTC, both thought to run the railway plant on departmental basis. So, there was a decision that in a departmental unit, railways didn't charge 15%. But, as the necessity was there, the market was growing, and it was not possible to create the capacity to the expectation, so IRCTC was allowed to go on a PPP model. So, that time, they could not visualize that, should we take it as per the departmental procedure or through PPP model which is available in all others like food plaza and all. So, now it is a settled issue

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that any PPP will be treated as per the same norm. Norm was already existing. But, it's a matter of interpretation earlier, now it's very clear, and there is no ambiguity, and it's a conclusive thing now. And IRCTC is not losing anything. You see, we are earning say Rs.100, we are giving 40 out of that. So, Rs.60 is the net ensured to us. But that way we are able to create additional capacity in a shorter period.

Rahul Jain: But essentially this charge never used to exist prior to FY'22, but at the time of IPO, we already had this plant . So, when this rate effectively be implemented?

S.K. Jain: You see, it is done at the ministry level. And what I'm saying is, if we have to expand and there is already a norm of 40% on PPP project, so why IRCTC will not pay, I have a different question rather. If we pay 40% in place of 15% , I am able to grab the market. So, at least in absolute term, we'll be able to manage in getting more revenue than what we are doing now.

Rahul Jain: I can understand your stance, sir. My simple question is, because all of these charges, which are levied by Indian Railways at different point of time, creates the uncertainty in terms of what kind of revenue, what kind of profit would be retained in this listed entity. So, is it safer to assume that all such changes which are relevant because we are a significant beneficiary from Indian Railways, and at the same time we have a large opportunity to capture, is it safer to assume all such necessary changes?

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S.K. Jain: What I understood from your question and it's an important question, it would have been better for IRCTC to first clarify all this and then do the business. As management wisdom was there, let us start aggressively. And all these things we are not giving anything from pocket, we are just sharing the profit which otherwise the norm is there. When we are running contract, this business entity as assured business also, rather wasting time and fighting with railways first and then decide and then get the market, it would be always advisable that we should go for the market and side -by-side, we talk to them. Absolutely, there is no uncertainty. It is an interpretation and that has been settled now.

Rahul Jain: Yes, I can understand that aspect. Just one incremental input I was just saying. Since you said that it is in best interest for us to look forward, is it safer to assume for all the businesses that we are doing today, whatever is the sharing arrangement today is something which can be sustainable or you think at different point of time, something may come up which we can't predict at this point?

S.K. Jain: If I answer your question like this, the life expectancy in India is 79 years, it was previously 52 years or 59 years, now it is 79 years. So, it doesn't mean that you will not fall sick. So, you will take medicine and then move on so that you have achieved that life expectancy. That's what I can say.

Rahul Jain: Sir, just to add to your point, the analogy, whatever business problem you would face from the market is equivalent to falling sick.

S.K. Jain: We have to go on. We cannot –

Rahul Jain: We just have to understand is that sickness would be coming from our parent or would be an external sickness?

S.K. Jain: You see, every parent gives his son or the descendant, there are certain inherent diseases. But the son or the daughter, the descendants flourish. And if you see, earlier 52, after the disease would be 79. We all have reached that level. So, there will be clarity when we are going together. We can't say in a very inverted comma that there will not be any problem, there will not be any interpretation issue, all will remain there. But the main thing what I see as a management here is how we grow and we grow together to the satisfaction of the customer and to the investor that way.

Rahul Jain: Just last one aspect. we've been providing this UPI incentive to the user who do ticketing through the UPI mode and there is a significant subsidization on that aspect. Is there any timeline that we have decided that how long we would offer this to our customers, or this is going to be a permanent thing?

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S.K. Jain: See, promotion of UPI is government directive and as a citizen of India, as a response when we are talking of involvement sustainability, we talk of everything. So, this is a dream project of India which is taking India to a different level. We can't be left behind. So, we have to promote it and we can find out many other ways and means to enhance our earning. So, what I feel is that we should not restrict ourselves in such a conservative side of thinking.

Rahul Jain: But do we have any other precedence in India apart from this UPI incentive in such a big hearted manner?

S.K. Jain: You see, somebody has to take the lead. If I am taking the initiative, you should be happy that the management here in IRCTC are led to the occasion.

Rahul Jain: Sir, my only point is that it was well understood five years ago, but since that 67% of all volumes in India now happens on UPI, it's fairly acceptable medium of payment. So, do we need to promote it beyond this point as well?

S.K. Jain: What I see, time is a learning process. The time cycle may differ for two years, five years, 10 years. You see, 10 years before, we could not have thought that India will become the fifth largest economy. Now, we are daring to reach the third largest economy in the ten years itself. So, what I feel that we should not be bound by the time to pass on India for two years, three years. We should see how we can progress further, how we can add to our revenue, how we can add to our profit and there are very various ways and means to do that. So, you see, after getting this concession also, just now we told that we are happy to announce that this was the highest of the revenue in this quarter.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Devang Bhatt from IDBI Capital. Please go ahead.

Devang Bhatt: Just a few bookkeeping questions like what is the current Rail Neer plant capacity and what is the utilization and what -?

S.K. Jain: Utilization is 75% and the capacity is around 18 lakhs. We are adding to its capacity by 72,000 plant. In fact one of the plants is going to be inaugurated tomorrow, another plant by July. So, we are enhancing the capacity. Our utilization is 75%. There also we are planning to enhance our capacities because you see there are certain plants which are running at more than 100% capacity. There we are adding another add-on capacity, and we are coming with the new plants also.

Devang Bhatt: So, sir, how much your capacity will increase by FY'25 and beyond?

S.K. Jain: 18.4 lakhs bottle per day.

Devang Bhatt: So, that is the current capacity, right?

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S.K. Jain: No, no, no, current is 16.96. I may be wrong in telling. We will enhance it to 18.4 as of now. But '25 is like long period for me. Let us see.

Devang Bhatt: So, 18.4 by FY'25. By this year or by -

S.K. Jain: As on date there is a plan by 2025 18.4 lakhs of bottle per day. But what I feel, we are sitting here in January, February 2024. So, we have time to think it again.

Devang Bhatt: In this quarter, what drove your tourism revenues, I mean what was the key driver and how many additions of stages are expected in the coming quarters?

S.K. Jain: You see, in tourism, we have a very good product, Vande Bharat Train. So, about tourism business, let me explain it to you. We are basically catering to rail-based mass tourism. And Bharat Gaurav Train 10 plus one we are running, and secondly, interesting part is

that recently

only we have an MoU with Uttarakhand government I think in the last week itself, where we have a contract with them for two years that we will promote their tourist places and they are investing into raise Bharat Gaurav Trains, and we will be slicing it. And we are talking to some other state governments also like Maharashtra also because it is a nascent stage, I should not talk about the state, but we can just say to you that these are the two products, one is the MoU with the state government catering to like mass tourism and promoting their state tourism and Bharat Gaurav Train. So, these are the two futuristic in India.

Devang Bhatt: This MoU with Uttarakhand, what kind of revenues it will generate for you?

S.K. Jain: It will generate good revenue.

Devang Bhatt: Sir in Tejas, what kind of additions are you seeing?

S.K. Jain: It's not a concept of revenue my dear. What I feel is that if we are opening something, so there are many such states are there, which wants to promote their tourism. So, if I say that in the next two years we are having MoU with 10 or 12 state governments, it will generate huge revenue. So, I see the potential. I am not calculating the absolute terms.

Moderator: That was the last question. I would now like to hand the conference over to management for closing comments.

Management : Thanks to this. After this Q3 result which is one of the highest, I mean this for the nine months and three months this quarter, and especially talking to the investors gives us confidence and whatever the suggestions we take it forward. It's your Company and we look forward that in the next quarter, we do much better with your best wishes. Thank you very much.

Moderator: On behalf of Dolat Capital, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Jun 2024

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 June 04 , 2024

BSE Limited

1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
"Exchange Plaza", C -1, Block -G,
Bandra- Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of Earning Conference
Call for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st March 2024 held on
Wednesday, May 29, 2024.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated May 29, 2024, please find enclosed herewith
the transcript of Earning Conference Call for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st
March 2024 held on Wednesday, May 29, 2024.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a
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"Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited
Q4 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call "
May 29, 2024@1600hrs.

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR – IRCTC LIMITED.
MR. AJIT KUMAR – DIRECTOR , FINANCE AND CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER – IRCTC LIMITED.
DR. LOKIAH RAVIKUMARJI -- DIRECTOR - CATERING
SERVICES – IRCTC LIMITED
MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN -- DIRECTOR - TOURISM AND
MARKETING SEGMENT – IRCTC LIMITED. LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS
LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the IRCTC Q4 FY '24 Earnings Conference
Call, hosted by Dolat Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode,
and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should

you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain : Thank you, Guest . Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q4 conference and annual results for IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC, represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain , who is CMD of the company; and Mr. Ajit Kumar ji, who is Director of Finance and CFO of the company. Also, we have today with us Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar ji, who is Director of Catering Services; and Mr. Rahul Himalian ji, who is Director for Tourism and Marketing segment.

And now, I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC Management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, please.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Rahul. A very good afternoon to everybody and a warm welcome to this concall of IRCTC for the quarter, year-ending March 2024. At the outset, I'm happy to announce that your company has achieved its highest ever revenue and highest ever profit, setting a new benchmark in its journey as a listed company.

I shall first give an overall view about financial year 2024 and quarter -- this quarter results, post which, I will ask my Director of Finance and CFO to provide the details of the performance of our company, business -wise, segment -wise. We shall have the n the question-and -answer session.

I am pleased to report that Q4 has been an exceptional quarter for our company, in which we have achieved an all -time high revenue of INR 1,155 crores. This represents a robust growth of 19.7% year -on-year. The catering segment has notably driven this quarter revenue, showcasing the strength and potential of this business area.

For the financial year 2024, we have achieved a remarkable operating revenue of INR 4,270 crores, reflecting a substantial growth of more than 20% year on year. Our EBITDA raised at INR1,466 crores, marking a 14.89% increase year -on-year. PAT before exceptional items for the financial year is outstanding INR 1,170 crores, significantly up from INR 978 crores year -on-year basis. Overall, these results underscore our company's strong performance and resilience. We look forward to continue this positive momentum and delivering sustained growth and profitability in the coming quarters.

Our Board has recommended a final dividend of INR 4 per share subject to shareholders' approval, which takes the total dividend of INR 6.5 per share for this financial year. The total dividend of INR 6.50 per share for the face value of INR 2 per share , the highest ever dividend declared in the history of IRCTC.

I'd like to conclude my opening remarks and shall hand over the call to my colleague and Director Finance & CFO; Mr. Ajit Kumar to brief you on the financial and segmental performance of the company. Thank you very much.

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Ajit Kumar : Good afternoon, everybody, and I hope you and your dear ones are in good health. I shall first give a brief overview about annual performance and then Q4 FY '24 results, post which, we will have the question-and -answer session.

The annual performance of FY '24. Our annual operating revenue for FY '24 reached an impressive INR4,270 crores, reflecting a substantial 20.5% year -over -year growth. This achievement underscores our sustained momentum and a strategic expansion efforts. Absolute EBITDA increased by 14.89% year -over -year to INR 1,466 crores with our EBITDA margin remaining stable at 34.3% compared to 36% year -over -year. This stability demonstrates our effective management as well as oper

ational efficiency despite changes in o ur revenue mix. Net profit before exceptional items sore to INR 1,170 crores, significantly higher than INR 978 crores in the previous year.

Now quarterly performance, that is Q4 FY '24. For Q4 FY '24, we achieved another quarter of robust growth with revenues reaching INR 1,155 crores, marking a 3.3% quarter -over -quarter and just under 20% year -over -year increase. This growth was primarily driven by our Catering segment, which despite its relatively lower margin contributed significantly to our overall revenue.

Now the business segments highlights with different segments. The first one, Internet Ticketing, the Internet Ticketing segment continues to demonstrate this resilience, especially with the

transition of reserved ticket back to unreserved ticket as during the prepandemic period. The segment reported a revenue of INR 342.4 crores, growing by 2.1% quarter -over -quarter and 16% year-over year . EBIT margin remains robust at 80.3% despite minor variations, that is 83% quarter -over -quarter and 88.1% year -over -year, reflecting our strong market position and operational efficiency.

Now, the next segment is Catering. Our Catering segment maintained its strong growth momentum with revenue rising to INR 530.8 crores, an increase of 4.5% quarter -over -quarter and 34.1% year -over -year. While the EBIT margin moderated to 8.7%, that is 15.4% quarter -over -quarter and 12.1% year -over -year. The segment's revenue growth underscores the increasing demand and our ability to scale operations effectively as per the need.

Next segment is Tourism. The Tourism segment showed a solid quarter -over -quarter growth of 3.2% with revenue at INR 201.7 crores. Although there was a slight year -over -year decline, the EBIT margin was strong at 9.4%, that is 12.1% quarter -over -quarter and 13.5% year -over -year, indicating the segment's resilience and potential for future growth.

The next segment is Rail Neer. The Rail Neer reported steady revenue of just under INR 80 crores, stable quarter -over -quarter, while achieving a 13.9% year -over-year growth. The EBIT margin improved significantly to 13.3%, recovering from a loss on a quarter -over -quarter basis and achieving 18.6% on a year -on-year basis, showcasing our efforts to enhance profitability as well as the market reach.

Now, the overall, our Q4 FY '24 results highlights, a successful year of growth and a strategic execution. We remain committed to building on this momentum and delivering sustained value

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to our stakeholders. For Q4 FY '24, the capex was INR55 crores taking the capex for FY '24 to finally INR240 crores. The cash and bank balances to the company, as of the end of FY '24, is INR2,263 crores and net worth is INR3,230 crores.

This brings me to the end of my opening remarks. Now we will have the question -and-answer session, and if there is any specifically any data, which is required -- I mean, very minor data or any specific data, then you can always e -mail to the C IRO, Mr. Anil Sharma. And then, they will provide the data as per the books of accounts. So now we can straightaway move to the question -and-answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi .

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, my question is on our Catering division. So if I look at our EBIT margin, which used to hover in the band of about 15% to 17% in the last 3 quarters, they have come down to about 8.7%. So any specific reason for such a sharp deterioration? And how should we look at the margin trajectory over the next couple of quarters?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Mr. Joshi, it's a nice question, and very pertinent one. I know that all of you must be liking to know the reason for the dip. In fact, if you see -- if you compare our Catering revenue of -- on a quarter -to-quarter basis of

last, say, quarter of -- fourth quarter of 2023, and this quarter 4 of

2024, you will see that the margin is almost the same. Last year, in Q4 it was INR 48 crores. This year, in Q4 it is INR46 crores.

The reason being, you see the -- in the segment side, the revenue from Catering has increased many -fold. It has increased by, say, INR 500 crores and -- yes, during the year. And in the quarter also, it has increased from INR 507 crores to INR 530 crores. So what happened? Because of charging of -- assigning overhead cost as per the revenue segment, this booking of expenditure of administrative nature has been done on this segment more than any other segment.

Then, we have a 5% cost on our GST for the mobile (pre-paid) catering services, which we provide. And during this quarter, this is like -- if you see the history, this is the highest in -- generally higher compared to other quarters. And what we have done, because of our longterm catering contract, which we have already entered to and in the process of entering a few more, what we have done, we have provided a depreciated cost of 9 departmental kitchens, which we are running at the moment, which we will not be running anymore after finalization of all the contracts. That also we have provided, INR 2 crores of that total. So that is -- these are the main reasons for this.

As far as your concern for future, I see there is no problem ahead because we are already working on long -term contracts. Our e-catering business has already crossed 1 lakh mark per day. Our -- we have entered into an MoU with Central Armed Police Forces. We are sure to get new trains, many more new trains because of the addition of the capacity by railways. And last, but not the least, you are aware that -- we all are aware of that 1,400 ABSS stations are -- Amrit Bharat Stations are being upgraded. We have an opportunity to grab many business there of static type, like food plazas at stations along with retiring room, etc. So I see a robust future rather than a concern.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure, sir. Just a related follow-up. You mentioned that there was some one-off pertaining to 9 departmental catering unit -- the cost pertaining to this catering unit. And if I heard it right, you mentioned that amount was INR 2 crores, which again is not a very big sum. And again, you also highlighted that there was 5% GST on mobile catering, but I believe that should be a pass-through.

So I'm still not very clear as to what basically led to a sharp deterioration because from INR 78 crores in terms of absolute EBIT, we are down to about INR 46 crores, which is a swing of about INR 30 crores, INR 40 crores. So if you can just probably call out one big cost line item, which is sitting in the...

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I got your point, Mr. Joshi. I mentioned about INR 2 crores that I want to be very fair with us that we don't want to continue with the legacy. If you are closing down, then INR 2 crores is also a very important figure. But the main reason which I told you was the annual overhead charging onto the segment of administrative cost.

I'll just give you an example of it. INR 21 crores was the administrative cost. And because this segment revenue confirms to around 45% to 50% of the revenue, so around 50% of that has been charged on this segment. So though our overall profit is best ever, we have followed that formula of charging overhead as per the segmental revenue. So here, we have charged around INR 11 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: This is much clear. Sir, second bookkeeping question is with respect to the jump in CWIP on your balance sheet. So if I see the CWIP number for FY '24, that is at about INR 440 crores. And the swing is quite high because in FY '23, that number was INR 33 crores. So can you highlight what does this pertain to given the fact that we do not

have any major capex lined up?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Last year, it was as an advance -- capital advance for making our offices. This year, we have charged to capital works-in-progress. We have already bought it. We have paid it. We are already in the process of making our -- renovating the process for final view.

Jinesh Joshi: Okay. Got that. Sir, one last question from my side. If you can just provide a breakup between the convenience and non-convenience fee for the quarter and also the total number of tickets booked.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So you will be happy to know that this quarter we have booked an average daily tickets 12.91 lakh, which is the highest ever again. And this financial year, we have achieved a daily ticket booking of 12.38 lakh tickets per day as compared to 11.82 lakhs tickets per day last year.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, and the breakup between convenience and non-convenience fee for the quarter, if you can just share that?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: INR 1.18 crores of total non-convenience fee, and INR 224 crores is the convenience fee.

Jinesh Joshi: These are the figures for the full year, right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: We will give you the breakup. There is no problem. We will share that with you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Pranav Mashruwala from Dolat Capital.

Pranav Mashruwala: Sir, just a question on Catering business. So right now, we have about 470- plus trains and 700- plus trains under Tier 3. So what are our plans to add more units for FY -- whatever current units under FY '24? And what would be your plans for FY '25?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. Mr. Pranav, we -- at the moment, putting together, we are running 1,265 units in all. And this includes all kinds of contracts, mobile contracts. But as the new trains will get introduced, we'll add the numbers. I can't give that number right now because it is basically over the years regularly trains are introduced, and we are asked to provide the catering services.

Now, your concern, maybe how many more numbers we'll be able to add. So what is the expectation? So exact number, I can't give, but we all listen from the various speeches or various notification or various press release by railways and its ministry, we get to know that mostly they are now working to introduce more and more number of Vande Bharat trains. And this opens for us a very good opportunity to add numbers and numbers and numbers.

Pranav Mashruwala: And the current capacity utilization at -- about -- of our Rail Neer plants?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, last year, it was 11 lakh bottles per day that we were utilizing. This year, we have improved it to 12 lakh bottles per day. And you will be happy to know that at the moment, we are like utilizing around -- supplying around 14.5 lakh bottles per day.

Pranav Mashruwala: This is a bit lesser than FY '23. FY '23, we had about 15.52 lakh bottles per day, so So, we will leave it for the decline?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, no, that may be a peak average because what I got the information, I will capture it. It was 11 lakh only. And this year, it has improved to 12 lakh for this benefit.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Rohit Jain from Tara Capital.

Rohit Jain: Just some more questions regarding the catering business. Can you help us understand what's the status of the dispute on license fee? Where are we on that? And whenever that dispute is resolved, how much incremental revenue from licensee fee can we expect going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I could not get your name, sorry.

Rohit Jain: Yes, my name is Rohit , Rohit Jain.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Rohit, you know that this matter is under sub judice. And I should not share this in a public forum. Thank you very much.

Rohit Jain: Okay. I mean I understand that, but can you just tell us how much is the

claim from your side? I mean, how much are you claiming that you are entitled to receive?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, it would not be good on my part to share any number.

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Rohit Jain: Fair enough. Fair enough. So for the year, the margin for the catering business, I think, was around 12%, if I'm not mistaken. There were some overhead expenses that you had to allocate in the fourth quarter. Can you help us sort of -- can you tell us what would the margin look like for FY '25? What is the number that we should work with for the entire year?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: See, our -- I'm looking forward to around 15%.

Rohit Jain: Okay. So FY '25, 15% is the number that we should sort of work with?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes.

Rohit Jain: Understood. And in the quarter, there was a sequential decline in the margins for the Ticketing segment. I think it declined from 83odd percent level to 80%. Can you help us understand what drove that? And what is the kind of number that we should work with in this segment going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. You see, it is -- because of the government policy on UPI. Nowadays, UPI is much more in use. And there, we are charging less than a normal ticketing, right? Here, we charge INR 20 and INR10, around 1/3 in discount tickets.

Rohit Jain: So can you tell us what was the percentage of tickets booked using UPI in this quarter versus earlier quarters? And what should we expect going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Exact figure, I will give you for the quarter by details. But overall, you see it has increased to 39%. It was 33%.

Rohit Jain: So it has increased from 39% to -- 33% to 39%. So would it be fair to say that if this number stays around this level, then 80% would be the new norm for convenience fee?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I could not get your question.

Rohit Jain: Sorry. I mean what I'm trying to say is that if the percentage of tickets booked using UPI, let's say, is around 39% going forward then should the margin in the Ticketing segment be around 80% going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: See, you should see it like this in absolute terms, how much we are increasing. And from 83% booking as one day, how can we improve to say 85% kind of thing. So here, I have to say 2 things. First thing is, yes, something between 80%, 83%. That's if you take a real assess about this. But if you see that we are exploring on non-convenience fee to improve our margin.

Rohit Jain: Okay. I have 2 more questions. One question that I have is, when should we expect, let's say, next round of tariff hikes for the Catering segment?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It's an ongoing process and it is not dependent on us. It is taken by -- a decision taken by a ministry based on many things. One amongst them is the market inflation and all.

Rohit Jain: Okay. But -- I mean any tentative time line, whether it's -- it can happen this year, next year? Or do you have any clarity at all?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see last time also I told that life expectancy has now increased to 79 years. So we can't say that each person will live to that and who will live to that. So what I'm trying to say and suggest here that I'm not the authority so I should not comment. Whenever the situation arises, it happens.

Rohit Jain: And just one last feedback from my side, and this has been mentioned on IRCTC's call earlier also. It would be really helpful if you can release the deck with your earnings release, which has all the granular data regarding number of tickets booked using UPI, a number of tickets booked every day. It would be helpful for us as investors, if you -- if we have a deck so that we can sort of get those data in a readily available manner.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I don't see any problem in this.

Moder

ator: And the next question is from the line of Madhuchanda Dey from MC Pro.

Madhuchanda Dey : So I have a couple of questions. The first question is on the Tourism margin. I mean we see a drop again in the fourth quarter. And the margin has kind of been pretty volatile one earlier in the year. It was because of the haulage charges. So now can you explain what is the sustainable level of margin in the Tourism segment.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So it should be like 8% to 9%.

Madhuchanda Dey : And any particular reason why it dropped to 5.9% in the fourth quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, because of charging of -- the haulage charge on Tejus revenue by Railways with retrospect effect. That is the main cause.

Madhuchanda Dey : So that continued in the fourth quarter also?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, no. The issue is not that. The issue is that a retrospective, it implemented with the retrospective effect. And we have already we presented to Ministry of Railway in this regard.

Madhuchanda Dey : Okay. Understood. So -- I mean what makes you confident about 8% kind of a margin going forward? The haulage charges will not be implemented? Or it is after factoring in the haulage charges?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I could not get your questions properly. Come again.

Madhuchanda Dey : My question is in FY '25, would you still be glad to pay the haulage charges to the Railway?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: See, if I run the train, I have to bring operating efficiency and do some marketing effort to improve our like occupancy and improved non-fare revenue. I have look forward for other things for the profit or margin or revenue. This is how -- have been like a railway or airlines work.

Madhuchanda Dey : Okay. And my second question is a housekeeping one. You have reported a revenue of INR 342.4 crores in the Internet ticketing. If you could break it up between convenience and non-convenience, please?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, it is around INR 224 crores is a convenience fee and remaining is a non -convenience.

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Madhuchanda Dey : And what is the total number of tickets sold in the fourth quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It is 12.91 lakh per day. I can give you the numbers. That we'll be able to send you also. Let me see. Total ticket book is 11,74,45,000.

Madhuchanda Dey : 11,74,45,000. Okay. That's it.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Any such information you want, you can send mail to our C IRO, Mr. Anil Sharma will be happy to share that.

Madhuchanda Dey : Yes. As one of our colleague pointed out, if you could put it in a deck that would really be helpful. We will avoid all this housekeeping questions, hence forward. My last question is which seg -- like in FY '24, Catering business was the key driver of revenue growth. Going forward in FY '25 and beyond, what are the segments which are going to kind of lead the growth according to you?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, if -- before answering that, first of all, let us understand or let me explain that, we are working in an environment and largely environment related to railway at the moment. And if you see how railway is growing or how infrastructure and railway is growing, how the opportunity in the economy growing and railway percent particularly growing. I see that business opportunity starts with booking of tickets and then serving these people with our catering rail neer and tourism packages or tourism products.

So I see -- whereas I see that there will be incremental growth in the ticketing, but we have yet to capture the other 3 products to -- it's a good level. So opportunity is there. Our product mix will certainly change and which is changing also, you see quarter -by-quarter. So in absolute terms, we will be certainly going very high. But as the product mix will increase, the profit margin of the segment will decide the ultimate things.

Moderator: And the ne

xt question is from the line of Deepesh Lakhani from Dolat Capital.

Deepesh Lakhani: Yes. So I just wanted to know what led growth in State Teertha segment in this quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see this quarter is basically election declared. So model code of conduct has been implemented. So I can give you the figure. We will share the figure. But first say, this quarter, is not for this specific case of business because we have MoU with 6 or 7 states, but we are not able to run the trains , right? We have MoU with Chhattisgarh. We have MoU with Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, Goa, all these states we have MoU. There is a demand, but we are not able to -- we could not able to run the train because of model code of conduct.

Deepesh Lakhani: Okay. And also wanted to know how many prepaid trains are there in catering? And the margins operated in prepaid catering are lower or higher than the non-prepaid ones?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see there are 563 prepaid trains. Yes, just a moment. Please hold on. We have 120 prepaid trains and remaining 443 mail express trains and we have 702 this T SV. Certainly, if you go by the train, the train wise, then prepaid trains will have certainly better margin or better revenue

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potential than the mail express because here, you charge the customer at the time of booking the tickets. So it is certainly more.

Deepesh Lakhani: Okay. And just a bookkeeping question. I wanted to know the I -PAY revenues for this quarter ?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It is around INR 100 something in this quarter.

Deepesh Lakhani: Sorry, can you come again?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It is INR 22.35 crores.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Ayush, an Individual Investor.

Ayush: Just want to go ahead with regards to the catering business. So we have seen like good growth trajectory this year.

Just wanted to understand about how the recent tie -ups with Swiggy, Zomato is playing out? And if you can comment on incremental revenue from incremental revenue contribution from the aggregators?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, we have started this year with around 60,000, 60,000 bookings per day, it has crossed 1 lakh mark during this month only. So it's a very good growing and already, we have boarded 2 main aggregators. So I feel that it's good business for us and we have 15% margin. You see, we booked around INR 1.5 crores worth of booking daily, and we get 15% out of that.

Ayush: Okay. And is it like you have expanded to all the stations? Or is it just like 50, 60, which you highlighted like when -- once you signed up the MoU?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No. We have 407 stations already covered and we'll expand it slowly.

Ayush: And how is the trajectory going ahead like in FY '25, what are your expectations with regards to the thing?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Internal target, we have cash around INR 1.5 lakh not to be disclosed.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Hardik Kanthariya , an Individual Investor.

Hardik Kanthariya : Sir, I want to ask one question. A couple of quarters ago, we saw one filing that we have formed a new company with the payment gateway business. So, I just wanted to ask, is it only for the book ticket side? Or do you also want to get into the payment gateway business as well?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, we are applying for license with -- from RBI, of course, for payment gateway.

Hardik Kanthariya : Does it mean that we'll provide the payment gateway services to the enterprises? Or is it only for the -- our own ticketing business?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, it will be for everybody.

Moderator: And the next question is from the line of Rattan Joneja from CoValue Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

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Rattan Joneja : Sanjay, sir, I have a

few questions for you regarding Internet ticketing. My first question is about the recent announcement of the -- to remove the wait list passengers by the Indian Railways with a span of 3 to 5 years. Now does it mean that for these trains, the unreserved category will go away, and you will have to -- they will come on our site to book the tickets. That's my first question.

Second question is our rates for convenience fees are the same as for Vande Bharat versus the normal other trains? Is there a plan to increase the tariffs or change it to the mode -- percentage mode in the near future?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You told about waiting list ticket in next 3, 4 years, very specific it is 2,000 charges. And it does not mean that wait -- this unreserved ticketing will go away and the coaches will go away. What I could understand from the various notifications, not official notification, news reporting and all, the government is thinking of providing a smooth transition facility, transport facility that is environment friendly, that is railway. And there, you need not have a waiting list. They will enhance the capacity to ensure that we give the ticket as we did that.

And if you see the pipeline, if you see the investment like INR 2.4 lakh crore s being invested in railways, DF CC also is coming up sharing line capacity from the diagonals and the number of coaches and locos being planned, number of Vande Bharat trains being planned. So I think that does not mean that unreserved coaches will go away. That will remain there. In unreserved, you don't need a waiting list. You can board the train with the unreserved ticket. So that's the first question.

The second question is about the convenience fee in Vande Bharat train, which is this other trains. It is the same. There is no change. And is there any plan? Once we plan, you will know.

Thank you very much.

Moderator: As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to management for closing comments.

Ajit Kumar : Thank you very much for your I mean, insights and what we see the questions, there is always

an opportunity to understand and learn and drive for the future. And if there is any other -- I mean, with your query and all that, the C IRO, Mr. Anil Sharma you can always send it and we love that your -- any suggestion is welcome. And so we look forward that in the next quarter, we will come with a new robust growth. Thank you very much.

Moderator: On behalf of Dolat Capital, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Aug 2024

No. 2019 /IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 August 21 , 202 4

BSE Limited

1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotu nda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
“Exchange Plaza”, C -1, Block -G,
Bandra -Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “Q1FY’2 5 Earnings
Conference Call” held on August 1 4, 202 4.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma’am,

In reference to our communication dated August 0 6, 2024, please find enclosed
herewith the transcript of “Q1FY’2 5 Earnings Conference Call” held on Wednesday,
August 1 4, 202 4.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of
Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

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“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limi ted
Q1 FY’25 Earnings Conference Call ”
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MANAGEMENT : MR.SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. AJIT KUMAR – DIRECTOR , FINANCE AND CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
DR. LOKIAH RAVIKUMAR -- DIRECTOR - CATERING
SERVICES –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM
CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN - DIRECTOR (TOURISM AND
MARKETING) –INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN– DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS
LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode, and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you and you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Good morning, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q1 FY '25 conference call of IRCTC Limited. And I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the company, and he's also -- he also have along with his other Director of respective department. Over to you, Sanjay -ji, for taking the proceeding ahead.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thanks, Rahul. Good morning, everyone, and a warm welcome to IRCTC earnings call for the quarter ended June 30, 2024. At the outset ; I'm pleased to share with you all that your company has been upgraded from Schedule B to Schedule A company by Government of India based on our past performance. It will strengthen our organizational structure and is a precondition for taking up company to a new level that is from Mini -Ratna to Navratna. Yesterday, the company has announced its financial results for the first quarter of 2025, and the results have been disclosed in both stock exchanges.

I will begin with a brief overview of our Q1 '25 performance, following which, our Director of Finance and CFO of this company will provide a detailed analysis of our business segment performance. Afterwards, we'll open the floor for the question-answer session. I am pleased to

report that Q1 FY '25 has been another exceptional quarter for our company with an all-time high profit of INR308 crores. This represents a growth of 8.2% on Q -on-Q basis and a significant increase of 32.5% year -on-year basis.

The Catering and Rail Neer segments were the primary drivers in Q -to-Q comparison, wherein the profit increased by 68% and 27%, respectively, in Catering and Rail Neer segment. This performance underscores the strength and potential of the business areas.

Similarly, on Y -to-Y basis, the bottom line of all the segments, except Tourism has grown uniformly. Our EBITDA for the quarter also raised up to INR 375 crores, marking a 9.32% growth year -on-year basis and an approximately 3.38% on a Q -to-Q basis. EBITDA margin has improved to 33.47% up from 31.41% on a Q -to-Q basis and flattish on year -on-year basis, highlighting our operational efficiency and effective cost management.

Overall, these results underscore our company with strong performance and resilience. We are committed to continuing this positive momentum and delivering sustained growth and profitability in the coming quarters.

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With that, I conclude my opening remarks and hand over the call to our Director -Finance and CFO, Shri Ajit Kumar to provide further insight into the financial and segmental performance of the company. Thank you very much.

Ajit Kumar: Good afternoon, everyone. I hope you and your loved ones are in good health. I'll begin with a brief overview of our quarterly performance, comparing it to the previous quarters followed by our question and answer session. The quarterly performance of the Q1 FY '25. We have achieved another quarter of robust growth with a profit of INR 308 crores, reflecting an 8.2% quarter -over -quarter and 32.5% year -on-year increase. This growth was primarily driv

en by

our Catering segment, which, despite the relatively lower margin made a significant contribution to our overall revenue.

Now the business segment highlights. The first segment, Internet ticketing, the Internet ticketing segment continued to demonstrate resilience, especially with the transition of reserved 2S tickets back to unreserved tickets. In spite of the fact that we are nearing saturation

with almost 84% of tickets now being booked through our portal, and we understand that there is a very -- have an incremental increase will be there, but still we can -- we want to continue with the same revenue growth. The segment reported revenue of INR 329 crores, reflecting a 13.4% year -over -year growth with a slight quarter -over -quarter decline of 3.9% attributed to the typical seasonal pick in quarter 4 when tickets are booked in advance for the upcoming summer season.

Additionally, our residual income from sources other than Google and Facebook, characterize

a part of other nonconventional income decreased by INR 12 crores compared to the last quarter. In spite of that, the margin remained robust at 82.76% compared to 80.34% quarter-over-quarter and 82.73 % year-over-year, underscoring our strong market position as well as operational efficiency.

The next segment, Catering, our Catering segment maintained a strong growth momentum with revenue rising to INR 559 crores, an increase of 5.3% quarter-over-quarter and 17.1% year-over-year. While the margin moderated to 13.94% compared to 8.75% quarter-over-quarter and 14.61% year-over-year. This segment's revenue growth underscores the increasing demand and our ability to scale the operations effectively.

Now next, Tourism. The Tourism segment saw a decrease of 38.1% quarter-over-quarter and 12.4% year-over-year, with a revenue of INR 124.8 crores in Q1 FY '25. This subdued performance is due to the non-operational State Teertha trains and Bharat Gaurav trains in quarter 1, primarily due to the general parliamentary elections in April and May '24. Despite this, segment remained resilient and showed its potential for future growth, for which we are taking suitable steps.

Rail Neer, this reported steady revenue of INR 107 crores, marking a 34.4% quarter-over-quarter and 16.5% year-over-year growth. The margin remained stable at 12.65% compared to 13.34% quarter-over-quarter and 13.17% year-over-year. Notably, our absolute margin increased by 27.4% quarter-over-quarter and 11.9% year-over-year, showcasing our efforts to enhance profitability by expanding our capital utilization as well as adding the new capacities.

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Now the overall our Q1 FY '25 results highlight a successful quarter of growth and the strategic execution. We remain committed to building this momentum and delivering sustained value to our stakeholders. At the end of FY '24, the company's cash and bank balances stood at INR 2,908 crores with a net worth of INR 3,538 crores.

This concludes my remarks. Now we can straightway move to the question-answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Deepak from Sundaram Mutual Fund.

Deepak: Sir, I have a couple of questions regarding your Catering segment. So sir, as per your annual report, the income from your premium trains, Duronto, et cetera, stood at INR 1,000 crores.

And you mentioned in the annual report that in FY '24, you serviced around 51 Vande Bharat trains. So out of this INR 1,000 crores, how much would be the revenue generated from Vande Bharat train in FY '24?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Roughly 12%.

Deepak: Okay. Sir, in continuation to that, so FY '24, we ended our Catering EBITDA margin at around 13% to 14%. Now would the Vande Bharat EBITDA margin, would it be similar? Or would it be, let's say, a 200 to 300 basis points higher than your overall

margin?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: See, so far, a premium segment is concerned, we have already introduced our cluster system as I told last time. And this is giving confidence to our licensees to share more revenue with us because it's a long-term contract being given to them. And over a couple of clusters we have already finalized and some of the clusters we have already offered slice.

So generally, it should be on the same range. But in the time to come more and more Vande Bharat trains are coming. So premium trains are certainly giving us a better revenue than the non-premium trains. So I'm very hopeful of getting a more and more percentage of revenue, while the number of trains or prepaid trains increase.

Deepak: Okay. So sir, then margin should also see even improvement, right, with this premium train revenue getting added?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Actually, you see, if you see our -- this segment, then mail express and prepaid trains, there are 2 kinds of trains. So here in the prepaid trains, you have an assured business, but the tag is your meal charges are already prefixed. That is an administered price. So if you see the percentage-wise per meal charge, it will never increase, but overall, the more number of premium trains or prepaid trains are introduced, our volume and revenue and profit will increase in absolute terms.

Deepak: Okay. And sir, second question would be, so you have also mentioned in the annual report that in the Mail Express part, you are currently servicing around 440 onboard and 700 to through TSV, train side vending. So total, you are servicing around 1,200 kind of number in mail

express. Now if I look at Railway Board numbers on FY '23, the daily average train running, that is Mail Express was around 4,000. And we were serving around 1,000, 1,200 as of FY '24.

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So that is roughly 28% of the total market that we can serve. So is my understanding correct that right now, there is a very big room for us to grow from 1,200 Mail Express train to which we are catering to around, let's say, 4,000 at peak capacity?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Very good question, Deepak. May I know from which city you are talking or where do you stay?

Deepak: Sir, Chennai?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Chennai. So you must be aware that there are suburban trains running on to Chennai and quite in large number at Mumbai, in Chennai and in Kolkata, Delhi, all the metros. So all these trains are not our customers, particularly Mail Express kind of thing. So if you see the number of trains Mail Express trains, which are running for more than 12 hours, which are not overnight trains because every passenger who comes to take a train -- overnight trains, they don't require services of railway or Catering or from IRCTC.

They only at most take the mineral water PDW, you can say, Rail Neer. So we have to eye for trains which are running for more than 12 hours and day trains. So those are our target group.

And accordingly, we are serving them.

Deepak: And sir, that number would be how much? Means...

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That already we have given, 440 and 702. I will give you. The exact number will be sent to you. No problem. It is 440 and 702.

Deepak: Okay. No, sir, I'm saying our -- means total is 4,000, but as you explained, our total addressable trains is not 4,000.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: `1,259. To be specific 1,259. As on date 1,259 trains including prepaid trains, we are running services of IRCTC.

Deepak: Okay. And sir, 1 last question I had. So sir, last time, Indian railways, they took a food tariff hike in 2019, prior to that it was 2013. So taking precedents from the past average 6 or 7 years, there is a food tariff hike, which comes. So assuming, let's say, if it does come in 2025 or '26, okay, how would our Catering revenue growth trajectory change? Let's say, for example, for FY '24 to '27, i

f we were hypothetically building in, let's say, 15% CAGR in catering revenue growth, with this tariff hike, how can the growth trajectory change for Catering revenue? Will it be 15% plus 5%? Or how would that change?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, generally, these are all hypothetical situations. When we see increase in the rates, it is always lagging behind in cost recovery. So to my mind, our profit will -- in the average of that ratio only between hovering around 14% to 20% only.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Madhuchanda Dey from MC Pro.

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes. I have one housekeeping question. If you could give me the breakup between the convenience and the non-convenience fees for Internet ticketing for the quarter? I have one more question.

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: We have a convenience fee in quarter 1 '25 -- 1 '25 is INR 224 crores and non-convenience fee -- is INR 224 crores is the convenience fee and INR 105 crores is non-convenience fee.

Madhuchanda Dey: And there, the non-convenience fee was lower. You had mentioned something if you could just come back again on that.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, no. Convenience fee is INR 224 crores.

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes, I got that sir. But you mentioned. Yes, can you hear me?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, sure, Madhu. Please.

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes. So you mentioned something in your opening remark that some INR 12 crores reduction in non-convenience fee. If you could explain that a little bit, please? I missed that point.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Actually, if you compare Q1 '24 to Q1 '25, as against INR 198 crores of convenience fee revenue, we have earned in Q1 '25 INR 224 crores. Similarly, in Q1 '24, we earned INR 92 crores as non-convenience fee, which has increased to INR 105 crores in Q1 '25.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. And the number of tickets?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Just a moment, Madhu. If you compare our Q4 of '24 with Q1 '25, there is a slight dip in non-convenience fee from INR 118 crores, it is showing INR 105 crores. In this INR 118 crores, we have onetime exceptional earnings of INR 12 crores from social media advertisement, which happened in the month of March because of declaration of elections.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. Got it. Got it.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That's what you want to know?

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes. Okay. So that was there in -- INR 12 crores was there in Q4, which is not there in Q1. I got that point. If you could just share the numbers of tickets sold in the quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. You want daily average or you want complete?

Madhuchanda Dey: No, I want the full for Q1. I mean the total cumulative ticket.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Q1 '25 is 11.81 crores.

Madhuchanda Dey: 11.81 crores for Q1 '25.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Q1 as against Q1 '24 10.43 crores.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. And my last question is, of course, because of the very bad summer, the Rail Neer business has done well, extremely well. So what was the capacity utilization for Rail Neer?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. I am very happy to say that it increased from 23% to 86%, and that too when we added 3 more plans.

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Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. So in terms of physical capacity, where does it stand now?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: As the physical capacity, we have 17.68 lakh of bottles per day. And average of this quarter, which we are producing is 14 plus -- 14 lakh plus per day as against 12.5 lakhs per day last year, last year Q1.

Madhuchanda Dey: And any more plans of capacity addition in the next couple of years?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, one plant of 72,000 bottles per day is getting commissioned in Vijayawada, hopefully in the month of October, we'll be able to do, hopefully.

Madhuchanda Dey: All the best.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Ma'am, one question

from this side.

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: This is not only the summer. It is your organization and the people behind that. They have done a marvellous job. That's why we could capture this much business. Thank you very much.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Mohit Jain from Tara Capital Partners.

Mohit Jain: So my question is on Catering segment. The margins there have been pretty volatile quarter - over-quarter. Can you tell us -- can you help us with the steady state margin for this business? I think you mentioned 14% to 20% as a band, which is pretty wide. So what really caused such a big volatility in the Catering margin? And secondly, there were some pending cases, I think, regarding previous tariff hike that was going on, what is the status for those of them?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So far as first question is concerned, one hypothetical question was raised by someone. So I made a hypothetical reply that it may range from 14% to 20% if everything improve. As for the hypothetical question was asked. Generally, it is varying between 12% to 15%, depending upon which kind of services are introduced in higher number.

And as we understand, as government and railway, as I understand, are coming with more number of Vande Bharat -type of train, so we have a better chance of getting that business of prepaid and premium trains where we can, in absolute terms, we can earn more and grow more. Second question, I just missed your second question. What's your question? .

Mohit Jain: My second question was regarding the pending cases regarding previous tariff hike. Some of them, if I remember correctly, were still to be decided and were sub-judice. What is the status of them?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see the -- any matter which is sub-judice, no comment should be made. This is what we have learned. So I will not make any comment. Thank you.

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Mohit Jain: Understood. And just coming back to my first question, there is significant volatility quarter - over-quarter in the Catering segment. Can you help us understand what drives this quarterly volatility in the Catering margins?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. You see we are in seasonal business. So not only Catering margin, if you see my -- all segments, you will find a pattern. Pattern is depending upon season. Suppose in the last quarter, January to March, you're booking a ticket for, say, June. May, June, July, where your summer holidays are there. So if you see the pattern in the IT side, you will find that revenue is good. Whereas in Catering side, the revenue will grow in the June quarter. So that's how it happened. It's a cyclical. It's a seasonal business, you can say. If you see, you will find a pattern. If you want, I can draw and send it to you also.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Jyoti Singh from Arihant Capital Markets Limited.

Jyoti Singh: Sir, two questions from my side. What is the capex guidance for the FY '25 we are targeting for the Rail Neer plant? And second is, what kind of growth and margin we are earning from the devotional trip train that we plan for the 11 days or 12 days for the specific location? So on that, sir?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So far as Rail Neer is concerned, we have already planned additional capacity, Vijayawada plant is coming. And then we are in the process of identifying 2, 3 more plants and we have

not yet decided the model. If we go for departmental model, certainly, the investment capex will be more. So this is regarding Rail Neer. We have -- almost we have under process of finalization, the final stage is Mysore and Varanasi but not yet decided the model that we are discussing and taking the feasibility report.

Your second question is the devotional train. You see our -- what is our USP? We have 2 USPs. One is we are fit to take mass tourism. And second

is, we are known for running train --

tourist packages in a most reasonable price range. So we are not looking of increasing the margin per se, but volume will add to our margin in absolute terms.

So devotional trip, we have 2 kinds of devotional trips, one which we get from state government, which we say that we take this and the other is Vande Bharat trains -- sorry, Bharat Gaurav trains, where we design a product and sell in the market to our general market and get the bookings. So in the first time, the margin is good and which compensates -- it is around 20%. And in the second category, it is 9% to 11%.

Jyoti Singh: And sir, just last question on the overall growth and margin side, what are the targets?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Target means the coming year?

Jyoti Singh: Yes, sir.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So you see we are already -- if you see our CAGR. Our growth is 17.3% over 5 years. And if you see our CAGR of margin that is net profit, it is growing 21% CAGR. So hopefully, we'll try to do if not better than equal. Thank you very much.

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Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vivek Rath. .

Vivek Rath: You mentioned that if I got it right, during the initial part of the discussion that there are 1,219 trains, which we are catering to, that's our customer, right? So any probable more trains which we can -- which we will be able to serve? You mentioned that overnight trains are not really our customer, that's a problem.

But apart from that, are we looking -- what are we looking at as a probable market, let's say, where we are going to service because it looks like Catering is coming out to be the dominant area?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It's a very good and pertinent question. And if you -- I missed your name, please.

Vivek Rath: It's Vivek Rath, sir.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Vivek, you see how India is moving and how is railway is moving. If we see that, we get our answer. First is economy is booming, Secondly, the DRC is coming and sparing the line capacity for normal train running in the existing infrastructure. And thirdly, government is consistently investing into the infrastructure of railways. This year also, they have planned to invest INR2.6 lakh crores.

So when everything which is indicating is towards adding more and more and more number of trains. And with the Vande Bharat technology being used and being populated, demand from everywhere is to run more and more trains Vande Bharat trains. And this will certainly add to the business in which IRCTC is in. so I find that I can't give you a number right now, but I can only give you a good hope. Thank you.

Regarding your second question, Catering, we are -- besides the normal Catering business, we have also come into e-catering. And on our e-catering platform, we have more than 19 aggregators, including Zomato and Swiggy and I'm happy to inform you that in that business also, we have grown both in terms of meals booked and the revenue earned. If you see the comparison of quarter 1 '24 with quarter 1 of '25, there is an increase of around 35% in average meals per day booked and 40.9% is the revenue growth on Q-to-Q basis. So this will certainly give us a good business. Thank you.

Vivek Rath: One last follow-up question, sir. One of the participant mentioned before is that 2019 was the last time we increased the Catering prices. So any plans of increasing the prices over the next few months or year?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: See, this is decided by Railway Board -- Ministry of Railway. So as the trend is there, we can only hope, but we can't give any confirm assurance.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kanchan Mangaonkar from Anvil Research.

Kanchan Mangaonkar: Sir, my question is regarding the number of trains. Can you please share the breakup of the 1,259 trains that is prepaid, how much was n

on-prepaid and DCF?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: Sure, Kanchan. It's 117 prepaid trains, 440 mail express trains and 702 mail express where we run PSP. Mail express were 440 with pantry. So it's 1,259.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Deepak from Sundaram Mutual Fund.

Deepak: Yes. Sir, I had one more question regarding non-convenience fee revenue portion. I mean, let's say, if I want to take a 2 - to 3-year view of where that revenue can be? And what are the steps are we taking to grow that non-convenience fee revenue within the Internet ticketing segment?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see exact number, I can't share even if I like. But if you see the past, INR 91 crores have increased to INR 105 crores, and we are trying our best to like improve this further because as you add number of tickets, which is happening, so the interest of like your customers, your bankers and advertisers improve. So I'm very hopeful. Thank you very much.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kanchan Mangaonkar from Anvil Research.

Kanchan Mangaonkar: Yes. Sorry for the follow -up. So you shared the breakup for this quarter. Can you please share the breakup for last year as well for Q1 '24?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: We'll share you separately.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vivek Rath, an individual investor.

Vivek Rath: Sir, you mentioned around 11 crores tickets booked this quarter if I got it right. So can we get the revenue being generated out of these tickets and then for tickets our total revenue is ?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You want to know the revenue for 11.81 crores tickets which we have booked, it's INR 224 crores.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ashish, an Individual Investor.

Ashish : My question is regarding the plans to grow the ticketing business for flights, buses and of course, hotels as well. So would the company be planning to grow revenues and business from these ticket in places?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you for good question. You see, there is an ample scope of giving flight services and hotel services to our reserved passengers. So from here, we can only grow that much I can tell you. And we have certain plans to do it, which we can't share at the moment, but let it happen, you will know. Thank you very much.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Shruti from Prabhudas Lilladher.

Shruti: I just wanted to know the share of UPI transactions for the quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It's 45%. Last one, it was 37%.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rattan Joneja from CoValue Technologies Private Limited.

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Rattan Joneja: I'd like to know what is the revenue from Vande Bharat trains this quarter? And my second question is when do we plan to increase or bring at parity, the UPI ticketing fees.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So to my knowledge, we can give you a separate figure also, but to my acknowledge information at the moment, INR 48 crores is the revenue in this quarter from Vande Bharat trains. And so far as UPI is concerned. Sorry, INR 12 crores is the figure for Vande Bharat train in this quarter. And the exact figure, we'll share with you. And the second question, which you wanted to know about the charges on UPI?

Rattan Joneja: Yes. When do we bring it at parity?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: What are you interested in? Should we improve the revenue or should revenue improve the charges? What should we do?

Rattan Joneja: My question is -- yes. So others are charged INR30. In UPI, you are charging INR 20. So my question is that when do you -- when are you planning -- now it's already at 45%. When do you plan...

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It's a very good question, Rattan. Let me tell you when we were working with the UPI no

t

giving this concession, we were earning only 73 % of the business. Now we are doing 84 % of the business of railway. And with UPI there, we are expected to grow further. So what do you suggest? What should the management should do? .

Rattan Joneja: So this is a 50% rise from 20% to 30%.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No. You see, in absolute terms, we are growing just because UPI has permitted all the customers, which we are otherwise not coming to us. They're now booking tickets with us. The total number enhanced from 73% to 84% and which further grow of UPI number will likely to grow it further. So management has taken a call that to keep it like this and earn in the absolute number and volume. Thank you very much.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital.

Rahul Jain: I just wanted to ask you that are we having any thought processes on price hike in the Rail Neer bottles, which is unchanged for like more than 12 years?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. You see our USP is selling affordable water to the railway passengers. If we don't do that,

then we'll have to face competition with all of the brands. So then ultimately we will lose. So what we are trying to expand our capacity, make an efficient plant running, utilization should improve to 73% to 86% or 87% collection we already brought, we are increasing our capacity, and we want to sell at INR 15 only. Thank you very much.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Vivek Rathi, an individual investor.

Vivek Rathi: So on the community, I wanted to ask are you expecting any changes or this will continue -- even with Vande Bharat and number of things exploring -- increasing you're not expecting any change?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: It's irrespective of trains, already fixed per class, AC and non-AC. That is continuing.

Moderator: As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Lokesh Ravikumar: Thank you all our partners. I'm Ravikumar, the Director, Catering services, IRCTC. Thank you all for showing so much keenness and interest in the working of this company -- of your company and asking very pertinent questions, which will help all not only us to perform much more better and also the other shareholders to come into the interest -- into more interest into IRCTC. Thanks a lot for sparing all your time and energy. And we hope your continued support will take us to the next level. We will continue to grow and make our company, you are part of it to the higher level. Thank you one and all on behalf of the management of IRCTC.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Dolat Capital, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2025

No. 2019 /IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 17th February 2025

BSE Limited
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
“Exchange Plaza”, C -1, Block -G,
Bandra -Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “ Earning Conference
Call on Q3FY25 Results ” held on 11th February 2025 .

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated 3rd February 2025 , please find enclosed
herewith the transcript of “Q3FY 25 Earnings Conference Call” held on Tues day, 11th
February 2025 .

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of
Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a
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“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited
Q3 and 9 Months FY '25 Earnings Conference Call ”
February 11 , 202 5

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR - INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. RABINDRA NATH MISHRA -- DIRECTOR FINANCE--
INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM
CORPORATION LIMITED
DR. LOKIAH RAVIKUMAR – DIRECTOR , CATERING
SERVICES – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. SUDHIR KUMAR– CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER AND
GROUP GENERAL MANAGER , FINANCE – INDIAN
RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION
LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL MARKET
PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Q3 and 9 Months FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited , hosted by Dolat Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star , then zero on your touch -tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you, Elaric. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC Limited , represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the company; Mr. Rabindra Nath Mishra, who is Director Finance. And also, we have today with us Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar, who is Director Catering Services; and Mr. Sudhir Kumar, CFO and GGM, Finance of the company.

And now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, please, Sanjay ji.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Rahul. Very good evening to all of you, and a warm welcome to the IRCTC earnings call for Q3 financial year '25. Today, our company announced its financial results for the third quarter of financial year '25, which have been disclosed on both stock exchanges. I will begin with a brief overview of our Q3 financial year '25 performance, following which our Director of Finance, Mr. Rabindra Mishra, will provide a detailed analysis of our business segment performance. Afterwards, we'll open the floor for the question -and-answer session.

I am pleased to report that Q3 financial year '25 has been another exceptional quarter for our company with an all -time high revenue of INR1,225 crores and a profit of INR341 crores. This represents a revenue growth of approximately 10% and a significant increase of PAT at the rate of 14% approximately on a year -on-year basis. The Catering and Tourism segment were the prime drivers in the quarter -on-quarter comparison with revenue increases of 15% and ho oping 80%, respectively. This performance underscores the strength and potential of these business areas.

Similarly, on a year -on-year basis, revenue across all segments have shown growth. Our EBITDA for the quarter reached INR417 crores, marking a 5.83% growth on a year -on-year basis and 11.8% increase on quarter -on-quarter basis. The EBITDA margin is 34. 04%. Overall, these results highlight the company's strong performance and resilience. We remain committed to sustaining this positive momentum and driving continued growth and profitability in the coming quarters.

With that, I conclude my opening remarks and hand over the call to our Director Finance to provide further insight into the company's financials and segmental performance. Thank you.

Rabindra Mishra: Thank you, CMD sir. Good evening , everyone. I hope you and your loved ones are in very good health . I will begin with a brief overview of our quarterly performance comparing it with the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited
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previous quarter, followed by the question -and-answer session . In Q3 financial year '25, we achieved another quarter of robust growth with a margin of INR341.21 crores, reflecting a 10% quarter -on-quarter increase and 14% year -over-year increase. That way it's a very robust growth. This growth was primarily driven by our Rail Neer and Tourism segment, which despite having relatively lower margin, made signi ficant contribution to our overall revenue. While coming to the business segment hig

hlights, I will mention the detail of all the verticals.

First is Internet Banking . The Internet ticketing segment continued to demonstrate resilience despite nearing saturation with 87.42% approx. of the ticket now being booked through our portal. We acknowledge that incremental growth in ticket booking may be limited from this point onwards. However, we are actively exploring opportunities to enhance our non -

conventional source of income beyond convenience fee.

The segment reported revenue of INR353.72 crores, reflecting a 5.4% year -on-year growth with a slight quarter -on-quarter decline of 4.65% attributed to the seasonal surge in advance booking for the festive season. Additionally, our residual income from other sources categorized under non-convenience fee income increased by INR5.64 crores compared to the previous quarter. Despite this, the EBITDA margin remained strong at 84.71% compared to 81.03% quarter -on-quarter and 83.02% year -on-year, underscoring our strong market position and operational efficiency.

In the Catering Segment. The Catering segment maintained strong growth momentum with revenue rising to INR554.81 crores, which is an increase of 15% quarter -on-quarter and 9% year-on-year. However, the EBITDA margin declined to 12.19% compared to 12.78% quarter -on-quarter and 15.44% year -on-year due to low margins in the segment. The revenue growth highlights the increasing demand for our catering services and our ability to scale operations effectively.

In the Tourism segment, which witnessed a remarkable growth with the revenue reaching INR224 crores in the Q3 financial year '25, marking an 80% quarter -on-quarter increase and 16% increase on year -on-year increase. This exceptional performance was driven by the operation of the luxury segment, that is Maharaja Express, the State Teerth trains and increased business in the Tejas Express.

While coming to the fourth segment, that is Rail Neer. The Rail Neer segment reported steady revenue of INR92.39 crores, reflecting a 7% quarter -on-quarter increase and a 16% year -on-year increase. The EBITDA margin remained stable at 12.84% compared to 10.37% quarter -on-quarter. Additionally, our absolute EBITDA increased by 32% quarter -on-quarter and 464% year-on-year in this segment of Rail Neer, demonstrating our effort to enhance profitability by expanding capital utilization and adding new production capabilities.

Overall, our Q3 financial year '25 results highlight a successful quarter of growth and strategic execution. We remain committed to sustaining the momentum and delivering long -term value to our stakeholders. As of today, the company's net worth is INR3,546 crores.

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This concludes my remarks. We will now proceed to the question -and-answer session. Thanks a lot, everyone.

Moderator: The first question comes from the line of Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, I want to understand how launch of Swa Rail is likely to impact our business. Now what I understand is that this app is developed by CRIS and every online transaction basically will be routed through our booking engine which effectively means that there is no loss of business for us. But what I want to know is how will CRIS benefit out of this? I mean, do we have to pay any share to them from the convenience fee that we earn? Or will they take an additional fee over and above what we charge from the consumer to make money? So just some clarification on that side.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Jinesh. Your question is about super app application. This will have no impact on our convenience fee because this is just one of the many modes which we are doing. So, to my mind, to our mind, this will make no difference because the convenience fee, whatever is being charged to the passengers will be coming straight to IRCTC.

Jinesh Joshi: Perfect. And we don't have to share any quantum with them, right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, no. I already explained it to you that there is no change in anything. We will get the share as we are getting as of now. This is just one -off.

Jinesh Joshi: Got it, sir. And sir, my second question is on our e -Catering business. Just wanted to get some update on that side because we have tied up with Swiggy and Zomato since quite some time to expand our e -Catering business. So, I mean, can you share the progress over here? I mean, how many stations have we covered so far or any volume number that you may want to call out? And lastly, what is our e -Catering?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: May I come in Jinesh? I'm happy to inform you all that from a bigger like 2,000 average meals per day a few quarters back -- this quarter, we have done more than 1 lakh average meals per day, not orders, meals per day. So, in -- if you compare our year -on-year basis, last year, it was 61,522 meals per day. This quarter, we have done 102,561 meals per day. On a quarter -on-quarter basis also, last quarter, Q2, it was 47000 . So, we are growing very fast.

Jinesh Joshi: Possible to share what is the contribution of e -Catering revenue, the total catering revenue? Any number you want to call out?

Moderator: Hello sir, you are not audible.

Jinesh Joshi: I just wanted to know if you want to call out the share of e -Catering revenue for 9 months or maybe for this quarter.

Sanja Kumar Jain: This quarter, we have booked a revenue of INR15 crores as against INR9 crores last year -on-year basis.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, one last bookkeeping question from my side. If you can share the number of tickets that we have booked in this quarter and the convenience fee income? And also, one follow-up on our Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited
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depreciation charge. I believe the new office building was supposed to be capitalized in October '24. But if I look at our depreciation run rate, I mean, it is similar to what it was in the previous quarter. So just wanted to know if that building has been capitalized or not. And once the capitalization happens, what should be our quarterly run rate on the depreciation side.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Jinesh, your question is both morning and evening. So let me first answer your morning. This convenience fee is, this quarter, we achieved INR254 crores and on a year-on-year basis, it was INR239 crores in Q3 '24. And regarding your question on to our capitalization of new office building part, this will be doing in this quarter, Q4 FY25.

Jinesh Joshi: Tickets booked, please.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: What's your question?

Jinesh Joshi: Number of tickets booked.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Total number of tickets you want to know?

Jinesh Joshi: Yes, sir, for the quarter.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: For the quarter, total tickets we have booked is 12.51 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Okay. Got it, sir. I'm fine with the number. Yes. I don't want the base quarter number.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Deepak from Sundaram Mutual Funds.

Deepak: Sir, my first question is with respect to catering. So, I just wanted to understand the relationship between our tariff rate increase and license fees. First, I was reading in one of the document by Railway Board that for the current running contract, let's say, even if the tariff hike comes in the food menu, there won't be any change to the license fee for the contracts which are currently running. Is that understanding, correct? So basically, there won't be any material impact on, let's say, increase in the license fee because of, let's say, higher revision of tariffs. Is that understanding, correct?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Your question is finished? Should I come or should I wait for the next question?

Deepak: Sir, I'll ask one by one, so that it's easier for you

to answer.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, as you correctly read, there is -- there will not be any impact on license fee if the tariff is enhanced because that has also -- that has been clearly indicated in the tender document. So whatever benefit they are expecting to derive because of the tariff enhancement has already been considered by the bidders of the tenders while bidding.

Deepak: And a second question, what would be our Vande Bharat train revenue contribution to Catering and Internet ticketing separately in this quarter, Q3?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: We'll let you know. Thank you.

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Deepak: And sir, coming to Internet ticketing. So, this quarter, we saw a 5% Q-o-Q decline in Internet ticketing. But despite that, our margins have improved by 3, 4 percentage points. So, I just wanted to understand, is that margin sustainable? Or is it one-off in Q3?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, if you see quarter-by-quarter, you are correct that our Internet ticketing revenue is less. It is because of the seasonal nature of bookings. So, in our Q2, we have booked tickets of all the seasons like Diwali, Dussehra, Chhath, which was -- which is not there in Q3. But if you compare with Q3 '24, there is an improvement of 5%. And if you also see the 9-month performance in IT ticketing revenue, it has also increased to INR1,054 crores as against INR953 crores, giving around 11% growth.

Deepak: Sir, I understand that. My question was despite a 5% Q-o-Q decline in revenue, our margins have improved. Okay. So, I just wanted to understand, is that margin which we are currently reporting, 84.7%, is it sustainable going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That you see this all depends on the type of booking. Like when we talk of overall IT earnings, it consists of 2 things. One is convenience fee and another is your NFR, non-fare revenue. So, when we are already doing 87% of the booking, now we are trying to maximize our non-fare revenues. So, this is what will happen now, and that is what has happened.

Deepak: Okay. So basically, the non-convenience fees portion as proportion revenue has gone up. That's why we see an increment in the margins. Is that understanding, correct?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, please.

Deepak: And sir, my final question would be with respect to Tourism. So, you have already provided in your opening remarks that because of luxury trains and Tejas and State Teerth, we saw a very good comeback on tourism revenue this quarter. So, is it sustainable going forward? Or was it kind of one-off because of some events which is happening? And is the margin sustainable? Because I think this quarter, we have reported the highest margin in tourism. Is it sustainable?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Of course, yes. Rather, we'll grow further.

Deepak: Okay. On margin front?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, if you see our luxury train, last year, we did overall in the year INR65 crores. This year, we are expected to come up to more than INR95 crores, and it is giving us around 30% operating margin of our business. So, these kinds of products are already -- you see, there is a euphoria for tourism. All of the world, they are trying to see towards India. So, we are increasing our share of luxury trains, be it Maharaja Express or Golden Chariot. I'm happy to share that for the first time after 2019, we have -- we could run Golden Chariot and there is a good buzz in the market about that.

So, this will continue. We have taken additional rake of Bharat Gaurav train because we are having the business out of that. That is also -- that will also add both revenue and the margin to us. So, I'm seeing margin -- I don't find any reason why, the margin will not be either at the same level or improve further.

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Deepak: Ok

ay, sir. Very encouraging, sir. Sir, my final question would be with respect to one of the regulations, which has kicked in that the advance booking has come down from 4 months to around 2 months, right? And that has impact on the revenue with respect to the cancelled ticket, right? Because we collect our convenience fees even on the cancelled tickets. So, I just want to understand on average, I mean, how much revenue in the Internet Ticketing convenience fees, do we get from cancelled ticket? And what could be the, let's say, revenue loss because of this implication of advance window coming down from 4 months to 2 months?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Actually, so far as the number of days of E RP is concerned, it will not cause any difference in convenience fees, first thing. Because there are number of fleets are there and every day, there is -- you see many trains -- you see large investment has taken place in railways since last 3, 4 years. And this year also, there is a good budget capex support to the railways. So, all these things will make it possible to run more and more number of trains. So far as the capacity is concerned, that will -- that is bound to increase or enhance.

And we should not subject to -- we should not be very, very selfish that we earn out of the cancellation charge. So, what we should focus is how we can provide better and better services and more and more ticket booking. So, our target is that. So, I see it with that perspective. And there, I am finding the business is used to come to us. Thank you very much.

Deepak: Sir, that is fine. Your goal and your inclination towards public service, that's very encouraging. But what I wanted to understand ask you in simple terms that out of this INR254 crores convenience fees, which you booked in Q3, how much of that has means, what is the proportion of cancelled ticket revenue in this INR254 crores?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: One thing I want to share with you, the cancellation -- when the tickets are cancelled, earlier also, we were not taking -- charging anything. We used to take convenience fee only and only on -- at the time of booking. So, it will not have any impact on to us.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Madhuchanda Dey from Money control Pro.

Madhuchanda Dey: I have a housekeeping question. Sir, the first one, which is if your convenience fee is INR254 crores, so the non-ticketing is about INR100 crores. Is that the correct figure? And if you could share the figure for the corresponding quarter, which is Q3 FY '24.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, this is INR239 crores is the convenience fee Q3 '24 and INR96 crores is the non-convenience fee, INR96 crores in Q3 '24.

Madhuchanda Dey: And the number of tickets sold is 11.46 crores or that's a different number?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. On year-on-year basis, the tickets sold is 12.51 crores this year. And last year, it was 11.48 crores, which is 9% of the total sale of ticket, which has increased.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. Got it. I have a very simple question. If you could explain, you ended last year, which is FY '24 on a Catering margin of 13.8%. But I mean now that is at around 12.2%. I mean just wanted to understand what is the trajectory? What is pulling down the Catering margin?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, if you see the Catering margin, we have already explained when Director of Finance was

explaining that there are 2, 3 things which has come in the way. First is that we have closed down our base kitchens, 9 base kitchens, which we are running on departmental basis that was closed because of the new catering policy wherein now we have gone for licensing model. So there, immediately, it is seeing that there is a squeeze in the margin. But overall, if you see the number of trains which are coming, so the margin will certainly improve

. Then if you see this -

- if you see the absolute terms, it has improved.

The second thing is the new tendering process, which we have done through clustering mode, here we are not charging 15% on a billing. And our main focus is now on creating infrastructure, a network of base kitchens all across India so that -- which we are envisaging that a large number of catering business is going to come to IRCTC because of the introduction of many new trains in the coming quarters and the years. So, we are preparing ourselves by creating sufficient infrastructure so that we don't lose on that account. So, margin is going to improve.

Madhuchanda Dey: Yes. I have a last question, if I may. That is on the Rail Neer. Was there any capacity addition in this quarter -- fresh capacity came on board? And what kind of capacity addition are we going to see in the next few quarters?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So recently, we have added Vijayawada plant, which we inaugurated on 7th of October '24. And there are 3 plants which we are planning to bring in the coming financial year. So that will also add to our capacity by, say, around 1,50,000 bottles and more, I think it's 2 lakhs bottles.

Madhuchanda Dey: So, what's the current capacity if you could just mention that after this new plant?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Total capacity is 18.4 lakhs bottles per day.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. That is now. And is it going to go up to?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Add around 2 lakh bottles.

Madhuchanda Dey: By which quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: In the coming financial year.

Madhuchanda Dey: Okay. Roughly in the second half, right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That I can't commit now.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Balaji from IIFL.

Balaji: I just wanted to understand the benefit, if any, which you will see from the ongoing Kumbh Mela. So, will we see a sharp increase in ticketing volumes? And what should be the approximate quantification of that? And moreover, what can be the potential improvement in both Catering and Rail Neer revenue from the ongoing Kumbh Mela.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see it's one of its kind. Here, what specifically we have done that I can share with you. We have -- we are running 8 Bharat Gaurav tourist trains in this area, covering Prayagraj, Varanasi Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

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and Ayodhya. So there, we are bringing thousands of people there on our train. This will be where the ticket is ours, the whole tourist package is ours. Second, that we have created, set up 100 rooms, 100 tents, Mahakumbh Gram - Tent City of IRCTC, which is fully sold out. So, these are the direct things which we are doing. Besides that, you know that everybody is moving towards that. And railway has run so many special trains also. And so, we are getting benefit in all our like ticketing, Catering and Rail Neer, as you correctly pointed out. Thank you very much.

Balaji: This is helpful. So, any sense on the numbers, if you could provide based on how it has been for the past one month?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: If you want, I have to calculate, otherwise, because this will come in this quarter only, you can wait.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Mohit Jain from Tara Capital.

Mohit Jain: Sir, thanks for the presentation. Sir, on the Internet Ticketing, you said one of the reasons the margin has improved is because the non-fare revenue has increased significantly. But sir, on a Y-o-Y basis, it has increased only from INR96 crores to INR100 crores. So, then what actually explains this increase in the margin on ticketing -- Internet Ticketing from 83% to 84.7%. And is it sustainable as it was asked earlier also?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see our number of tickets, which we have booked since Q3 is daily average is 13.59 lakh tickets per day whereas it was 12.4 lakh tickets per day. So, this quarter, we have increase

d 1

lakh tickets per day on an average. And that much number. So that much fees also come in absolute terms. And besides that, from INR96 crores to we have brought to INR101 crores in non-convenience fee. So that's how it has improved.

Mohit Jain: No, sir. I appreciate such increase in the profit and the revenue. I mean I was looking for the margin percentage. It has gone significant -- it has increased significantly. So, I just wanted to understand that should we say that now this 84%, 85% is the new normal, and this is what we can expect going forward also?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Let us hope for the best.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Nikhil Verma from SUD Life.

Nikhil Verma : My question is, sir, in the terms of Catering revenue, what kind of volume growth you are saying? So, as you told that number of train additions will be there. So mostly it will be Vande Bharat -based trains or some other kind of volume growth you are seeing?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That decision is of the Ministry of Railways. But so far as we are hearing like all of us, that besides Vande Bharat, Vande Bharat sleeper trains are also going to come. So that will also give us volume.

Nikhil Verma: So, sir, any kind of guidance of how much it should increase by next quarter or year?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: That we can't predict, but there are so many rigs which are going to come of Amrit Bharat trains.

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Nikhil Verma: And my next question is while cancelling the clerkage that is charged, does that go to IRCTC or what is the thing around that -- because I wanted to understand if it is free relates to the convenience fee on Ayodhya.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Nikhil, I could not get you. You want to know that during cancellation of ticket, what clerk age charges the railway charge is going to us or to railway. Is this your question?

Nikhil Verma: Yes, sir, that is my question. Yes, that is.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, I already explained it to the previous speaker. That we only charge convenience fee and that too only at the time of booking. During cancellation, we charge nothing.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Mohit Motwani from Tara Capital.

Mohit Motwani: Sir, my question is on your opening remarks on the Internet ticketing segment, where you said that the growth could be limited -- incremental would be limited from this point onwards. So, I want to understand what are the streams of revenue are you looking at? Have you decided any streams or there is something going on along those lines? And this growth that we saw 5% has actually moderated from the last 2 quarters. So, what should we expect in terms of trajectory going forward? Not looking for any numbers, but if you can give us a sense of what can be the future trajectory for this?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: As I explained earlier also, we are already reaching to 87% -- we have touched 87%. So, the scope of the percentage improvement is -- we are not foreseeing much. But as the volume itself is growing very high because of the investment in coaches and in infrastructure of Indian Railways. So certainly -- and with the coming up of both the DFC lines, the line capacity is also released for running more and more passenger trains. So, in absolute term, we see a very handsome business out from here. So far as margin is concerned, it will remain -- as percentage wise, it should remain the same in the near future.

Mohit Motwani: Okay. And sir, on the -- can you say it again 87% -- just double clicking on this. And you say that 87% of the tickets are now already booked. So, would you say that the market has reached a saturation from a penetration point of view or there is scope for growth there because the other means of transport, if you see, right, today, airways has become more prominent? So, is that the case that the m

arket has reached a little bit of saturation? That's the reason you're also believing that the growth from a volume standpoint may be relatively limited.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, I got your point. I got your point. There is -- I'm not telling that market is saturated. Market is booming, but the percentage of share which we carries is almost 90%. So, you can understand and appreciate the situation that how -- what extra we can -- so we should maintain and slightly improve the margin when the volume increases. That is what we are planning.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rattan Joneja from Co Value Technologies Private Limited.

Rattan Joneja: So, I have one question. What is the status of payment aggregator license, which we were expecting from RBI? It's been quite some time.

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: Good evening, Rattan. We have already applied for the in-principal approval of RBI on 12th of December. And as you know that, RBI does a scrutiny of any application they receive in a very threadbare manner. So, we had engaged some consultant, and they have planned, and we have already submitted our application. So hopefully, we'll get the in-principal approval of RBI soon, and then we'll plan to get the license as such.

Rattan Joneja: And can I ask one more question, please?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Welcome.

Rattan Joneja: Okay. What is going to be the impact on IRCTC revenue and cost benefits from this license?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, I'm very happy to inform you that when we have not got the license, and still, we are doing payment gateway business for our internal clients, internal customers. And I'm happy to share with you that our share in gross transactions value is quite handsome, around 20%, 22%. And we are number 1 in transaction value on website booking, and we are number 2 in mobile application booking. And in both the website and mobile combined or individually, we are ahead of Paytm. So, what I understand that once we get the license and the opportunities in this business, what I see is huge. So that will decide once we get the license to our business. Potential is there. I can commit that much.

Rattan Joneja: Okay. Can you elaborate on the potential please, in terms of markets or...

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Exact numbers, I will not be able to give, but I can...

Rattan Joneja: I don't want the numbers.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, I can just tell you where we can have a moat. Like if you see the railway business as such, we are only doing a part of reserve ticketing. The freight business is there. Another your unreserved ticketing is there. Similarly, GeM is there, which is doing huge amount of business during the procurement. So, government business in itself. And there is no other company other than IRCTC in government parlance, which is doing this kind of business. So, what we are seeing is if we touch only government part, there is a huge, huge potential for -- on a transaction value level. Thank you very much.

Rattan Joneja: And one more thing. I have a strategic question. Our convenience fee has remained flat in terms of per PNR. Well as prices of tickets have been rising, particularly since Vande Bharat has come in. So, are we thinking anything in terms of moving the convenience fee as a percentage of tickets -- percentage of the ticket value since we can then ride the inflation?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Rattan, can I come?

Rattan Joneja: Yes.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You have given both the question and the answer too. Your question is how we can maximize our profit through this convenience fee by -- either by increasing the rate or increasing the volumes. And you see that you yourself told that because of coming of Vande Bharat train, you are seeing only part story of a fare enhancement of Vande Bharat, whereas we are seeing a Indian Rai

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volume enhancement. And since beginning, I'm repeating this, that we are trying to maximize our volumes. Okay. So, at present, we are not seeing any enhancement in the rate as such.

Rattan Joneja: No, not rate. I'm talking why don't we move into percentage so that we don't have to think about rates, because it's been 5 years, another 5 years will ago?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Leave some work up to the management. We will try to understand your things. But what I find, and our team find -- that you see, if you are doing business, you can do the -- how you should do. So here, it's a very price-sensitive segment. So, we are wanting to maximize our revenue and profit both by getting more and more business. You see already, we are making a margin of 84%, 85%. How much more margin you want to extract from a passenger can we share?

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rajesh Gajra, an Informist.

Rajesh Gajra: Sir, can you repeat. Earlier on in the opening remarks, you gave the EBITDA margin for -- individually for your Catering segment, for your Rail Neer and for your Web Ticketing segments. Please?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: EBITDA margin is 34.04% this quarter. And what else you want? I could not hear you.

Rajesh Gajra: For each of the segments and versus year ago margin?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: The Catering margin is percentage-wise 12.19%, Rail Neer 12.31%, IT 84.71% and Tourism 16.94%.

Rajesh Gajra: And the year ago margins?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Could not get you what you want.

Rajesh Gajra: For each of the segments, what was a year ago that is Q3 of FY '24, what were the margins, respective margins, for comparison purposes.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Comparison quarter-on-quarter?

Rajesh Gajra: Year-on-year.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Year-on-year, it was Catering 15.44%, Rail Neer negative 3.89%, IT 83.02% and Tourism 12.28%.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital.

Rahul Jain: Most of my questions have been answered. Just 1 or 2 bookkeeping questions, if it is handy. I think we spoke about the Golden Chariot being restarted. So, if we could understand what is the seasonality for this particular train? Is it heavy on the Q3, Q4 just like Maharaja Express? So that is point number one. And secondly, if you could share the contribution of luxury train revenue for the quarter?

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

Sanjay Kumar Jain: The Golden Chariot is also run during the winter season, wherein foreigners, they generally prefer to come to India. So, it will be quarter 3, quarter 4 like Maharaja Express. And so far as this segment revenue is concerned. Maharaja Express this quarter, we achieved INR38 crores revenue as against year -on-year, quarter 3 '24, INR27 crores. And yes, and Q -on-Q basis, Q2 INR2 crores.

Rahul Jain: And last question from my side. Regarding this State Teerth, in generally, if you could explain how the situation and demand is playing out here. There has been some moderation that we have observed. So how are our interaction with various state and tourism segment is working to drive this part of the revenue piece?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: What do you want to understand ? Our modus operandi , how we work or how we get the business?

Rahul Jain: So, my primary question is to understand, are we -- right now, are we getting a lot of interest from various state government on driving this segment? Or it is continued to be slightly weaker compared to the past trend?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see what speaks in number? Number is speaking that it is on the right path. And there is a lot many encouragement among the state government to come to us and ask for the State Teerth. Nowadays, we called it Bharat Gaurav Train. INR65 crores is Q3 revenue in Bharat Gaurav

Train. And in Q2, it was INR26 crores only. And last year, Q3, it was INR28 crores only.

Rahul Jain: Sir, how much you said for the current quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: INR65 crores .

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that brings us to the end of the question -and-answer session.

I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments.

Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar : Thank you all of you for a patient hearing and interaction with the management of IRCTC. All the best for all of us, including the stakeholders. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Dolat Capital Market Private Limited, that concludes this conference. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Jun 2025

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 June 04, 2025

BSE Limited
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
"Exchange Plaza", C -1, Block -G,
Bandra -Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of Earning Conference Call for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st March 2025 held on Thursday, May 29, 2025 .

Ref: Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated May 19, 2025, please find enclosed herewith the transcript of Earning Conference Call for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st March 2025 held on Thursday, May 29, 2025 .

In accordance with Regulation 46 (2) (oa) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations 2015, the transcript of the Earning Conference Call is also available on the website of the company i.e. [https://www.irctc.com/assets/images/IRCTC%20Transcript%20Q4FY25\(04.06.2025\).pdf](https://www.irctc.com/assets/images/IRCTC%20Transcript%20Q4FY25(04.06.2025).pdf)

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a
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"Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited
Q4 & FY25 Earnings Conference Call"
May 29, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR –
INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. RABINDRA NATH MISHRA – DIRECTOR FINANCE – INDIAN RAILWAY
CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
DR. LOKIAH RAVIKUMAR – DIRECTOR CATERING – INDIAN RAILWAY
CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN – DIRECTOR – TOURISM AND MARKETIN G –
INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED

MR. SUDHIR KUMAR – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER AND GROUP GENERAL
MANAGER FINANCE – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM
CORPORATION LIMITED

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited
May 29, 2025

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MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS PRIVATE LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the IRCTC Limited Q4 and FY '25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you, Muskan. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all for the Q4 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call for IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the company; Mr. Rabindra Nath Mishra, who is Director Finance. And also, we have today with us Dr. Lokiah Ravikumar, Director Catering; Shri. Rahul Himalian, Director, Tourism and Marketing and Mr. Sudhir Kumar, CFO and GGM Finance of the company.

And now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, please, Sanjay ji.

Sanjay Jain: Good afternoon, everyone and a warm welcome to you all to this con call of IRCTC Limited for the quarter and year ending 31st March, 2025. Yesterday, the company had announced the audited financial results for the Q4 '25 and the year ending March '25 and the same have been disclosed on both the stock exchanges. I shall first give a brief overview about the FY '25 and Q4 FY '25 results, post which our Director Finance will provide the details of the performance of our business segments.

Thereafter, we shall have the question -and-answer session. I am pleased to report that Q4 FY '25 has been again an exceptional quarter with our company achieving an all -time high operating revenue of INR1,269 crores. This marks an impressive year-on-year growth of 10%, driven primarily by strong performance in our Internet Ticketing, Rail Neer and Tourism segments. These results reaffirm the resilience and growing strength of our core business areas. Looking at the full year, FY '25 has been a landmark year with operating revenue reaching INR4,675 crores, representing a strong annual growth of 9.73%. Our absolute EBITDA stood at INR1,549 crores with -- up 5.71% annually, reflecting our sustained focus on operational efficiency and service delivery.

Most notably, our PAT rose to INR1,315 crores, up from INR1,111 crores in last financial year, a commendable increase of 18.30% annually. This growth underscores our commitment to delivering long -term value and highlight the company's solid financial foundation. Our overall yearly performance demonstrates robust fundamentals and a clear trajectory of long -term sustainable growth.

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The Board of Directors has recommended a final dividend of INR1 per share, subject to the shareholders' approval, taking the total dividend for financial year '24 -'25 to INR8 per share, the highest ever dividend amounting to INR640 crores, which is 400% of the share capital as compared to INR520 crores in financial year '23 -'24. This reflects our continued commitment to give a return to our shareholders.

I'd like to conclude my opening remarks and shall hand over the call to my colleague and our Director of Finance, Shri Rabindra Nath Mishra to brief you on the financial and segmental performance of the company.

Rabindra Nath Mishra: Thank you, sir. Good afternoon, everybody, and I hope you and your dear ones are in good health.

I shall first give a brief overview about the annual performance and then Q4 financial year '25 results, post which we shall have the question -and-answer session. Now coming to annual performance, financial year 2024 -25.

I am pleased to report that FY '25 has been a year of strong financial and operational growth, reflecting the resilience and dynamism of our diversified business model. Annual highlights in comparison to financial year '25 vis-a-vis financial year '24 is revenue from operations stood at INR4,675 crores in financial year '25, which is up by 9.73% year-on-year, led by sustained growth across key business segments.

Profit before tax reached INR1,757 crores, a solid increase of 17.42%, where while net profit that is PAT rose to INR1,315 crores, which is up by 18.30% year-on-year. Absolute EBITDA improved to INR1,549 crores, which is registering a 5.71% year-on-year growth, maintaining a high healthy margin of 33.15%. These results reflect the company's consistent focus on operational excellence, cost control and strategic expansion in high-growth area, particularly Internet ticketing and tourism.

Coming to the quarterly highlights that is Q4 financial year '25 versus Q4 financial year '24 and Q3 financial year '25. Despite a seasonal moderation in some segments, Q4 financial year '25 was marked by historic revenue milestone reaching INR1,269 crores, the highest ever for any quarter. Coming to the segment-wise revenue performance for Q4 financial year '25.

Internet ticketing revenue grew to INR372.5 crores, a strong 8.78% year-on-year growth and 5.30% quarter-on-quarter increase, reaffirming our leadership in this digital domain. Tourism revenue surged to INR274.4 crores, which is up by 38.17% year-on-year and 22.65% quarter-on-quarter, driven by strong demand and innovative travel offerings.

Rail Neer also performed steadily, posting INR92.2 crores in revenue, which is up by 15.49% year-on-year. While catering revenue moderated to INR529.4 crores, this was primarily due to seasonal variation, and we anticipate a strong recovery and growth in the upcoming quarters. Segment-wise EBITDA highlights for Q4 financial year '25 is Internet ticketing achieved an EBITDA of INR306.9 crores with a remarkable 82.4% margin, a testament to the segment's profitability and the scalability.

Tourism segment delivered INR49.6 crores in EBITDA, which is up by INR118.49% year-on-year with margin of 18.1%. Rail Neer maintained a consistent EBITDA of INR11.7 crores with Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

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a margin of 12.7%. Catering EBITDA rose to INR64.6 crores from INR42.7 crores year-on-year, reflecting 51.12% growth in absolute terms, even as margin adjusted to 12.2%.

The net worth of the company has increased to INR3,663 crores in financial year '24-'25, which is up from INR3,230 crores in financial year 2023-24, which is representing a net addition of 13.40% in shareholders' wealth. The quarterly and annual performance underscores IRCTC's strong fundamentals, robust execution capability and its agility in adapting across diverse verticals.

With a continued focus on innovation, service excellence and enhancing customer experience, we remain well positioned to seize future growth opportunities and drive sustainable long-term value creation for our esteemed stakeholders. That concludes my opening remarks. We can now move to the question-and-answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question is from the line of Navani Naredi from Naredi Investment. Please go ahead.

Navani Naredi: I've got two, three questions. So my first question is, what is the status of payment aggregator license applied to RBI? And second is there is a significant increase in bills receivables and current assets. So is it the payment p

ending from the state government involved in the tourism of senior citizens to religious spaces?

If yes, for how long they will be paying us back? And my third question is that there is a significant increase in the revenue from tourism vertical also. So what is the scope and opportunities coming ahead and growth ahead from this vertical? So these are my three questions?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. Good questions. As about the RBI license, we have submitted in principle approval with RBI in December '24. They have asked for certain clarification, which we have already replied and awaiting their response.

Navani Naredi: So when can we expect the response from the same?

Sanjay Jain: They take their own time, but we are chasing it. Secondly, your question about bills receivables, this is largely with Indian Railways. And you know this is our parent organization, and we have a huge business. Largely IRCTC is dependent on their business. So we are getting it clear from time to time.

And revenue tourism, as you correctly pointed out, that the revenue tourism in the last quarter has increased very high, and the momentum has already achieved. And we are likely to take tourism further for growth of our company. That's what we have committed in our earlier call of Q3 and before that. Thank you.

Navani Naredi: All right. But I have a follow-up questions on the same. So the thing which -- like as you mentioned that it is on account of the parent company. I agree to that. But my question is like from like for how long the bills receivables will get cleared? And are these going to clear in the next few quarters or will this amount stay the same?

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Sanjay Jain: You see, there is a process and now I'm happy to inform you that we have already introduced a system whereby we get certain percentage of our bills outstanding as an advance. The moment we book the tickets, we get the advance. So this process challenges we are working on to it, but there is no worry so far as bill clearance are concerned. Thank you.

Navani Naredi: All right. And also about the tourism vertical. So what -- are we planning new things ahead or we will be able to maintain the current revenue growth in the upcoming quarters also?

Sanjay Jain: You see revenue from tourism will grow and grow only. That much I can say.

Navani Naredi: Okay. All right. Thanks for the opportunity I will get back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, our catering revenue was flat in this quarter. I believe due to Mahakumbh, we should have got an additional boost because a lot many special trains were being run. And if I'm not mistaken, some additional Bharat Gaurav trains were also being run.

So in that context, why is the revenue flat? If you can just explain the reasons behind that?

Sanjay Jain: That's a good question, Joshi. You see, if you compare Q4 of this year with Q4 of last year, you will find one distinct difference that this year, Mahakumbh, when the trains were run, these were without catering facility because the main target of government was to take more and more passengers to the Mahakumbh and clear the rush from there.

So these TOD trains were largely without catering facility as a prepaid trains. But last quarter, in the quarter '24, we have a quite good chunk of Aastha Express we run for Ayodhya. And there, our catering facilities were there. So this is the main cause of Q4 getting flat, but there is nothing to worry about it, first thing. Second thing, this Bharat Gaurav train is not related to our catering business. It is related to tourism and which has grown around 12% this year.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. And sir, I mean, we recorded an exceptional gain of about INR45 crores in this quarter.

And I think some INR40 crores pertains to some one time reconciliation of the legacy business. I think that is what is stated in your footnote. So can you please explain what does this exactly pertain to?

Sanjay Jain: See, we have legacy items since many years. And this year, we could clear the legacy transactions. And one time you are right that we have gained a onetime revenue out of this. And this was essentially required to clean up our balance sheet. And management has taken -- BOD has taken an initiative that we should clean our balance sheet, and that's why it has happened. And there are two more factors to that.

One is some dues payable to KTDC, Karnataka Tourism Development Corporation. We have taken some negotiation. And due to that, we got back some money, which was due. Secondly, around excess provisioning of PRP of around INR5 crores were again got back. So that's the reason.

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Jinesh Joshi: Sorry, sir, I'm harping on this again, but the KTDC thing and the excess provisioning thing is a bit self-explanatory in nature. The second part, which has a chunky gain of about INR40 crores, just mentioned that a net impact of onetime reconciliation of legacy business. So I'm still not clear which segment does it pertain to? And what kind of legacy business are we talking about?

Sanjay Jain: This is related to different segments. If you want a breakup segment-wise, that also I can provide you. We'll send it to you. No problem.

Jinesh Joshi: One last question from my side. If you can just share the number of tickets booked and the convenience income for 4Q? And also, if you can share the AC and non-AC ticketing mix for this quarter?

Sanjay Jain: Daily average ticket booking this quarter is INR14.33 lakhs per day as against INR12.91 lakhs per day last -- around 11%. What's your next question, please?

Jinesh Joshi: Convenience fee income in 4Q?

Sanjay Jain: Convenience fee for Q4 was INR242 crores as against INR224 crores last year.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. And sir, the AC and non-AC mix and share of UPI, if you can give the quantum for the full year, that will be very helpful?

Sanjay Jain: The UPI is around 47.68 % in Q4. This UPI for the whole year is 46.27%.

Jinesh Joshi: And the AC quantum, AC ticketing quantum in percentage terms?

Sanjay Jain: AC in this quarter, you want the complete year or the...

Jinesh Joshi: Full year. No, sir, full year will be helpful?

Sanjay Jain: It is 2,525 lakhs AC and non -AC is 1,952.7 lakhs.

Jinesh Joshi: 1,952.7 lakhs?

Sanjay Jain: And 2S is 586.7 lakhs. So total ticket is 5,065 lakhs.

Jinesh Joshi: Okay, sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next participant is Hardik an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Hardik: So my first question was regarding the payment aggregator license, which you have already answered. My second question is regarding the Tejas trains. I remember the commentary from management when Tejas train was first launched, we were anticipating a breakeven in the first year, but surprisingly, we got the breakeven in the first quarter itself. So if you can give some numbers, how Tejas is performing? And if you can give some kind of bifurcation in the Internet ticketing business, that would be helpful?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. Tejas occupancy in this quarter, we are running two Tejas Express. And the average occupancy in this quarter is 93.2% as against last -- Q4 last year, 85%.

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Hardik: Okay. And sir, can you give some bifurcation of revenue or profits in the Internet ticketing segment of Tejas train? How is the percentage of the figures in the overall segment result or profit results?

Sanjay Jain: I can give you revenue -- both the Tejas 2 put together, we have around INR9 .1

8 crores of profit

on a revenue of INR177 crores.

Hardik: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Navani Naredi from Naredi Investments. Please go ahead.

Navani Naredi: So I just wanted to know like which are trains work in the tourism sector. And I didn't get like there is an increase in current assets. So what is the reason behind it?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. We are running Bharat Gaurav train. We are also running Maharajas' Express and Golden Chariot. And current assets has increased because of increase in debtors.

Navani Naredi: All right. Okay. That's all from my end. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Hitesh an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Hitesh: First of all, congratulations on a good set of numbers. I have a couple of questions . My first one has two parts to it. There was a news sometime back that like earlier, IRCTC was taking reservations on a 6 -month basis, advanced ticketing reservations, which was changed to 2 months reservation instead of 6 months. So I would like to know the reason behind that. And any near -term or short -term challenges that you might see related to the change in government policies or something that might affect your business?

Sanjay Jain: Thank you, Hitesh. First of all, let me clear you that changing the number of days will not make any difference on our business. And that we cleared through stock exchange also, and we have submitted an information to that. And how many days prior ARN should be made for booking a reserve ticket is a purely decision of Government of India, Ministry of Railways. IRCTC has no role into this. But I can assure you that this will not be any like concern for us. Thank you.

Hitesh: And any near -term challenges or roadblocks that you see related to the government policies for like its impact or something on our business?

Sanjay Jain: Related to what?

Hitesh: One more news articles was there is like sometime back?

Sanjay Jain: Just a moment, relating to what?

Hitesh: [inaudible 27:24] I think it is related to financial year '21 in which just when the government convenience -seeking share demand from the IRCTC, which was opposed by the shareholders. So, the government rolled back?

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Sanjay Jain: That matter was already resolved and we are getting a stronger and better business, that much I can say. Thank you.

Hitesh: Okay. I will come back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shrinarayan Mishra from Baroda BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Sir, can you highlight if there will be additional monetization features with the launch of news

app which is SwaRail? Hello. Am I audible?

Moderator: Yes, sir. You are audible.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Should I repeat?

Sanjay Jain: You want to know the SwaRail feature?

Shrinarayan Mishra: Yes, sir. SwaRail, will there be any additional monetization for us for any new feature, which will be coming in, additional source of revenue?

Sanjay Jain: SwaRail provides reservation -- tickets for reservation, UTS, parcel, goods and any business related to railway. We are dealing only with one part of it, that is reservation, so reserve ticketing.

So far, ticketing is concerned, it will continue like that. And we are not entering into other ventures. Thank you.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. And sir, any update on the RBI payment aggregator license? Is there any time line to it or no update?

Sanjay Jain: We are likely to get this in principle approval in this quarter, I believe, or next 2 months, 3 months.

Shrinarayan Mishra: So this will help us to improve margins, right?

Sanjay Jain: No, then we'll have to go for final approval. That will take around a year.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. So after a year, the effect will

be visible?

Sanjay Jain: Yes.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. Got it. Thank you. I will get back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Hardik an Individual Investor. Please go ahead.

Hardik: Sir, can you give us some numbers be it Zomato, Swiggy, how are they performing?

Moderator: Your voice is not audible properly. Can you speak a little louder, please?

Hardik: Am I audible now?

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Moderator: Yes, now it's better.

Hardik: Yes. So can you give [inaudible 30:53] on the Zomato and Swiggy, how are they performing?

And how many [inaudible 30:59] with Zomato and Swiggy in IRCTC?

Sanjay Jain: Yes, I will not be able to provide you specific to Zomato or Swiggy, but I can give you a picture of our e-catering business, which will clearly indicate you how they are performing. Like annually, we grew from INR33 crores last year to INR54 crores this year. That is a growth of 63%. And in Q4 itself, we have grown from INR9 crores to INR15 crores. That is a 53% increase. Thank you very much, in the revenue.

Hardik: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Rahul Jain: My first question pertains to the business of catering. We had in past some of the repricing opportunity available to us because there was some litigation pending in some of the vendors who did not come back to the pricing, which was suggested after the COVID situation. So any clarity on what is the status for that vendor? And what more -- what is the percentage of total vendors which are still not on the revised pricing, if you could share that?

Sanjay Jain: The matter of self-assessment is under dispute and under litigation.

Rahul Jain: Okay. Is there any time lines that one could possibly consider? I understand matter sub-judice, so difficult to quantify. But anything that this is the situation of the current proceeding that one should -- one should expect this to happen?

Sanjay Jain: It depends on the wisdom of honorable court, which we cannot challenge, but it's an ongoing process. Thank You.

Rahul Jain: Right. And on the tourism side, like we got a good fillip from one mega festival in the previous quarter. So similarly, are there any bigger events lined up for this year, which are typically the driver for us in this business, be it in terms of any election related or any other?

Sanjay Jain: There is a noise from behind, and I'm not able to listen what you want to say. Please ask others to keep silent and then you can narrate.

Rahul Jain: Yes. Is this any better, sir?

Sanjay Jain: Yes.

Rahul Jain: Sorry for that. So I was saying that in the tourism businesses, are we seeing any upcoming trigger, which could possibly drive the growth like what we saw with Mahakumbh in the previous quarter? Is there any major upcoming event that should be a driver for growth for us in the tourism segment?

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Sanjay Jain: You see, you must be listening government policy nowadays that government is all up increasing the employment and because of tourism. So it is in the -- as it is in the radar of government, we are the arm to execute that. So we can see it hopefully in the best possible. Thank You.

Rahul Jain: Right. And just from the newer initiative, a couple of years back, we have -- in one of our annual report, we have articulated the strategy around growing the non-railway part of the revenue for the business. Are there any new initiative that we are contemplating, which is beyond the railway ecosystem or any new revenue stream within railway ecosystem that we could be chasing other than the current line of businesses?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. So basically, you have two questions. One is what is

the non-railway revenue. So we have

around 30% we are going in the non-railway revenue also. And we are planning to merge our - all the OTA platforms for improving our hotel bookings and MICE activities and air bookings, we are planning to have a unified portal and which will be a good trigger to give a good business going forward, non-railway.

Rahul Jain: Right. So on the 30% part, which you just said, you are saying the eventual goal is to make it 30% outside railway or you're saying the current revenue stream also includes a lot of non-railway revenue?

Sanjay Jain: No, no. This is what at present scenario. This 28% is the air packages we are booking.

Rahul Jain: You mean to say within the tourism revenue, 28% is coming from air packages?

Sanjay Jain: No, 28% is the growth in our non-railway tourism, particularly air packages. Like our air packages last financial year was INR68 crores. This year, it is INR87 crores. So we have revenue growth of 28% over to last year. So this segment is also growing. That's what I wanted to say.

Rahul Jain: Understood. That's very helpful. Thank you and I will join back the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shrinarayan Mishra from Baroda BNP. Please go ahead.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Thanks again for the follow up. Sir, you just highlighted that we have three trains for tourism. Can you give out the revenue and profit contribution from them?

Sanjay Jain: Bharat Gaurav train, this financial year, we have achieved INR277 crores as revenue. Maharajas' Express, it is INR92 crores. And Golden Chariot, it is INR2.83 crores.

Shrinarayan Mishra: And profit sir?

Sanjay Jain: Nearly 8% in the Bharat Gaurav and Maharajas' Express 18% to 20% and Golden Chariot just we started.

Shrinarayan Mishra: So we would be near to breakeven in the Golden Chariot right?

Sanjay Jain: No, it is just starting last year -- before last year, there was no train run, Golden Chariot could run. Last year, we could operate three Golden Chariot. This year, we have a good booking.

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Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. So sir, on similar lines, are we trying to add a few more trains in this segment for growth or this is how -- I mean, it will look like for FY '26 as well?

Sanjay Jain: Actually, Bharat Gaurav is not 1 train. We are running 10 rakes of Bharat Gaurav. We are adding one more rake to this Bharat Gaurav. And this Bharat Gaurav as a brand, it runs and it runs on a different itinerary. We have 16-17 itineraries on which it runs. It is very popular itineraries, which we run.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. So additional rakes across twin trains, if you can give how many additional trains will be run this year?

Sanjay Jain: One rake we are planning under discussion.

Shrinarayan Mishra: And second question was on Amrit Bharat and Vande Bharat sleeper train. So as more and more of these trains operational, what kind of revenue growth or growth outlook for catering business we should expect?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. All the Vande Bharat trains are prepaid trains. And similarly, Amrit Bharat trains are having pantry cars. So both the things will lead to enhancement in our catering business and, of course, IT business.

Shrinarayan Mishra: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Sanjay Jain: Good evening to all of you. Thank you for joining us in this con call. This motivates us to perform better and we will continue to deliver and ensure our -- all the stakeholders and shareholders are happy. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited, that concludes this conference.

Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Call: Aug 2025

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 August 19, 2025

BSE Limited

1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001

Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited

“Exchange Plaza”, C -1, Block -G,
Bandra- Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “ Q1FY26 Earning
Conference Call ” held on August 14, 2025.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations
and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated August 08, 2025, please find enclosed herewith the
transcript of “Q1FY26 Earning Conference Call ” held on Thursday, August 14, 2025.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)

Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Membership No: F9199

Encl: a/a

Page 1 of 8

“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited

Q1 FY26 Earnings Conference Call ”

August 14, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED .

MR. SUDHIR KUMAR – DIRECTOR FINANCE AND CFO
– INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM
CORPORATION LIMITED .

MR. RAHUL HIMAL IAN – DIRECTOR TOURISM AND
MARKETING – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED

MR. MANOJ SHARMA – DIRECTOR CATERING
SERVICES – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED .

MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS
PRIVATE LIMITED

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to IRCTC Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you, Nidhi. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the company; Mr. Sudhir Kumar, who is Director, Finance and CFO and also, we have today with us Shri Rahul Himalian ji, who is Director, Tourism and Marketing services and Mr. Manoj Sharma, who is Director, Catering Services of the company.

And now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceedings forward. Over to you, sir.

Sanjay Jain: Thank you, Rahul. Am I audible?

Rahul Jain: Yes, sir.

Sanjay Jain: Good evening, everyone. And a warm welcome to the IRCTC Limited earnings call for the quarter ended June 30, 2025. Yesterday, our company has announced its financial results for the first quarter of financial year 2026, and these results have been disclosed on both stock exchanges. I will begin with a brief overview of Q1 FY '26 performance, following which our Director, Finance and CFO, Mr. Sudhir Kumar, will provide a detailed analysis of our business segment performance. Afterwards, we will open the floor for the question-and-answer session.

I am pleased to report that Q1 FY '26 has been a stable and profitable quarter for the company with a PAT of INR 330 crores, reflecting a year-on-year growth of 7.14%. This performance is primarily driven by strong contributions from the Internet Ticketing, Rail Neer and Tourism segment. Our EBITDA for this quarter stood at INR 397 crores, up 5.86% year-on-year. It is driven by improved operational efficiency.

Further, our EBITDA margin also expanded to 34.27% compared to 33.55% in Q1 FY '25, reflecting continued emphasis on cost optimization and better revenue mix management.

Revenue from operations grew by around 4% year-on-year, reaching INR 1,160 crores. That is driven by continued growth in Tourism and Internet Ticketing segment.

Overall, these results reflect our company's strong fundamentals, strategic focus and continued adaptability in a dynamic market environment. We are confident in sustaining this positive trajectory in the coming quarters, backed by operational excellence and a strong digital backbone. Thank you very much. Now over to my Director Finance, Mr. Sudhir Kumar.

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

August 14, 2025

Sudhir Kumar: Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. I wish good health and happiness to you and your family.

I'm eager to share with you a brief overview of our quarterly performance. I will also compare it with quarterly performance on year-on-year basis. It will be followed by question-and-answer session. This year, we have recorded profit after tax of INR 330.45 crores in quarter 1. It is 7.14% higher on a year-on-year basis.

Our total revenue in first quarter has stood at INR 1,220 crores. It is 4.36% higher on year-on-year basis. Our EBITDA rose to INR 397 crores, which is 5.86% up on year-on-year basis. EBITDA margin is at 34.27% in first quarter of this year, underscoring our operating efficiency and prudent cost

control measures.

Now I come to segment-wise highlights. The first segment is Internet Ticketing. This segment continued to be solid revenue driver for the company. Revenue from this segment has stood at INR 360 crores, marking a 9.12% growth on year-on-year basis. 87.78% of total reserved tickets on Indian Railways are now booked through our portal.

This segment is the most profitable. EBITDA of this segment in this quarter is 84%, which is better than that reported last year in the same quarter. Last year, it was 83%. Now I come to my next segment, that is Catering. Revenue from this segment has stood at INR 547 crores, which is slightly lower by 2.15% in comparison to last year in the same quarter.

The EBITDA margin of this segment has also moderated to 13.1% in comparison to 13.9% last year on a year-on-year basis. Even though margins are relatively moderate compared to other segments, this segment is a reliable revenue stream with constant growth potential. Now I come to next segment, that is Rail Neer. Rail Neer segment has reported steady revenue growth of INR 106 crores.

It is INR 1 crore s less in comparison to same quarter previous year. EBITDA from this segment is also almost same, to be precise, INR 1 crore s more than last year. Now I come to the last segment, that is Tourism. This segment has posted impressive revenue of INR 148 crores. It is 21.3% up on year -on-year basis. This growth is commendable, considering the fact that our business suffered setback due to geopolitical events.

EBITDA margin of this segment has also improved in comparison to previous year. EBITDA margin of this segment was 7.6% last year in first quarter. It is 8.7% this year in the same period. Our performance of this quarter and growth initiatives undertaken by IRCTC reflect resilience, strategic discipline and operational efficiency, setting a strong foundation for remaining period of this financial year. This concludes my remarks. Now floor is open for question-and -answer session. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question and answer session. T he first question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, my first question is on the decline in revenue in the Catering business. I believe we had multiple levers at play here like say, for instance, the rising count of Vande Bharat trains, tie-up with Swiggy and Zomato, expansion of business outside of rai lways and I guess the price hike was also helping us.

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But I think even in this quarter, like last quarter, the growth is a bit subdued. So can you just call out what is the problem area over here? Because in an ideal scenario, growth in Catering should mimic the passenger traffic growth. And if I look at your Internet Ticketing revenue, that is up by about 8%, 9%. But somehow that growth in Catering seems to be missing since the last two quarters. So your thoughts on that?

Sanjay Jain: Yes. Thank you, Jinesh Joshi. I have to tell you that , our overall revenue increased by around 4% and our Tourism grew by 21% and IT business also grew by 9%. Our growth in Rail Neer remained flat and a slight dip in Catering, the reason being there was a temporary phenomena like we -- last year, same quarter, we ran election special and a sizable amount, around INR 32 crores worth of revenue generated from that business, whereas this year, it was only INR 4 crores to INR5 crores. So that was th e main reason we find about Catering.

Otherwise, you see the e-c atering part, e-c atering, we grew by more than 30%. And in addition, we are in a transition phase whereby an opportunity through ABSS station, Amrit Bharat Station, where upgradation of stations are taking place. So the static unit on those stations could not generate license fee for this quarter. You can understand a little pain for a

final relief. So

ultimately, this ABSS station, once it is put in place, it is opening a very big door for IRCTC, Catering business.

Jinesh Joshi: Understood. A follow -up on this part is that how many stations or rather static units were impacted because of this transition that you spoke of? And what was the lost revenue because of that, if you can specifically call out?

Sanjay Jain: That figure we'll give you later. We'll send you across.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. And sir, secondly, even on Rail Neer side, I believe all our 20 plants are operational. And ideally, we should have basically seen the benefit of improving utilization come through on that side. But even if I look at Rail Neer, the top line was more or less flat in this quarter as well, wherein in the earlier quarters, we have registered a good growth. So any specific reason that you may want to call out for this segment as well?

Sanjay Jain: As you correctly pointed out, our utilization, in fact, has improved. Earlier last year, June 2024, our capacity utilization was 86.8%, whereas this quarter, it is 87.04%. But there were two issues. One is our Bilaspur plant. It is not working at the moment because of some issue with the state government regarding the extraction of water. So that -- in this quarter, we are hopeful to start it again. So first thing is that.

Secondly, the election special, which we ran last year has a component of Rail Neer also. That is not there this time. And thirdly, we have introduced a new 500 m l bottle for Vande Bharat train. So you see that compared to the last quarter -- the last year quarter, June 2024, there were -- a number of Vande Bharat trains have been introduced in which we are giving only 500 mL bottles. So despite our utilization has improved, but effectively, because of 500 mL bottles, the revenue capturing is less.

Jinesh Joshi: Understood. Understood, sir. Just one last question from my side. If I look at our depreciation expense, it is relatively flat on a Q -o-Q basis. But if I remember right, I think in the last quarter,

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we capitalized our new office building worth INR400 crores. So sequentially, the expense should have increased, but it continues to remain flat. So if you can just explain the reason behind it?

Sanjay Jain: Actually, if you see the things, we -- our building has two parts. One part is land, as per the accounting standard, that land value has to be taken separately from the building part, from the construction part. And out of INR400 crores, the major chunk of our amount of investment in this building is of land, which appreciates generally, doesn't depreciate. So we have capitalized only INR40 crores (approx.) of total investment and depreciation is counted on to that.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kartik Gada from Multipl Wealth.

Kartik Gada: Yes. So a couple of bookkeeping questions first. Can you provide the breakup of Internet Ticketing revenue into convenience fee and the other component, non-convenience?

Sanjay Jain: Yes, sure. We -- actually, it is two-third of total IT revenue is convenience fee and 1/3 is non - convenience fee. You want a figure?

Kartik Gada: No, that's fine. I will -- that should be useful. That can be calculated. And similarly, can you provide a breakup of the -- like one is total tickets and the breakup of tickets booked, AC, non-AC sitting?

Sanjay Jain: You see this quarter, we have booked 12.63 crores of ticket. And I think it is -- AC ticket of INR6.4 crores, non-AC ticket is INR 4.74 crores.

Kartik Gada: Okay. The next question is, so there was a news recently about a rebate of 20% on holiday packages during the festive season. So just wanted to understand two parts here. One is about this rebate of 20%, who will be bearing that? Would it be railways, which is my guess? And second, here, would

this be counted as one transaction only, both the onw ard journey and return journey or there would be two transactions which would be like neutral for the convenience fee component for us?

Sanjay Jain: First of all, I must compliment Ministry of Railways for bringing this 20% discount in this festive season of Diwali and Chhath. And simultaneously, I must tell you, that we have no impact on our convenience fee because both -- we will be having 2 PNRs, one for onward journey, another is for return journey. And convenience fee, we'll be charging the same rate. So this will certainly add to our business because of running of many trains, but no impact on our revenue.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Harsh Yadav from Dolat Capital.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. My question is regarding the Catering business. I wanted to get an update on the total number of trains that are equipped with onboarded catering services and also how many of them are managed via the tendering process?

Sanjay Jain: All the units which we are working is through tendering process only, and this is around 1,300 trains, 1,295 is the number. And it changes every time a new train is introduced or new service is added to that.

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August 14, 2025

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Harsh Yadav: All right. I had one more question regarding the Rail Neer business. So you had guided for adding three new bottling plants in FY '26 and increasing capacity to around 2 million bottles per day. I just wanted an update on this expansion time line. And also wanted to know if you have the number for the average volume of bottles sold per day in Q1?

Sanjay Jain: Actually, we are only -- our Board of Directors already approved the expansion of our 2 major plants, one at Danapur and another at Ambernath. And there are a few plants in the pipeline at Prayagraj, at Ranchi, Bhagalpur, Mysuru. So we -- tendering process, we are already on to finalize the tender -- start the tendering process. And then it takes around a year and plus.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. And also, do you have a number for the average volume of bottles sold per day in Q1?

Sanjay Jain: Average number of bottles we sold per day is 14.12 lakh bottle per day.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. I just had one final question regarding the Tourism business, which is a more like general question. I just wanted to -- wanted you to give some light on the forward booking trends for Q2 and H1. Specifically, if you could talk about the niche services like Bharat Gaurav, Maharajas' Express and the general services also?

Sanjay Jain: Exact figure, I will not be sharing, but I can just give you a glance that we are adding one more rake of Bharat Gaurav train this financial year. And we have already crossed a good figure mark in Maharajas' Express booking and which is much higher than the last year figure. And we are very hopeful to get a very good business in Tourism. Already, we have -- like in the first quarter itself, we have taken -- shown a growth of more than 20%.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rahul Prakash, an Individual Investor.

Rahul Prakash: First of all, thanks for the great set of numbers. I just had one question regarding the train tickets for Q1 2026 -- for this year Q1. May I know what is the total count of tickets for this Q1?

Sanjay Jain: Yes, please. We have booked 13.88 lakh tickets, this daily average. No, you want total number of tickets? Yes, it is INR 12.63 crores.

Rahul Prakash: INR12.63 crores is the total number of tickets for Q1. Got it. Any guidance for Q2 market growth

in terms of ticket?

Sanjay Jain: You see, this -- all our IT business -- all the business which we do is a seasonal business. So it will be comparable to Q2 last year.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited.

Rahul Jain: Firstly, if

you could share about the new initiatives that we have taken in the Tourism segment. Of course, you mentioned about the one rake that you have added in the Bharat Gaurav train.

But any other newer initiative around any newer plans highlighted in your zone or categories that you want to operate in the Tourism space?

Sanjay Jain: So you want to know about our initiative in Tourism only or overall?

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

August 14, 2025

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Rahul Jain : Yes. First on the Tourism, but it would be great if you could express another element as well ?

Sanjay Jain: So in Tourism, we are already -- as I told that we have already started a process of adding one more Bharat Gaurav rake. In addition, the Golden Chariot of Karnataka government, which we are running on an MOU, that is also getting booked this season. And we are expected to run 3 to 5 departures this financial year. And as I explained that Maharajas' Express has already seen a 20% growth.

And in addition, this -- during this financial year, we are likely including many new circuits like Shivaji -- Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Circuit", we have already run one and in the -- another in the offering. We are running Dev Bhoomi Kedarnath Kartik Swami tour. This is in the month of June and Ganga Ramayana Yatra from Secunderabad in the month of June and Bharat -Bhutan Mystic Mountain Yatra in the month of June. So many such new initiatives are already in the pipeline. Rahul, am I audible?

Rahul Jain : Yes, that's very helpful. And we recently also saw the press release from IRCTC about the payment aggregation approval. If you could help us in understanding the time line by when we could go live and start seeing monetization of this business?

Sanjay Jain: See, we are already into this business. And with the license which we are trying to get from RBI, in-principle approval we have already got and 6 months' time have been given by them to submit our paper. And then it will take around 6 to 8 months in getting a license. So total from now, if we say, it may be around 12 to 18 months. We'll be able to get this license. And that will help us in capturing business of -- other than our ticketing also.

Rahul Jain : Okay. So basically, what you're saying is that it may take another 12 to 18 months before we could get to the external customer base. Of course, we are working on our own portal at this point ?

Sanjay Jain: Exactly.

Rahul Jain : Right. And in the ticketing segment, if I look at the non-convenience part of the business, what we have seen is that it has not seen a very meaningful jump. We used to be pretty optimistic about the space, especially around monetization on the advertisement in some other segments. Is there any key aspect of the business which you think can drive growth ahead of the convenience fee growth or do you think it was moreover more in line with the convenience fee or ticket booked growth itself?

Sanjay Jain: See, I think, Rahul, you should check your figure again. Because in non-convenience fee, we -- on a year-on-year basis, this quarter, we have grew by 17%. And any double-digit figure in this, to my knowledge, is a good one, but we are not satisfied. We are planning to do many things into this.

We -- first of all, you talked about ads. So we are already planning to float a tender for -- like a sole tendering rights for advertisement, wherein we'll be using artificial intelligence to get the ad and to get the cross-selling also. So first thing is this. Secondly, in the non-convenience fee type, we are planning to have our OTA platform ready, which is unified portal.

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

August 14, 2025

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This is also in the tendering process. That will give us a very good conversion of our like business by cross-selling. So these are a few things which will give us. Then if you see t

he UPI CC, which

has a share of 12% and is growing with 18%, that will also help us in getting a good business out of it. That also we are planning to implement.

Rahul Jain : So just one clarification. So what you're essentially saying that double-digit growth on a full

year is a possibility in the non-ticketing -- non-convenience fee part of the Ticketing business?

Sanjay Jain: No, no, I'm simply saying that we grew by double digit this quarter, and the momentum is already there, and our plan is also there to grow exponentially in this field.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Gurpreet Singh, an Individual Investor.

Gurpreet Singh: My question has been answered.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Rattan Joneja from CoValue.

Rattan Joneja: I want to know what is the trend of AC bookings over the past few quarters?

Sanjay Jain: We'll send you across. Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Mohit Motwani from Tara Capital.

Mohit Motwani: My question was on the margins that you did quite better versus last year in the Internet Ticketing segment. Can you just walk us through what were some of the initiatives? Was it -- you already,

I think, spoke about operational efficiencies, but was it also so that the share of UPI was higher or

it was better cost controls? If you can give some sense on the segment margin, better margins?

Sanjay Jain: Would you like to know about the margin in Internet Ticketing, why it has increased?

Mohit Motwani: Yes. Any particular factors that you want to attribute it to? And also the share of UPI, which was there for the Internet Ticketing segment in this quarter versus the previous quarter?

Sanjay Jain: UPI share is 48.72% this quarter. And the margin increased because of non-convenience.

Mohit Motwani: Okay, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Rahul Himalian: Thank you very much, everyone. I'm Rahul Himalian, Director of Tourism and Marketing. There was robust growth in Internet Ticketing and Tourism sector and almost flat because of some

obvious reasons in Catering and this thing, but with your confidence -- continuous confidence

in IRCTC, we as a team will grow. Wishing you a very happy Independence Day and a festival weekend. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you very much. On behalf of Dolat Capital Markets Private Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Nov 2025

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 November 18, 2025

BSE Limited
(Through BSE Listing Centre)
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers, Dalal
Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001
Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
(Through NEAPS)
"Exchange Plaza", C -1, Block -G, Bandra -
Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai –
400 051
Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of "Q 2FY26 Earning Conference Call " held on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Madam,

In reference to our communication dated 07th November , 2025, please find enclosed herewith the transcript of "Q2FY26 Earning Conference Call" held on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
For Indian Railway Catering and
Tourism Corporation Limited
(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199
Encl: As above .

Page 1 of 11

"IRCTC Limited Q2 FY'26 earnings call Hosted By
Dolat Capital "

November 13, 2025

M
ANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN - CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR , IRCTC LIMITED
MR. SUDHIR KUMAR - DIRECTOR (FINANCE) AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER , IRCTC LIMITED
MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN - DIRECTOR (TOURISM AND
MARKETING), IRCTC LIMITED
MR. MANOJ SHARMA - DIRECTOR (CATERING
SERVICES), IRCTC LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN - DOLAT CAPITAL

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the IRCTC Q2 FY'26 Earnings Call hosted by Dolat Capital.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' then '0' on your touchtone phone.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q2 FY'26 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited.

I take this opportunity to welcome the Management of IRCTC, which is represented by Mr.

Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the Company ; Mr. Sudhir Kumar, who is Director of Finance and CFO. And also, we have today with us Mr. Rahul Himalian Ji , who is Director for Tourism and Marketing and Mr. Manoj Sharma – Director for Catering Services of the Company.

And now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, please, Sanjay Ji.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Rahul Ji. Good afternoon, everyone. And a warm welcome to the IRCTC Limited earnings call for the quarter ended September 30th, 2025. The Company announced its financial results for the 2nd Quarter of Financial Year 2025-26 yesterday and the same have been filed with both Stock Exchanges .

I will begin with a brief Overview of our Quarterly Performance, after which our Director Finance and CFO – Mr. Sudhir Kumar, will take you through the detailed financial and segment wise analysis. We will then open the floor for questions.

We are pleased to share that Q2 FY '26 has been a stable and profitable quarter for IRCTC, underscoring our strong operational fundamentals and sustained business momentum. The Company reported a profit after tax of Rs. 342 crores, reflecting a year -on-year growth of 11.%.

This growth was primarily driven by robust performance in our internet ticketing, catering and tourism segment, supported by operational efficiency and disciplined cost management.

EBITDA for the quarter stood at Rs. 404 crores, an increase of 8.31% year -on-year, with an EBITDA margin of 35.25% compared to 35.05% in Q2 FY '25. The improvement in margins demonstrates our continued focus on cost optimization, operational excellence and revenue diversification. Revenue from operations for Q2 FY '26 stood at Rs. 1, 146 crores, up by 7.71% from Rs. 1,064 crores in the corresponding quarter of the previous year. This growth was broad-based across all business segments, reflecting steady demand recovery and our ongoing efforts

IRCTC Limited

November 13, 2025

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to enhance service delivery and digital capabilities. We believe that IRCTC's consistent performance reflects its resilient business model, strong brand equity and customer -centric approach. Our strategy remains focused on strengthening our digital ecosystem and expanding new-age offerings, enhancing operational efficiency across business verticals, leveraging technology for better customer experience and scalability, and exploring emerging opportunities in tourism, hospitality and value -added services.

Looking ahead, we remain confident of sustaining our business growth trajectory in the coming quarters, supported by our strong financial strength, efficient operations and commitment to delivering long-term value for all stakeholders.

Thank you very much. I will now hand over the call to Mr. Sudhir Kumar – Director Finance and CFO, for a detailed discussion on our financial and segmental performance. Thank you.

Sudhir Kumar: Good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. I hope you and your families are in good health and high spirits. I am pleased to share with you a brief overview of

IRCTC's " Financial and Operational "

performance for the 2nd Quarter of FY 2025- 26, along with a comparison on a year -on-year basis. This will be followed by question-and -answer sessions.

During the quarter, profit after tax stood at Rs. 342 crores, reflecting a year -on-year growth of 11%. Our total revenue for the quarter stood at Rs. 1, 209 crores which is 7.5% more than the corresponding period of the previous year. EBITDA for the quarter rose to Rs. 404 crores, a 8.31% year -on-year increase. EBITDA margin also improved to 35.25% in comparison to 35.05% previous year. Improvement of EBITDA demonstrates IRCTC's successful cost management and operation efficiency.

Now, I come to segment -wide highlights.

Internet ticketing :

Internal ticketing segment continues to be a strong revenue and profit driver for the company.

Revenue from this segment stood at Rs. 386 crores, marking a 4% growth on a year -on-year basis. This growth clearly proves IRCTC's leadership in digital marketing. Currently 89.24% of total reserved tickets of Indian railways are booked through our online platform. This segment is the most profitable with EBITDA margin of 85%. And it compared to last year it was 81% and it clearly reflects our improvement in efficiency.

Catering:

Revenue from catering segment stood at Rs. 520 crores, showing an 8% increase on a year -on-year basis. EBITDA margin for this segment remained broadly stable at 13% compared to the same previous year. Catering continues to be a steady and dependable revenue stream with IRCTC Limited

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consistent growth potential. It is further supported by growing passenger volume and customer-centric service initiatives.

Rail Neer:

Rail needs segment reported revenue of Rs. 91 crores, representing a 4.6% growth on a year -on-year basis. EBITDA margin of this segment remained stable at around 10%, similar to last year's same quarter, reflecting sustained operational efficiency and strong brand acceptance.

Tourism:

The touring segment has delivered a very robust performance with a revenue of Rs. 150 crores. It is 20.97% up year -on-year basis. This growth is particularly noteworthy given the temporary disruptions caused by geopolitical factors during this period. EBITDA margin of this segment further improved to around 7%, as against a negative margin in the same quarter in previous year, reflecting successful cost-rationalization efforts and better business mix.

Overall, the 2nd Quarter performance reflects IRCTC resilience, strategic focus and operational excellence, the Company's diversified business model, strong digital backbone and disciplined execution continue to position it well for sustained growth in coming quarters.

Now, I conclude my remarks. We will now open the floor for question-and -answer session please.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin with the question-and -answer session. The first question is on the line of Sucrit Patil from iSight. Please go ahead.

Sucrit Patil: Good afternoon, team. I have two forward-looking questions. My first question is, looking beyond the quarter numbers, what is the bigger plan for IRCTC as digital platforms, tourism and catering evolve? How are you planning to build a lasting edge? Beyond just ticketing growth or catering contracts, is there something deeper that the company is planning that will make your competitors hard to copy your model? Thank you. That's my first question. I will ask my second question later on.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Mr. Patil. I am happy to tell you about our bigger picture. We are already making our road for two major activities. One is our payment aggregator business. We have already got in-principle approval from RBI on 4

th of August and we have been given six months' time to submit our proposal application for acquiring license finally. So, that we will be able to su

bmit

by the end of January. And this business appears to me as one of the future leading business for IRCTC. The other big plan for IRCTC is, besides its normal business, is unified travel portal.

Here we are aspiring to give a travel solution through a unified portal and by making this portal, we aspire to cross-sell the product to our existing customers and to the additional customers. So, IRCTC Limited

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here we will improve our UI /UX, will use AI /ML and Agentic AI and we will facilitate the passengers. We will make their experience very nice and that's our plan.

Sucrit Patil: Thank you. My second question is in regards to margin and cost planning. When cost rises, whether it is catering imports or IT investments or any compliance issues, how do you make sure the margins stay ahead without slowing down growth? Is there any system that you have built or you will be building which will help you keep the profits in line even when things are getting a bit, you cannot foresee certain things coming in the future? I want to hear your view on this. Thank you.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, in that scenario, you have only two ways to do these things. Firstly, you increase your price or you increase your volume. So, we believe in increasing our volume because in most of the sectors we are known for our delivery at affordable prices. Be it our tourism product, be it our catering products, all our products are designed to gain from the volume and not from the hiking the price. Like we are selling at Rs. 14 Rail Neer. We are selling like catering meals, full meals at Rs. 80. So, all these things are affordable prices and getting volume. Thank you very

much.

Sucrit Patil: Thank you for the guidance and I wish the entire team best of luck for Q3.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, I believe pre-paid catering is now available in the Amrit Bharat Train. So, what is the 7% growth in catering that we saw attributable to that? And also if you can clarify whether all Amritsar Bharat trains will operate on that pre-paid model or not? And how many trains are we currently servicing right now?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You want to know how many Amrit Bharat trains we are serving now or you want to know overall trains we are serving?

Jinesh Joshi: So, currently how many are we serving and if you can also tell us what can be the universe over here?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Whole universe today it is 1,318 trains and out of which around 15 Amrit Bharat trains we are serving. At the moment none of the Amrit Bharat trains we are running on pre-paid model but yes, the policy is out. Of course, this will give us a good gain but we are putting our system in place to take up this work.

Jinesh Joshi: Thank you. If I remember right earlier our universe was somewhere around 1,500 trains and our reach was at about 1,300 trains. And now you mentioned that additional 1,318 Amrit Bharat trains will come up. So, does that imply that our universe doubles or basically how to think about it?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: I could not get your question. Please repeat it again.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, our current catering reach is 1,300 trains, right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Sure.

Jinesh Joshi: And you mentioned that additional 1,318 Amrit Bharat trains are something which will come up in future. So, does it imply...?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No. Currently we are running, currently all trains put together mobile services we are providing in 1,318 trains. And only 15 trains are Amrit Bharat trains.

Jinesh Joshi: Understood. And how many more Amrit Bharat are about to come was my question. How big is the universe?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Though universe is quite big but exact number you can get only from Ministry of Railways.

Jinesh Joshi: Okay. And secondly, just one small clarification required on the cluster based contracts that were awarded sometime back on 5-plus 2 year basis. So, these new contracts, are all of them now getting our P&L and we are accruing revenues at revised prices or some of them are yet to get our P&L?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, you see, there is a mix of cluster trains and SBD trains and temporary trains. You see, we have given contract on cluster trains which have been already awarded where we got the tender through. And in those trains also, when the SBD trains tenure will expire, those trains will be converted into cluster trains. And there are certain trains which could not be pooled in the cluster, those trains we are running on a temporary basis. So, all three types of trains are still working. Thank you.

Jinesh Joshi: I will take this separately. No problem. But sir, one last book keeping question. If you can share the number of tickets booked for the quarter and the convenience fee and also the share of UPI transactions.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Total tickets during this quarter booked is 13.55 crores and UPI share is 49.81% and convenience fee share is Rs. 252 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Rahul Jain: Thanks for the opportunity. Just I would like to understand about this exceptional item which has been announced in this particular quarter related to the Tejas Express train. If my memory

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serves right, is it related to the reduction request that we have made towards certain charges for (Inaudible) 18.04 the rake? Please give me clarity on this. And is there anything more to happen here? Thank you.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, this exceptional item is because of the discount we got from Indian Railways on the haulage charges of Tejas Express. This is 5.8 crores. Thank you. What's your next question on to that?

Rahul Jain: And this haulage charges now since this has been aligned, so the reduced rate is what is applicable to us for the current fiscal onwards?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, the same rate is continuing now.

Rahul Jain: And any colour we could get on this Tejas Express? Is it making profit at this point? And any utilization, any other input that we could share how the operations are working right now?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Total Tejas revenue is Rs. 37.31 crores out of which Rs. 3.38 crores is our profit. And our occupancy of Ahmedabad is 87% and Lucknow is 56%.

Rahul Jain: Okay. Now, about the Rail Neer business, we have highlighted that we would first close the already announced plant. So, any development in terms of what all new capacity we are expecting to getting live in next 12 months?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: First of all our Bilaspur plant which is not working at the moment because of some reasons of state government, so now the issue is resolved and we will be very soon starting the Bilaspur plant. So, that will add capacity of 72,000 bottles per day. Besides, we are in the process of enhancing the capacity of our Danapur and Ambarnath plant from 1 lakh bottles to 3 lakh bottles and we are also hoping to install four more plants across India.

Rahul Jain: Is it safer to assume this Brownfield capacity can come in next 12 months but the four more plants might come probably in the next fiscal?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes.

Rahul Jain: Sure. And on the tourism business, we keep innovating in terms of new revenue stream and opportunity. So, is there any other thing that we are working right now or any smaller initiative that has taken up scale within the tourism sub segments?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I am happy to inform you that we have started taking up MICE event. And recently we have done it for Indo-AS EAN countries Mart, where IRCTC in Bangkok for the fir

st time organized

the Mart infrastructure. We participated in PATA, and we have been given by MEA this work, not to Ministry of Tourism.

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Rahul Jain: Sorry, we got it from where?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: From MEA, Ministry of External Affairs.

Rahul Jain: Okay. So, was it representing this Mart which you were mentioning, sorry, about my knowledge on this subject. So, was it like India section which we hosted in that ASEAN event or something more?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. It is not only for India but it is for ASEAN also. 11 Countries participating.

Rahul Jain: Sure. So, in the MICE event, is there, because this is a very diversified segment, so how we are trying to identify the area which we will participate and areas which we may not?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, general MICE everybody can do, but now we have planned to make a cluster kind of thing where we will divide all the ministries and the state government in five clusters. And it will be backed by good partners, PPP partners, and we will try to capture this business from government and semi-government organizations including the PSUs.

Rahul Jain: Pretty interesting. So, any profitability, will it be like a fixed top-up margin on the cost plus basis or it will be function of other revenue stream and what we collect?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, it will be what we have thought of as a minimum margin of 8% will keep. And as I told earlier that we work on an affordable model, so whatever benefit we can derive because of our capacity or our market presence will certainly give benefit to the organization so that we get more and more business, of course with the 8% return.

Rahul Jain: And just lastly, will this revenue be part of our catering initiative or it will be part of our tourism initiative?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Of course, tourism.

Rahul Jain: Sure, Thank you so much. I will join back the queue and congratulations on starting this new venture. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Kartik Gada from Multiple Wealth. Please go ahead.

Kartik Gada: Hi, thank you for this opportunity. I had a question related to the balance sheet. So, when I look at the six month revenue, it is at Rs. 2,300 crores. And when I compare this with the debtors, debtors are at Rs. 1,548 crores. So, just wanted to understand the composition of debtors. Even when I look at the March numbers, the fiscal 25 numbers, the debtors days are coming at more

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than 100. So, just wanted to understand which are the segments which are contributing to this and what would be our strategy to bring down the debtor days?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, mostly this is more than 80% with railways, which is our parent organization. It is basically that it's a continuous business going on every day, there is a new bill coming in and we are getting this money back also. So, we monitor it in a better way. We are trying to use this automation also where HST, because bill verification is a critical issue here. There are many trains which then run then TT of the train that verifies that how many numbers are actually taken meals and based on that, that verification we get the bill cleared. So, there, what happens at the

moment all the all the major trains they have already they are using HST. So, we are in the process of linking this HST with our billing process. So, once this is done, of course, it will certainly help us in at least getting it verified quickly, and that much time we will be able to save. So, I am very hopeful to get it a better proportion.

Kartik Gada: Okay, so would a major chunk of this data be coming from the catering segment? Would that be the fair understanding?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, major catering.

Kartik Gada: Okay, and this initiative, which you mentioned the automation initiative, is it

possible to provide

any timelines? What kind of improvement we can say by end of this fiscal year or the next fiscal year, something of that sort?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: It is already in the process. We'll first do it on a pilot basis. And if it is getting through, then we'll be going all on by the end of next financial year.

Kartik Gada: Okay, my next question is related to the payment aggregate of business. So, thank you for the commentary in the initial remarks. So, if it's possible, anything which you can share? What will be the timeline after we get the final approval from RBI? What would be the timeline and what will be our strategies? How we plan to monetize this segment?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, we are already into this payment business. But of course, for our internal customer also only. And there we have a good sense and business sense of this particular business. And after six months, once we get the license, we are already in the process of putting our people right at the right place. We have already set up a subsidiary, which will be looking into the business alone. And we have our business plan, how we'll go about it. But I can tell you that our business alone, presently we are doing with our I -Pay only 20% of the total transaction GMP value, which we have a scope of around going up to 100%. So, something around 70,000 crore, whereas we are doing only 13,000 crore round business, this business already existing, we'll tap that. And we have business plan, which I don't want to discuss openly here. You know that is a very competitive field. And you will get to know once we do it. Thank you.

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Kartik Gada: Okay, just last question on the internet ticketing segment. So, now, you mentioned that we have a very high share of almost 90% of Indian Railways, online tickets booked. Again, depends on the ticketing growth from the railway side, but how we can get higher growth because this quarter, we are seeing four percentage growth in the revenue. So, again, how, how can we get higher growth in the internet ticketing revenue?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: We have two segments of business earnings revenue in this particular IT revenue segment. One is convenience fee, which depends on the percentage of reserve ticketing IRCTC is doing online.

And the other is non-convenience fee. So, basically we have like improved our non-convenience fee by 13% and we are very hopeful to increase it further, So, that is how we will be able to manage and maintain our IT segment growth.

Kartik Gada: Okay. Thank you so much for all the replies.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Harsh Yadav from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Harsh Yadav: Hi. I wanted to ask question on Bharat Gaurav Train. You had mentioned in Q1 that you were going to add one more rake. Has that been deployed? And what could be the booking trend for Q3-Q4 that you see? And also how many departures have you completed in H1?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: We have already got nine coaches. And presently, we have deployed these coaches in our regular trains, regular Bharat Gaurav trains. And we are doing good business of Bharat Gaurav train.

You see, this year, our tourism, this quarter, our tourism revenue has grown by 21%. And contribution of Bharat Gaurav train is quite a lot.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. If you could also provide some light on the booking pipeline for Maharaja s' Express, because you had mentioned 20 % odd growth in Q1. Has that momentum sustained in Q2?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I am happy to tell you that even for the next year, we have got quite handsome booking. And this year, we'll be touching, I think, highest ever booking on Maharaja s' Express.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. And a question on this A BSS. You had mentioned in Q1 that station upgrades were impacting static units temporarily. Has that been resolved? Or is this continuing? And how long do

you think this impact would persist?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, this is still continuing because the stations are getting commissioned slowly, but they have been taken up simultaneously. But it will give us a very good business in the years to come.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Just a few more questions. You had mentioned this IRCTC co-branded UPI credit card. Is there any update on this? Have you planned anything?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: You are talking of SBI co- branded card?

Harsh Yadav: Yes.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, that business is continuing. And we are still with them. And besides that, SBI, we have collaborated with Ratnakar Bank also, RBL also.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Just one last question. If you could share the AC, non-AC ticketing mix ?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I am just trying to tell you about the figures also. Loyalty program we have gained 15.35 crores, there is a jump of 26.65%. What is your next question please?

Harsh Yadav: I wanted to know AC, non-AC ticketing mix share for Q2.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: AC is 6.75 crores out of 13.55 crores. Non-AC is 6.8 crores.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions from the participants, I now hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Rahul Himalian : A very good evening to everyone. I am Rahul Himal ian, Director, Tourism and Marketing, looking after the tourism and internet ticketing business. As you have seen that H1 as well as Q2 has shown us a robust growth of 7.71% from revenue for operations and the EBITDA has been around 8.31% variation. With this, it has set the zeal and momentum in us to perform in Q3 and Q4 and make the financial year ' 25-'26 a remarkable and momentous year. Wishing you all the very best. Wishing us all the very best in this en deavor. Thank you.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you.

Moderator: On behalf of Dolat Capital that concludes the conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Call: Feb 2026

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 February 18, 202 6

BSE Limited
(Through BSE Listing Centre)
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
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Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
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Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of “ Q3FY26 Earning
Conference Call ” held on Friday , 13th February , 2026.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing
Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015,

Sir/Madam,

In reference to our communication dated 06th February , 202 6, please find enclosed
herewith the Transcript of “Q 3FY26 Earning Conference Call” held on Friday , 13th
February , 202 6.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,
For Indian Railway Catering and
Tourism Corporation Limited
(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199
Encl: As above.
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“Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation
Limited
Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call ”
February 13, 202 6

MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING
AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. SUDHIR KUMAR – DIRECTOR , FINANCE AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – INDIAN RAILWAY
CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN – DIRECTOR TOURISM AND
MARKETING – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND
TOURISM CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. MANOJ KUMAR SHARMA – DIRECTOR CATERING
SERVICE – INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM
CORPORATION LIMITED
M
ODERATOR : MR. RAHUL JAIN – DOLAT CAPITAL

Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited
February 13, 202 6

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the IRCTC Limited Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call hosted by Dolat Capital. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I would now like to hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain: from Dolat Capital. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: : Thank you, Alaric. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited. I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC represented by Mr. Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is Chairman and Managing Director of the company; Mr. Sudhir Kumar, who is Director, Finance and CFO. We also have on the call, Shri Rahul Himalian Ji, who is Director of Tourism and Marketing; and Mr. Manoj Sharma, Director Catering Services of the company.

Now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceedings forward. Over to you, please. Thank you, Rahul.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Good afternoon. It's my pleasure to welcome you to the earnings call of IRCTC for the quarter ended 31st December 2025. The financial results for Q3 '26 were announced yesterday and filed with the stock exchanges. I will begin with a brief overview of our performance, after which our Director of Finance and CFO, Mr. Sudhir Kumar, will present a detailed financial and segment-wise analysis.

We will then open the floor for questions. Q3 FY '26 stood out to be extremely encouraging with the highest ever revenue and profitability in the company's history. This reflects the strength of our operating model, resilient business segment and sustained momentum across core business verticals. During the quarter, PAT stood at INR 394 crores, registering a healthy year-on-year growth of 15.5%, driven by strong performance in Internet ticketing, rail neer and tourism, along with improved operational efficiencies and prudent cost management.

EBITDA stood at INR 465 crores, a jump of 11.5% year-on-year. Revenue from operations increased to INR 1,449 crores from INR 1,225 crores in the corresponding quarter last year, reflecting a growth of 18.2% with a robust contribution across all business segments. This consistent performance is anchored in a citizen-centric business model, strong brand positioning and continuous enhancement of our digital capabilities.

We remain committed to the expanding new age offerings, improving operational efficiencies and leveraging technology to enhance customer experience while exploring emerging opportunities in tourism, hospitality and value-added services. We are confident of sustaining this growth momentum, supported by our strong financial position and commitment to long-term stakeholder value.

Thank you. I now hand over the call to Mr. Sudhir Kumar, our Director, Finance and CFO, for a detailed discussion on the financial and segmental performance.

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Sudhir Kumar: Good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. On behalf of the management team, I extend a warm welcome to all of you to this earnings call to discuss our financial and operational performance for the third quarter of financial year 2025-'26. I'm pleased to share that the company has delivered a strong and resilient performance during the quarter, reflecting the robustness of our diversified business model and disciplined execution.

Profit after tax stood at INR 394 crores, registering a year-on-year growth of 15.5%. Total revenue

for the quarter reached INR 1,449 crores, representing a 18.2% increase over the corresponding period last year. EBITDA rose to INR 465 crores with a healthy EBITDA margin of 32.1%, although margins moderated slightly due to changes in revenue mix, particularly higher contribution from catering and provisions, our overall profitability remained strong and sustainable.

Let me now briefly highlight the segment-wise performance. Internet ticketing continued to be our most profitable segment and the core strength of the company. Revenue stood at INR 401 crores, up 13.2% year-on-year. Nearly 89% of the reserved railway tickets in India are now booked through our online platform, underscoring our leadership in digital ticketing. The segment delivered an impressive EBITDA margin of 85%, reflecting strong operating leverage and cost efficiency.

Catering recorded revenue of INR 661 crores, achieving a robust growth of 19.1% year-on-year. Margins were impacted due to higher sales in train catering operations and pilot initiatives such as branded catering projects, along with our continued focus on enhancing customer value and

passenger satisfaction.

Despite this, the segment remains a steady and scalable growth driver, supported by rising passenger volumes and ongoing service improvements. Rail Neer generated revenue of INR 98 crores, registering a 6.5% year-on-year growth. Margins improved during the quarter, driven by economy in material costs and sustained operational efficiencies, along with strong brand acceptance in the market.

Tourism delivered an excellent performance with revenue of INR 289 crores, marking a 29% year-on-year growth despite temporary geopolitical disruptions. EBITDA margins improved to 19%, reflecting a better product mix and focused cost rationalization initiatives. Our overall third quarter results demonstrate the resilience of our business, disciplined cost management, a strong digital backbone and unwavering focus on operational excellence. We remain confident in our growth momentum and are well positioned to create sustainable long-term value for our stakeholders.

With this, I conclude my remarks. We will now open the floor for questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you sir. The first question comes from the line of Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: Congrats on a good set of numbers. Sir, my question is on the catering business, which reported a very healthy growth of 19% in this quarter. So if you can highlight the reasons behind that.

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And also in the opening commentary, you mentioned that margins were impacted due to the Vande Bharat project. So if you can just talk a bit about that as well?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Mr. Joshi. It's a very good question. We have seen that our revenue from Vande Bharat train this time, the billing has increased by INR70 crores and so be the license fee. So the main reason for factoring business revenue enhancement is introduction of additional 40 trains during the period. And so far as margin is concerned, when we log the revenue for the Vande Bharat billing, it doesn't give us that much license fee. And additionally, 5% GST, we have to pay out of that. So that is the main reason of the margin not very high, which you have indicated.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure, sir. And secondly, you mentioned that 40 additional trains were introduced in this quarter, which basically led to a very good growth. Sir, how to think from FY '27 and '28 perspective?

Because if I look at our catering business in 1Q and 2Q, the growth was slightly weaker and suddenly, we have seen a very sharp jump led by addition of trains. So can you give some color as to how many new trains are expected to be introduced in, say, '27 and '28 and how to think from the 2-year perspective, especially on the growth

side?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Again, it's a very pertinent question, important question, how it looked like in the catering business. So you must have seen the budget announcement and the discussion thereafter in the parliament and various media coverage, wherein it is very categorically told by rail ministry that they are going to introduce 260 Vande Bharat train sets. So these trains are already in the pipeline, and that is certainly going to add good business for IRCTC catering.

Jinesh Joshi: Got that. Sir, one last bookkeeping question from my side. If you can just give out the figures for a number of tickets that were booked in this quarter? And what was the share of UPI transactions and also the breakdown between convenience and non-convenience revenue. So that is the last question from my side.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Our convenience revenue is INR 251 crores and non-convenience revenue is INR150 crores during this quarter. And the ticket booking, average daily ticket booking in lakhs is around INR14.64 lakh per day as against INR 13.59 lakhs last year December '24. And the UPI share has increased from 46.86% last year to 50.18%.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Kashish Mehta from Dolat Capital.

Kashish Mehta: Congratulations to the team on a wonderful quarter. I have a couple of questions. So firstly, on the payment aggregator license that I received the in-principle approval in the previous quarter, and it was said that by January end they would be submitting the final applications. So just the timelines treated on that thing. I just wanted a view of how the management is looking at that thing from a strategic business drive up potentially going ahead?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So our document submission date has been extended by RBI till August this year. And we have already engaged our technology service provider. So most likely we'll be submitting the documents at the earliest.

Kashish Mehta: And one more question. Again, sir, regarding Railneer, it was announced that the company will be undertaking 4 greenfield projects in FY '27, I think. So again, what are the timelines because

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naturally greenfield operations take a bit of time getting operationalized? And what sort of capacity expansion are we looking at once these plants get operational?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, first of all, we are enhancing the capacity of our existing plant at Danapur and Ambernath. We are doubling its capacity. In addition, our Board has already sanctioned for installation of 4 new plants at Mysore, Prayagraj, Bhagalpur and Ranchi. So we'll be adding around 25% to 30% capacity in say -- in 1.5 years.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Harsh Yadav from Dolat Capital.

Harsh Yadav: Congrats on a wonderful set of numbers this quarter I firstly, just wanted to confirm the numbers for convenience, nonconvenience -- if I'm right, then it was INR 251 crores convenience and also for daily ticket booking. If you could share that again? I missed that.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I could not get you properly, but I think you want to know what is the share of convenience fee in the IT earnings. That is INR 251 crores and non-convenience fee realization is INR 150 crores.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Regarding your real new volume, could you share the average volume of rail neer bottles you sold per day in Q3? And how close are we to reaching that 2 million bottles per day capacity target?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: The average is 12.68 lakhs bottle.

Harsh Yadav: I had one more question around the Amrit Bharat station scheme. We had previously noted that static catering units were being impacted by these station upgrades. So has that normalized here in Q3 now? Or are we seeing some revenue flow from these upgraded stations yet or are we yet to see that?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Earli

er, we were having our projects at 543 stations. It has now increased to 563.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. All right. I have a few more questions. If you could give me the time to ask them. I could -- I also wanted to confirm the UPI transaction share. Was it 50.18%?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Also regarding the labor code impact you had mentioned in the footnotes that you're still assessing the labor code impact and we've seen a lot of peers taking your provisions this quarter.

So could you give me like a broad range of quantum of any potential liabilities in the case in Q4?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I don't see there is any major impact because we are still examining the impact as such in detail because there are 2 things which may come for us, like earlier gratuity that used to be given in 5 years. So it has been reduced to 1 year and health checkup. So like for our regular employees, we have no problem because we will see to that. And whatever the impact of that will be adding to our cost. But that we will compensate by increasing the volume and revenue of the business.

Harsh Yadav: So tourism did really well. And how much of this do you think would be able to this influx of seasonality would we be able to carry over to Q4 for Maharaja Express and Bharat Gaurav?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see all of our segments have shown a very good increase and we are targeting to achieve 15% sustainable growth this year.

Harsh Yadav: Just one last question from my end. This is a little generic in nature, but I just wanted to ask, so you have a huge database. And are there any anonymized data insights or products that were created for third parties that you would like to use? Or is it strictly for personnel IRCTC to use due to privacy concerns?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see we have to see the DPDP compliances. And we have a very -- like we have planned to introduce our unified portal and taking use of data available with us to cross-sell our products, but this will be in compliance to DPDP guidelines.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. With these Swiggy, Zomato integrations and catering going. Do you see any -- do you see this as a cannibalization of your onboard entry card sales? Or is it purely incremental?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see there is no dearth of market for both kinds of things. Like -- as I showed you the figure of this quarter, both our normal catering also increased and our e-catering also increased by, say, 25%. So the difference is like in basic catering, we serve the daal chawal khaana type of thing.

But in catering, you can add to what you eat. So both the things are complementing each other, and I don't see any downside anywhere in both the segments. It should be win-win situation.

Harsh Yadav: Regarding the OTA platform that you had mentioned, are you aggressively looking to compete with private OTAs or non-rail inventories like hotels of flights this year, the focus will primarily be on cross-selling existing rail passengers?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see our forte is rail passengers. But now at the moment, our rail passengers are utilizing the services related -- travel-related services from other OTA sites and from unorganized sector.

Even if we are able to like capture some of the value-added services, to our customers. This is a very good business proposition for us. Around 1,600,000 tickets we are booking every day.

And our total other transactions are only 1,00,000 a day which includes hotels, airlines, tool packages and all. So if we put a unified portal, then we will be able to at least offer our services

at a platform, a single platform to our passenger. And whatever packages we are working at the moment, we have got a very good feedback from the customers. And most of these customers are our like family and friends kind of things keep more from the word of mouth

h. So when we

will be able to provide a platform, we are very sure to encash the cross-selling.

Harsh Yadav: Just 1 final question from my end regarding Vande Bharat. So as you see when they Vande Bharat take larger share of the catering mix, how does the unit economics actually differ if you compare it to standard or express mail, like at the prepaid nature of it, is it working better for you and how does it compare to what you have otherwise with the express range and standard mail that you are?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see there are 2 kinds of trains. One is prepaid, another is postpaid. Vande Bharat trains are prepaid trains where we know the assumed number prior to departure of the train. So we get the assessment of volume and we accordingly get a higher revenue share. Whereas in postpaid trains, we are not sure of the volume.

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And in the process, like passengers, they may or may not ask for the meals. So that does not give us that much confidence. So increase in Vande Bharat trains, as I told that 260 Vande Bharat train sets are getting introduced. So that business is more good for our company, rather better for our company.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital.

Rahul Jain: Congratulations to the management for very strong results I have a few questions. Firstly, on the catering business, you said there was launch of more Vande Bharat. So this 40 -odd number which you mentioned of the INR 70-odd crores number, is the increase we saw on a Y-o-Y basis is what I understand and not on a Q-o-Q basis. Is that understanding right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: All 40 trains are not Vande Bharat. There are certain Mail Express trains are also there. Only 19 trains are Vande Bharat out of this.

Rahul Jain: Sure. And the 260-odd train?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: This is year-on-year basis.

Rahul Jain: Sure. And on the 260 train, of course, this would come over a period of years. So it won't happen in the current fiscal alone. Is that also a fair estimate?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, yes. That I told when they were asking about 2027, 28 estimates, that I told.

Rahul Jain: Sure. Then moving to the rail neer segment, can we have any assessment in terms of what percentage of total demand for the segment is currently served to railway? And what more untapped opportunity exists for that as more and more plans will come.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Around 50% and 60%, depending upon season is being served.

Rahul Jain: So basically, even if we increase our capacity by close to 100%, we will still be able to accommodate on the demand side of it.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. That's why our management is like going to add capacity, add new plants. We are thinking further thinking because not yet done anything, but thinking we are thinking to tie up with certain other brands also. Discussion is going on, but not fructified anything at the moment that we will let you know once the things happen.

Rahul Jain: Sure. And in the tourism segment, we saw significant growth. Can you give some breakup in terms of the revenue mix? How much it came from luxury train or Maharaja kind of train? How much it came from Tejas, Bharat Gaurav? Any breakup on the tourism segment, State Tirth and all would be great to understand?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Maharaja revenue grew by 39%. And in absolute term, it is INR53.14 crores. Our State Tirth and Bharat Gaurav train revenue grew by 51%, and it's INR 118.91 crores. Our air ticketing business also grew by 41%. And -- but the figure is INR 6.7 crores -- our budget hotel and Rail Yatri Niwas business grew by 38% in absolute terms, INR 5.3 crores. And other packages announced by 19%, which is INR55.26 crores.

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Rahul Jain: Sir, anyt

hing on Tejas, what was the revenue for Tejas?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Tejas revenue is INR 50 crores.

Rahul Jain: And from -- I can understand that catering momentum should broadly continue given that this has come from more train launches. But from a tourism point of view, how the pipeline looks like? Do we expect the Q4 to see some moderation because the seasonality would be lower? Or

do you think there is enough routes that are identified for Bharat Gaurav or State Tirth , even in Q4 to continue the momentum?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, overall, this year, we'll be able to achieve 15%. And I don't see any dip in the -- because you see Maharaja Express is also running in this Q4. And that is giving us the highest ever revenue. And our state at and Bharat Gaurav trains are also -- in fact, we have added 1 train, Bharat Gaurav train. So that will add to our revenue.

Rahul Jain: Sure. And on the -- lastly, on the ticketing business, we said that payment business would be taking some time before we commercialize that part. In the interim, do we see any driver for this segment to grow the train network expansion that we already covered? Is any other segment or any other driver?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No. Payment Gateway will be announcing in arithmetical mode only, not in a geometric progression more until we get a license. And regarding -- we are more focusing on non-convenience fee revenue, which has grew by 26% this quarter. So we'll focus more on non-convenience fee.

Rahul Jain: And any specific part of that revenue stream that has seen this growth in this particular quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, all segments have grew like in our marketing and ad revenue, it is INR 24.78 crores as against INR13.29 crores we achieved in December '24. And then business also grew by INR62.47 crores we have achieved in this business as against INR 52.53 crores. Similarly, our loyalty program has given INR21.88 crores as against INR 15.35 crores. So all our segment has shown a good increase.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Atif, an individual investor.

Athif : Congratulations on a good set of numbers. So my first question is on the ticketing business. So you said that 89% of tickets are already booked online. So what are the key growth drivers you are seeing in this business going forward?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: As I told earlier, we are focusing more on non-convenience fees. And in fact, this quarter, it has increased by 26%. So that's the main thing we are looking at looking -- looking forward.

Athif : Okay. And could you just share the current occupancy Tejas Express train?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Just a moment. It is -- Lucknow percentage is 69% and Ahmedabad is 109%.

Athif : And are we planning to add any new route?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: What's your question, please?

Athif : Are we planning to add any new route for the Tejas Express like any new service?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, no, not yet.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, as there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for the closing remarks.

Rahul Himani : A very good evening to everyone. I'm Rahul Himani, Director, Tourism and Marketing. First of all, I would like to congratulate us for doing quite well. In Q3, we had a revenue from operations growing at 18.29% and PAT at 15.54%. But what is more important that Q3 also saw a growth, and we are all now motivated inspired to do well for the financial year 2025, '26, which show you all the best. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Dolat Capital, that concludes this conference call. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2026

No. 2019/IRCTC/CS/STEX/356 May 29, 2026

BSE Limited
(Through BSE Listing Centre)
1st Floor, New Trade Wing, Rotunda
Building Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers,
Dalal Street Fort, Mumbai – 400 001
Scrip Code: 542830 National Stock Exchange of India Limited
(Through NEAPS)
"Exchange Plaza", C -1, Block -G,
Bandra -Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai – 400 051

Scrip Symbol: IRCTC

Sub: Outcome of investors/analysts meet – Transcript of Earning Conference Call on financial results for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st March 2026 held on Wednesday , May 27, 2026.

Ref: Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015

Sir/Ma'am,

In reference to our communication dated May 22, 2026, please find enclosed herewith the transcript of Earning Conference Call on financial results for the quarter (Q4) and year ended 31st March 2026 held on Wednesday , May 27, 2026.

You are requested to kindly take the same on record.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

For and on behalf of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

(Suman Kalra)
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No: F9199
Encl: a/a

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"IRCTC Limited Q4 & Full Year FY '26 Earnings
Conference Call "

May 27, 2026

M
MANAGEMENT : MR. SANJAY KUMAR JAIN - CMD, IRCTC LIMITED
MR. SUDHIR KUMAR - DIRECTOR (FINANCE) & CHIEF
FINANCIAL OFFICER , IRCTC LIMITED

MR. RAHUL HIMALIAN - DIRECTOR (TOURISM & MARKETING), IRCTC LIMITED
MR. MANOJ SHARMA - DIRECTOR (CATERING SERVICES), IRCTC LIMITED
MODERATORS : MR. RAHUL JAIN - DOLAT CAPITAL MARKETS PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to IRCTC Limited Q4 & Full Year FY '26 Earnings Conference Call.

As a reminder, all participant s' lines will be in listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' then '0' on your touchtone phone.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Rahul Jain from Dolat Capital Markets Pvt. Ltd. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Rahul Jain: Thank you, Riya. Good afternoon, everyone. On behalf of Dolat Capital, we welcome you all to the Q4 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call of IRCTC Limited.

I take this opportunity to welcome the management of IRCTC Limited, represented by Mr.

Sanjay Kumar Jain, who is CMD of the company ; Mr. Sudhir Kumar, who is Director of Finance and CFO, and also we have today with us Mr. Rahul Him al ian, who is Director of Tourism and Marketing, and Mr. Manoj Sharma – Director of Catering Services of the company.

Now I would like to hand the conference over to IRCTC management to take the proceeding forward. Over to you, please, Sanjay.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Thank you, Rahul. A very good afternoon, everyone.

It is my pleasure to welcome you to the Earnings Call of IRCTC for the quarter and year ending 31

st March 2026. The financial results for Q4 FY '26 were announced yesterday and filed with the stock exchanges. I will begin with a brief overview of our performance. Thereafter, our Director of Tourism and Marketing, Mr. Rahul Him al ian, will present a detailed financial and segment -wise analysis as our Director of Finance is not available because of his personal casualty in his family . We will then open the floor for questions.

Q4 FY '26 stood out to be extremely encouraging with the highest ever revenue and profitability in the company's history in absolute terms. This reflects the strength of our operating model, resilient business segment, and sustained momentum across core business verticals. The company has registered all -time high financial performance in terms of revenue from operations PAT and EBITDA in the Financial Year 2025-26 .

During the financial year, revenue from operations of IRCTC stood at Rs. 5, 215 crores, registering an increase of around 12% as compared to previous Financial Year 2024-25 , driven by strong performance across all segments with improved operational efficiency and prudent cost management. EBITDA stood at Rs. 1 ,666 crores, registering an increase of approximately 7% from previous year. During the financial year, PAT stood at Rs. 1,393 crores, registering an

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increase of approximately 6% from previous year. The company has also declared and paid the highest dividend in the Financial Year 2025-26 of Rs. 720 crores, out of which Rs. 680 crores has already been paid as interim dividend and Rs. 40 crores has been declared as a final dividend by the BOD subject to the approval of AGM in the AGM.

Thank you. I now hand over the call to Mr. Rahul Him al ian – our Director, Tourism and Marketing, for a detailed discussion on the financial and segmental performance. Thank you.

Rahul Himalian: Thank you, sir. Namaskaram. Good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. I am Rahul Him al ian, Director, Tourism and Marketing, IRCTC. On behalf of the entire Management Team of IRCTC and the IRCTC fraternity, I extend a very warm welcome to all of you with this Earnings Call today to present you with the overall " Financial and Operational " performance of IRCTC in the Financial Year 2025 -26 along with the Results of the 4th Quarter of FY 2025- 26.

I am pleased to share that the company has delivered a very strong and resilient financial performance during the Financial Year 2025- 26, including quarter ending 31st March 2026 reflecting th

e robustness of a diversified business model, disciplined execution and continued focus on operational excellence and customer centricity.

- While discussing the Financial Results of FY 2025 -26, you will be glad to know that IRCTC recorded its highest ever revenue from operations at Rs. 5 ,215 crores in the Financial Year 2025-26 compared to Rs. 4 ,675 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a

year-on-year growth of 11.55% which is more than the year -on-year growth of 9.74% recorded in FY 2024- 25.

- Number two, IRCTC recorded its highest ever total revenue of Rs. 5 ,475 crores in FY 2025- 26 compared to Rs. 4 ,904 crores in FY 2024- 25 registering a year -on-year growth of 11.64% which is more than the year -on-year growth of 10.80% recorded in FY 2024- 25.

- IRCTC also recorded its highest ever profit before tax of Rs. 1, 875 crores compared to Rs. 1 ,757 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a year -on-year growth of 6.72%.

- The overall profit earned by the company has been driven with strong performances from all business verticals of IRCTC including catering, IT, tourism and railways.

Similarly, the EBITDA grew from Rs. 1 ,550 crores in FY 2024 -25 to Rs. 1 ,666 crores in FY 2025- 26 registering a growth of 7.48%.

Now taking you deeper into the segment wise performance for FY 2025- 26:

The catering segment recorded a revenue of Rs. 2 ,399 crores in FY 2025- 26 as compared to Rs. 2,125 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a year -on-year growth of 12.89% that is nearly 13%. The

Rail Neer segment recorded a revenue of Rs. 391 crores versus Rs. 379 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a year-on-year growth of 3.17% and a marked growth in profit year -on-year of

21.74%. The internet ticketing segment recorded a revenue of Rs. 1, 536 crores in FY 2025 -26
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as compared to Rs. 1,426 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a year -on-year growth of 7.71% with a marked growth in profit of 7.55%. The tourism segment recorded a revenue of Rs. 890 crores in FY 2025 -26 as compared to Rs. 745 crores in FY 2024- 25 registering a year -on-year growth of 19.46% with a whopping growth in profit of 36.17%.

Now a llow me to briefly highlight the segment wise performance for Q4 of FY 2025 -26:

The total revenue from operations stood at Rs. 1 ,460 crores in Q4 of FY 2025 -26 as compared to revenue of Rs. 1, 269 crores in Q4 of FY 2024 -25 registering a growth of 15.05%. There was a marginal dip in the comparative profit figures in Q4 with profits at Rs. 447 crores as compared to Rs. 472 crores in FY 2024 -25. Prima facie due to macro environmental factors and exceptional items amounting to Rs. 48 crores legacy items which were considered as income in FY 2024- 25. EBITDA for the quarter stood at Rs. 399 crores with a healthy EBITDA margin of 27.33%.

While margins were impacted slightly due to a change in revenue mix particularly higher contributions from catering and tourism segments, the company continued to maintain strong and sustainable profit ability .

Now talking about the business segments for Q4 of FY 2025 -26:

The tourism segment delivered an excellent performance in Q4 grossing an overall revenue of Rs. 304 crores compared to Rs. 274 crores in FY 2024 -25 registering a growth of 10.95% year-on-year despite the current geopolitical environment. The EBITDA margins improved to 16% driven by a better product mix and focused cost rationalization initiative.

Internet Ticketing :

Internet ticketing reported a revenue of Rs. 390 crores versus Rs. 373 crores reflecting a year -on-year growth of 4.56%. You will be glad to know that today we command 89% share of reserved railway tickets and this segment continued to deliver robust profitability with EBITDA margin of 76% driven by strong operating leverage and sustained cost efficienc ies.

Catering:

The Catering segment recorded a revenue of Rs. 671 crores compared to Rs. 529 crores in FY 2024- 25, ach

ieving an impressive growth of 26.84% year -on-year. The margins in this segment were impacted due to higher sales contribution from train catering operations and pilot initiatives such as branded catering projects undertaken with a view to enhancing customer experience and passenger satisfaction. Nevertheless, catering continues to remain a steady and scalable growth driver supported by increasing passenger volumes and continuous efforts towards service enhancement.

Lastly, Rail Neer:

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Rail Neer generated a revenue of Rs. 95 crores compared to Rs. 92 crores registering a year -on-year growth of 3.26%. The segment witnessed an improvement in margins during the quarter supported by economies in material costs, operational efficiencies and sustained consumer confidence in the brand.

Overall, the 4th Quarter performance demonstrates the resilience and strength of IRCTC 's business fundamentals despite the ongoing geopolitical turmoil, prudent cost management with

rational austerity measures, strong digital capabilities and unwavering commitment to operational excellence. We remain confident about the future business growth trajectory and believe the company is well positioned to create sustainable long-term value for all its stakeholders.

With these remarks, I conclude my today 's address to the IRCTC family. We will now open the floor for questions , please. Thank you. Namaskar.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and -answer session. We have a question from the line of Kanishk Gupta from SS Family Office. Please go ahead.

Kanishk Gupta: Yes, sir. Very good afternoon to you. Sir, my question would be particularly on the August Kranti Rajdhani train, despite being a premium Mumbai -Delhi train, which currently stops at Mathura but not at Agra, which is a major tourist and business destination. And from a personal observation, I have observed that many passengers deboard at Mathura and then travel onward to Agra by road, creating additional inconvenience and transit inefficiency. So, additionally, another train, Mumbai -Delhi Tejas Rajdhani, currently does not stop at Mathura or at Agra. So, have you evaluated any possibility of introducing an Agra stoppage for such premium trains due to the high tourism destination like Agra could enhance passenger convenience and premium passenger demand on this corridor?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: The August Kranti Rajdhani route is from Mathura to Mumbai via Kota. If someone wants to go to Agra, there is another train, Rajdhani train from Mumbai, which goes up to CSMT and comes up to Nizamuddin. So, passengers aspiring to go to Agra, they can take that route. Secondly, this is concerning Indian Railways. They will certainly, if you send some request to them, they will consider introducing another train also. Thank you.

Kanishk Gupta: What I mean to say is that, if there is availability for Agra, the revenue potential for direct IRCTC can increase as one of the seven wonders of the world is present there.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: No, in this, you understand, its route is not through Agra. IRCTC cannot go to Guwahati via Srinagar. It has to go from Delhi to Guwahati via Kanpur or via Moradabad . So, the route is not there. You got my point?

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Kanishk Gupta: Okay, sir. And, sir, the second question would be on the convenience fees across AC and non-AC ticket categories have largely remained unchanged for several years despite rising digital volumes and inflation and continued investment in the platform infrastructure. So, how do you evaluate the scope for revisiting convenience fee structure over the long term while balancing affordability and monetization?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: At the moment, we are not planning to announce anything. But, of course, when it will pinch us, we'll think about it. Thank you.

Kanishk Gupta:

And, sir, given the strong cash balance that currently IRCTC has and ability to generate highly efficient cash flows, what would be the key capital allocation priority over the next few years?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, we are an asset-light company. But we are basically trying to invest into our platform. So, first, we are improving our infrastructure of e-ticketing to give convenience to our passengers. Secondly, to make it more secure, we are putting money to that. And besides that, we are planning to have four additional Rail Neer plans, expansion of existing two Rail Neer plans, and we are also trying to go in hotel business.

Kanishk Gupta: And, sir, on this question as a follow-up, dividend payout ratio remains relatively strong at approximately 50%. So, any other methods you are currently evaluating to reward shareholders as in terms of buyback?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: This decision is done by DIPAM, Ministry of Finance. Though we qualify for their criteria, but there is a number of years of barriers there. So, that rule, our board has already apprised DIPAM in this regard. Thank you.

Kanishk Gupta: And, sir, last question would be on that. IRCTC operated at 36% approximately four years ago, 36% EBITDA margins, while Q4 FY '26 margins are currently at 27%. So, can you elaborate the key drivers behind this compression and whether those earlier 36% margins were structurally sustainable or largely a peak driven by favorable e-ticketing business mix and operating leverage?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, we are aspiring to improve our revenue by increasing our different business segments. So, in the process, the high margin business or revenue, as you already know that we are working on 89% of railway ticket booking, so there we are finding it not a very encouraging look forward. So, we have planned to improve the other segment of our business-like catering, tourism, Rail Neer. There, our margin is around 10% to 12%. So, we have planned to improve in absolute margin, but we are regularly telling that in all the investors' calls and earlier also that we will maintain 30%. Now, if you go to the financial year, the margin comes to around 31.95%. And why there is a dip up to 27%? Because in this quarter, we have booked some exceptional items. If we deduct those exceptional items in this quarter, it will be around 30% only. Thank you.

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Kanishk Gupta: And sir, in the long run, is it safe to say that you aim to target mid- 30s kind of margin?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, we are aspiring to maintain 30%.

Kanishk Gupta: Okay, sir, that 's it from my side. Thank you and all the best for the future.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Mr. Jinesh Joshi from PL Capital. Please go ahead.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, what was the exceptional item that you booked in this quarter? And if you can quantify that amount. And secondly, also, can you share, did we get any revenue from running election special trains in 4Q ? So, that is my first question.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, there are three major items which I can quantify is first the legacy item which was booked in March ' 25 was around Rs. 48 crores, which is not there this year. And then allocation of CSR activities, which was last year Rs. 7 crores only, so it is Rs. 31 crores this year. And we have provided for additional ECL of around Rs. 16 crores as against Rs. 8 crores. So, first thing is this. Secondly, election special, we have a revenue of Rs. 2.38 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Sir, just to repeat the numbers because there was some issue in your voice. You highlighted that election special revenue was Rs. 2.38 crores and the ECL provisioning was Rs. 16 crores. But what was the CSR number that you highlighted for this quarter?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Legacy item was Rs. 48 crores, which was there in March '25. This year it is not there. CSR as against Rs. 7 crore

s booked last year. This time, the whole of CSR, Rs. 31 crores has been booked. That is additional Rs. 24 crores in this quarter. And ECL, last year we booked Rs. 8 crores. This year we have provided Rs. 16 crores. So, largely these are the exceptional items. And so far as election special, in this quarter, we have booked Rs. 2.38 crores. And in the financial year, it is Rs. 6.77 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Perfect, sir. Thank you.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: If you want, we will send across the exact figures also.

Jinesh Joshi: No, sir. This is pretty clear. Sir, my second question is on the catering division. I believe the last price hike happened in 2019. And now given the surge in gas prices, is there a possibility of revision in catering prices? And basically, how are the licensees coping with the inflation given their input cost has also risen? So, your comments on that. And just in case, hypothetically, if the price hike happens, will we benefit from the old contracts that have been awarded to the licensees? I thought of asking this because they were given at a fixed fee. So, if you can just clarify on this bit?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, you are 24:48 hypotheti cal, I cannot answer till the price is raised because it is an administered item and is decided by the Ministry of Railways. I can 't comment on that. Thank you very much.

Jinesh Joshi: Last bookkeeping question. If you can share the number of ticket booked, the convenience fee and the AC share in this quarter ?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Number of tickets booked in AC class is 6.85 crores and non-AC class 6.54 crores. Total 13.39 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Share of UPI?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: 51.7%.

Jinesh Joshi: And the convenience fee income also, sir?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Convenience fee income was Rs. 247 crores.

Jinesh Joshi: Sure. And, sir, just one suggestion. If you can maybe put out a presentation and give out all these KPI numbers, it will be really handy. That is one suggestion from my side. Thank you. Thank you so much.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Madhu Chandade from MC Pro. Please go ahead.

Madhu Chandade: Hi. My question is related to the previous question. Like you called out some exceptional items. I just wanted to check that there is a sharp decline in the EBIT margin for catering from 10.4 to 6.3. Was anything specific in this margin decline? And similarly, for internet ticketing, it 's 85 % to 76%, that kind of a decline. Was there anything business specific?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: In the catering, the margin dip because of this exceptional item. First of all, last year, same quarter, we have provided for ECL item of only Rs. 5 crores. This year, it is Rs. 16 crores. CSR allocation under catering was done as against Rs. 1 crore. It 's Rs. 5 crores. And legacy item, this year, it is not there. Last year, Rs. 33 crores. And direct cost because of GST, because increase in the premium trend sale is around Rs. 3 crores. This is regarding catering.

Madhu Chandade: Sorry, sir. I didn 't understand the last item that you called out. GST increase in premium trend, is this year it is Rs. 3 crores? Last year, there was nothing. That 's what you said, right?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Over to last year, additional Rs. 3 crores because of increase of the sale. Then, as regards IT

business, the margin, the reason for the down is allocation of CSR of additional Rs. 17 crores on this. Direct cost around Rs. 8 crores. And increase in the UPI share, it is again Rs. 8 crores.

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Madhu Chandade: Okay. So, in the 4th Quarter, there was a shortage of commercial cylinder. So, did that impact margin by any chance in your business?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Actually, we have done many things to get rid of this problem. First of all, we have allowed our vendors to cook

on the pantry car, which are already having safety facilities. So, all our LHB pantry car now can produce meals in a running train. So, we have allowed our vendors or licenses to cook their meals and serve onto the train. So, that is run on electricity. Secondly, at very big places, we have used this electric as a mode of induction cooking. Thirdly, we have tied up with all this marketing company, IOCL, BPCL, HPCL, to give us the priority as per the government directives.

Madhu Chandade: Great. So, sir, just a last question from my side. Because of the increase in airfare, especially on international routes, like we are hearing that there is a lot of diversion of tourism to domestic tourism in this peak summer holiday season in India. Are you seeing any change in the number of tickets booked or holidays booked or overall increase in passenger traffic?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: In our tourism, this quarter, our tourism revenue grew from Rs. 274 crores to Rs. 304 crores. Despite all these issues, this has increased. Similarly, IT business has also increased from Rs. 372 crores to Rs. 390 crores. So, certainly that has added to our revenue. We have got the opportunity and we have utilized it.

Madhu Chandade: Sir, my question was pertaining to this quarter, which means we are already one and a half months into this new quarter. So, my question was, are you seeing any increased activity in domestic tourism in this quarter, which is like the April-June quarter? Because we are already one and a half months into it.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You want me to comment on a thing which I should not, because it's a listed company, but yes, we are very hopeful. Thank you.

Madhu Chandade: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Sonal from Prescient Capital. Please go ahead.

Sonal Minhas: Hi, this is Sonal Minhas. I have a question with regard to the percentage of tickets that are booked on IRCTC with your channel partners and online travel agents like EasyGo, MakeMyTrip and others. What would be that share for this particular financial year, if you could give us an understanding?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: I will send you the details. Channel partner, I think 28% a round.

Sonal Minhas: All right, sir. And, sir, has that number increased over the last one year directionally without taking absolute numbers?

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Sanjay Kumar Jain: It appears to be the same, but we will send you the numbers. Thank you.

Sonal Minhas: Okay. And, sir, I have a follow-up question on this one that from a tech perspective, how do you see your channel partners directionally from here to the next 2-3 years? Do you think IRCTC can do much better on their portal to actually bypass these channel partners or these are channel partners who can actually add value to your business, your platform? Just want to understand from a build-out perspective, IRCTC going forward.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Why do you want me to lose money? You are my investor. You should be happy if I work with them more.

Sonal Minhas: All right, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Abhishek from Investec. Please go ahead.

Abhishek: Hi, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. My question is on the other expenses. So, other expenses in a quarter comes at around roughly Rs. 40 crores to Rs. 50 crores, but in this quarter it is around Rs. 109 crores. So, what are the reasons behind that?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: As I explained in my initial talk that we have booked the CSR on Rs. 31 crores -Rs. 32 crores and ECL at Rs. 16 crores and that's why it has increased. Thank you.

Abhishek: Okay, sir. Thanks.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Pranav Mashruwala from Dolat Capital. Please go ahead.

Pranav Mashruwala: Hi. Thank you for the opportunity. So, one question on tourism. So, the topline has been healthy, but there has

been some mild contraction in the margin. So, what has been the current growth driver for Q4? So, was there some lower margin Bharat Gaurav or lower tourism packages versus

lower premium luxury tourism? And how can we think about some of the sustainability of margins in this business?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, decrease in margin is basically because of allocation of CSR of Rs. 1.5 crores and decrease in the margin of Tejas Express, two Tejas Express we are running. So, otherwise this margin would be around 18%. Thank you.

Pranav Mashruwala: Okay, great. Next one question would be on Rail Neer. So, here we have seen a good margin expansion. So, what has been driving this margin expansion? Any operational efficiencies which are more sustainable or improved capacity utilization?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes. This last quarter the preform rates were quite good. So, that's how the margin percentage increased. Thank you.

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Pranav Mashruwala: Okay. So, just may be a broad level question. So, we have seen good growth in catering and tourism overall. But the ticket growth, ticketing growth has been a bit moderating considering even the digital penetration is high and the adoption is quite good. How do we see the revenue mix evolving over next few years? And which business will be the primary growth driver for us?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, revenue-wise primary growth I see in catering it will continue to maintain around 15%.

And tourism we are eyeing to continue with around this year we are looking to 19% should continue to be around 20%. And IT business is 7%. We want to increase the non-convenience fee. And for that we are already working on unified portal and iPay. So, that will be around 10%. We want to maintain that. Thank you.

Pranav Mashruwala: Thank you. That's all from me.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Karthik Gada from Multiple Wealth. Please go ahead.

Karthik Gada: Thank you for the opportunity. So, on this CSR which you mentioned against Rs. 7 crores we booked Rs. 31 crores. Understand. So, is there what led to increase? Because in terms of full year revenue growth we are at 11.5%. But CSR increase is almost like 4x. Kind of a little more than 4X. So, what is the rationale for such a sharp increase in CSR?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see CSR as you must be knowing that it depends on the profitability of last 3 years. And 2% of that. This year why we booked this expenditure in the last quarter? Because most of our project for CSR was sanctioned in this quarter. Thank you.

Karthik Gada: Okay. So, would there be such volatility going ahead also? Or we should see it stabilizing around these levels?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: This is an exceptional item. You see every month if I book for say Rs. 2 crores or Rs. 3 crores or kind of thing, then in 12 months we can book around Rs. 36 crores -Rs. 32 crores which is the CSR liability on to us because we identify the projects. We examine its feasibility and viability and whether it is good or not. So, it takes time. So, I don't think it is making any. It is just an exceptional item, you can say that. Thank you.

Karthik Gada: Okay. And just to understand in accounting terms, so there is some element of both CSR and ECL in the EBIT line item also and hence we are seeing lower EBIT margins for catering and internet ticketing. Would that be right understanding?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Exactly.

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Karthik Gada: Okay. Last question from my end. Just to reconfirm the number of tickets which you mentioned. The total was Rs. 13.39 crores?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes.

Karthik Gada: Thank you so much. That's it from my side. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Harsh Yadav from Dolat Capital Markets Pvt. Ltd. Please go ahead.

Harsh Yadav: Sir, you stated that enhancem

ent of license fee for prepaid and postpaid trains for this quarter is a matter of sub judice. Could you quantify the potential incremental revenue that has not been recognized? And what will be the timeline for resolution with respect to high courts?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You are talking of the previous court case which is going on for CC -60?

Harsh Yadav: Yes.

Sanjay Kumar Jain: So, that is under litigation. So, I should not comment it down to now. But under litigation.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. One more question. The RBI deadline for submitting final application for payment aggregator license has been extended to August '26 and you mentioned onboarding a tech service provider in Q3. Could you share the current milestone status of this application? And also once the license is secured, quickly do we plan to launch the unified portal and what is the expected monetization

roadmap for cross-selling travel services?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: August is the deadline and I am happy to tell that we will be able to do it by that time. And we have already engaged our partner. Thank you.

Harsh Yadav: One more question on Rail Neer. So, as you mentioned last Thursday that you are doubling capacity for Danapur and Ambernath and also working on four greenfield plants. What would be the execution status of these plants? And also you indicated in Q3 that you were exploring tie-ups with other beverage brands to bridge the 40% demand supply gap. Has there been any progress on those discussions?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: Yes, we have already tendered our expansion plan for Ambernath from 2 lakh bottles per day to 3 lakh bottles. And similarly for Danapur Railway plant from 1 lakh to 2 lakh bottles. So, we have already tied up with the partner. The work is going on. As regards four plants, we have already got land at Mysore and Prayagraj. Bhagalpur, one land which was given was not that good. So, we have again represented to give a good land where we can extract good water and no problem of future water scarcity. And in Ranchi, Barpali, they have already told that it is allotted to you but we have not got any formal communication from them. As regards engaging

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with other partners, channel partners, the discussion is going on. Our experience till date is not very encouraging but we are trying to find out a good partner for that. Thank you.

Harsh Yadav: Okay. Just one final question on catering. So, you had highlighted that the prepaid Vande Bharat model operates on higher billing but lower margins. With the Ministry of Railways planning to scale Vande Bharat trains, how should we model the long-term sustainable margin for catering division? Are there pricing adjustments or licensing fee revision in discussion with the railway board?

Sanjay Kumar Jain: You see, I never told that we don't get a good margin in Vande Bharat train. In fact, we are getting two things. One is our licensee which is quite good. The other thing is our booking of revenue because how it works. First, our licensee, they give us the license fee for taking a right onto the train and then they serve the meals to them and they raise a bill to us. In turn, we take the money from railway which in turn takes the money from the passengers in the tariff, in the passenger fare and that's how we are booking two things. One is licensee and another is turnover. So, when we book the turnover, we have to raise the bill and for that 5% is the bill which we raise which we don't get an ITC credit. So, whenever the increase in the train revenue will be there, there will be an element of 5% of GST. So, that means I have to increase the revenue. So, I have to bear this 5%. That's what I want to tell. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. That was the last question for the day. I now hand the conference over to management for closing comments.

Manoj Kumar Sharma: Namaskar to all of you. I am Manoj

Kumar Sharma – Director of Catering Services. First of all, I would like to congratulate all the investors on behalf of IRCTC. Because with your support and trust, IRCTC has given a very good performance. In Financial Year 2025-2026, our revenue has grown by 12% through operations. And our PAT has grown by 6%. And I would like to thank you again for your continuous support and trust in the company. Your encouragement and motivation encourage us to move forward, so that we can serve our country in the future and with our stakeholders, we can move forward with long-term relations and sustainable growth. Thank you very much.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of IRCTC Limited that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.